



Gravesend Local Plan Core Strategy

Adopted September 2014



Connecting with the Community



Foreword

Gravesham Borough Council is delighted that it has adopted its Local Plan Core Strategy during a period when the planning system is undergoing significant change. It will provide the certainty that local residents, businesses and developers need about the future direction of growth in the area.

The development strategy for the Borough in this Core Strategy has been informed by the community itself. It is consistent with sustainable development principles and national policy and its location within the Thames Gateway.



The four opportunity areas establish a broad framework within which development can take place and an overall vision can be realised. They together form a significant regeneration area in the Thames Gateway, extending along the whole of the urban riverside and its hinterland and occupying almost a third of the built up area of Gravesham. The identification of these areas gives the Core Strategy resilience and flexibility whilst showing where most change within the Borough will occur over the plan period.

This Core Strategy aims to transform and revitalise previously developed land, strengthen the vitality and vibrancy of Gravesend as the Borough's principal town centre and create modern, integrated, accessible and sustainable communities which meet the full range of people's needs and aspirations whilst preserving the openness and maintaining the national and local planning purposes of the Green Belt, to protect it from inappropriate development.

The concept of opportunity goes further, recognising the development potential of Swanscombe Peninsula and Ebbsfleet, which will carry the regeneration process beyond the plan period and beyond the boundaries of Gravesham as part of a longer term, sub-regional vision.

The Core Strategy has evolved through various stages with public involvement at each stage. The Council has ensured that local residents and businesses were central to its preparation and, as a result, a variety of views were considered and discussed. It is this consultation with stakeholders that provided valuable input and the Council would like to thank everyone who participated in the process.

Whilst the outcome might not satisfy everyone, the Council believes that the Core Strategy strikes a robust balance between all the conflicting needs and aspirations for the Borough as supported by the Independent Inspector who conducted the Core Strategy Examination.

John Burden
Leader of Gravesham Borough Council

Contents

1 Role of the Local Plan Core Strategy

1.1	Introduction	1
1.2	What is the Local Plan Core Strategy?	1
1.3	How does the Core Strategy link with other policies and strategies?	2
1.4	How was this stage reached?	5
1.5	Format of the Core Strategy	6
1.6	Sustainability Appraisal	6
1.7	Habitats Regulations Assessment	6

2 What are the Characteristics, Challenges and Opportunities in Gravesham Borough?

2.1	Purpose of this Section	7
2.2	Location	7
2.3	Settlement pattern	9
2.4	Population	10
2.5	Housing	11
2.6	Transport	11
2.7	Economy and Skills	12
2.8	Health, deprivation and crime	13
2.9	Heritage and the Built Environment	14
2.10	Climate Change	14
2.11	Natural Environment, Sport and Recreation	15

3 The Spatial Vision and Strategic Objectives for Gravesham to 2028

3.1	Spatial Vision	16
3.2	Strategic Objectives	17
3.3	Key Diagram	

4 Spatial Policies

4.1	Sustainable Development	25
	Policy CS01: Sustainable Development	26
4.2	Scale and Distribution of Development	26
	Policy CS02: Scale and Distribution of Development	35
4.3	Opportunity Areas in Gravesham	36
4.4	Northfleet Embankment and Swanscombe Peninsula East Opportunity Area	39
	Policy CS03: Northfleet Embankment and Swanscombe Peninsula East Opportunity Area	45

4.5	Gravesend Riverside East and North East Gravesend Opportunity Area	51
	Policy CS04: Gravesend Riverside East and North East Gravesend Opportunity Area	56
4.6	Gravesend Town Centre Opportunity Area	60
	Policy CS05: Gravesend Town Centre Opportunity Area	68
4.7	Ebbsfleet (Gravesham) Opportunity Area	71
	Policy CS06: Ebbsfleet (Gravesham) Opportunity Area	74
4.8	Land at Coldharbour Road	79
	Policy CS21: Land at Coldharbour Road Key Site	81

5 Thematic Policies

5.1	Economy, Employment and Skills	83
	Policy CS07: Economy, Employment and Skills	88
5.2	Retail, Leisure and the Hierarchy of Centres	91
	Policy CS08: Retail, Leisure and the Hierarchy of Centres	97
5.3	Culture and Tourism	99
	Policy CS09: Culture and Tourism	102
5.4	Physical and Social Infrastructure	103
	Policy CS10: Physical and Social Infrastructure	105
5.5	Transport	106
	Policy CS11: Transport	113
5.6	Green Infrastructure, Sport and Recreation	115
5.7	Green Infrastructure	116
	Policy CS12: Green Infrastructure	122
5.8	Green Space, Sport and Recreation	123
	Policy CS13: Green Space, Sport and Recreation	124
5.9	Residential Development	125
5.10	Housing Type and Size	126
	Policy CS14: Housing Type and Size	127
5.11	Housing Density	128
	Policy CS15: Housing Density	128
5.12	Affordable Housing	130
	Policy CS16: Affordable Housing	131
5.13	Provision of Traveller Sites	133
	Policy CS17: Provision of Traveller Sites	134
5.14	Climate Change	135
	Policy CS18: Climate Change	143
5.15	Development and Design Principles	145
	Policy CS19: Development and Design Principles	147
5.16	Heritage and the Historic Environment	149
	Policy CS20: Heritage and the Historic Environment	150

Figures

Figure 1:	Map of Gravesham Borough	8
Figure 2:	Key Diagram	19
Figure 3:	Opportunity Areas within Gravesham	38
Figure 4:	Northfleet Embankment and Swanscombe Peninsula East Opportunity Area	39
Figure 5:	Key Site 1.3 Land East of Grove Road and Robins Creek Schematic Plan	47
Figure 6:	Key Site 1.4 Old Northfleet Residential Extension Schematic Plan	48
Figure 7:	Key Site 1.5 Northfleet Cement Works Regeneration Area Schematic Plan	49
Figure 8:	Key Site 1.8 Northfleet Embankment East Regeneration Area Schematic Plan	50
Figure 9:	Gravesend Riverside East and North East Gravesend Opportunity Area	51
Figure 10:	Key Site 2.1 Canal Basin Regeneration Area Schematic Plan	58
Figure 11:	Key Site 2.6 North East Gravesend Regeneration Area Schematic Plan	59
Figure 12:	Gravesend Town Centre Opportunity Area	60
Figure 13:	Key Site 3.1 Heritage Quarter Schematic Plan	70
Figure 14:	Ebbsfleet (Gravesham) Opportunity Area	71
Figure 15:	Key Site 4.1 Northfleet Rise Quarter Schematic Plan	77
Figure 16:	Key Site 4.2 Springhead Quarter Schematic Plan	78
Figure 17:	Land at Coldharbour Road Schematic Plan	82
Figure 18:	Gravesend Town Centre Plan	96
Figure 19:	Strategic Green Infrastructure Network	121
Figure 20:	Zero Carbon Hierarchy	140

Tables

Table 1:	Strategic Objectives and Policies	20
Table 2:	Settlement Hierarchy	27
Table 3:	Housing Land Supply	29
Table 4:	Summary of quantitative retail need	32
Table 5:	Distribution of Residential Development	33
Table 6:	Distribution of B Class employment development	34
Table 7:	Summary of quantitative retail need	93
Table 8:	Guideline distribution of retail development to meet full quantitative need over Core Strategy period	95

Appendices

Appendix 1	Saved Policies of the adopted Gravesham Local Plan First Review 1994 (wholly or partially) superseded by the Gravesham Local Plan Core Strategy	154
Appendix 2	Key Milestones	166
Appendix 3	Policy Delivery and Monitoring	167
Appendix 4	Housing Trajectory	185
Appendix 5	Guidance Note: Marketing Requirements in relation to loss of existing B Class employment premises, sites or commercial wharves	186
Appendix 6	Infrastructure Delivery Schedule	188
	Glossary	206

1 Role of the Local Plan Core Strategy

1.1 Introduction

1.1.1 This document is the Council's adopted Core Strategy. It is accompanied by a Policies Map which shows the areas affected by the policies in the Core Strategy and saved policies from the Local Plan First Review (1994). It has been informed by a Sustainability Appraisal/ Strategic Environmental Assessment and a Habitats Regulations Assessment.

1.2 What is the Local Plan Core Strategy?

1.2.1 The Local Plan is part of the Government's planning system, introduced by the Planning and Compulsory Purchase Act 2004 (as amended). The Local Plan will consist of a collection of local development documents including Development Plan Documents (DPDs) and Supplementary Planning Documents (SPDs). In Gravesham Borough, the Local Plan will consist of the Core Strategy (this document) and a Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD which is to be produced in the future. In addition, the Council is considering a number of Supplementary Planning Documents.

1.2.2 The Council will develop a Community Infrastructure Levy (CIL) under Part 11 of the Planning Act 2008. The purpose of CIL is to ensure that the costs of providing infrastructure to support the development of an area can be wholly or partly funded by levying a charge on the owners or developers of land when development takes place.

1.2.3 The Local Plan replaces the Gravesham Local Plan First Review 1994. It will be used, together with the Kent Minerals and Waste Local Plans, to help shape the future of the Borough and to determine individual planning applications. This Core Strategy is the overarching strategic document. The policies in this Core Strategy replace a number of existing saved policies from the adopted Gravesham Local Plan First Review 1994 (see Appendix 1). Remaining saved policies from the adopted Local Plan will continue to operate until they are replaced or revoked.

1.2.4 This Core Strategy sets out the Council's long term spatial vision for the Borough. The Core Strategy covers the period from 1 April 2011 to 31 March 2028. It outlines the strategic objectives for the Borough based on the characteristics of the area and the key issues to be addressed. It sets out a delivery strategy for achieving the objectives. It identifies the areas where major change is likely to take place and allocates Key Sites for development which are considered key to the achievement of this strategy. It also defines areas where policies of restraint will apply and those places or characteristics that will be preserved and/or enhanced to ensure that the Borough's unique sense of place and local distinctiveness remains the permanent foundation upon which Gravesham's local community can grow and prosper.

1.2.5 This Core Strategy sets out as far as practicable when, where and by whom actions will be taken. This will involve the Council and other key interested parties in the public, private and

voluntary sectors working in partnership to achieve common goals.

1.2.6 The approach set out in this Core Strategy has been developed against a backdrop of national economic uncertainty that has and may continue to affect investment decisions and timing of delivery of development at the local level. With the uncertainty about the economic recovery, it is vital that Gravesham plans for growth, but with flexibility, in order that the Borough can benefit from the economic upturn and prosper during future economic fluctuations. Notwithstanding these concerns, Gravesham is in the fortunate position of having a considerable amount of infrastructure already in place and clarity about many of the developments which have planning permission.

1.2.7 All the Local Plan documents that the Council is producing, and their production timeframe, are set out in the Borough's Local Development Scheme (LDS). The LDS and all the Borough's Local Plan documents can be viewed on the Planning Policy pages of the Council's website.

1.3 How does the Core Strategy link with other Policies and Strategies?

1.3.1 The Core Strategy must be consistent with national planning policy, in particular the National Planning Policy Framework (NPPF) and the Planning Policy for Traveller Sites. It was previously a requirement that it must have regard to the sustainable community strategies produced by Gravesham Borough Council and Kent County Council but the statutory duty to prepare sustainable community strategies has now been abolished.

1.3.2 The NPPF emphasises that the purpose of the planning system is to achieve sustainable development. It sets out the following three dimensions of sustainable development: economic, social and environmental. As a result of this, the Core Strategy includes a specific policy on sustainable development. Each policy section also includes details of national planning policy where it is relevant and how this has been taken into account in developing the policy. The NPPF is supported by Planning Practice Guidance. It should be noted that the NPPF does not change the statutory status of the development plan as the starting point for decision making. Proposed development that accords with an up to date Local Plan should be approved and proposed development that conflicts with it should be refused unless material considerations indicate otherwise.

1.3.3 The South East Plan was the Regional Spatial Strategy for the area. This has now been partially revoked. The policies relating to Gravesham Borough no longer apply but are referred to in order to provide the strategic context. The South East Plan identified the part of the Borough to the north of the A2 as being within the Kent Thames Gateway sub-region, an area with a focus for growth and regeneration. It identified Ebbsfleet as the location for a regional hub with a major business district in a mixed settlement with the opportunity to create a regional transport hub around the international rail station. The South East Plan strategy for Gravesham was based on making intensive use of previously developed land within the urban

areas of Gravesend and Northfleet. This was set in a context of protecting the Green Belt and other environmental assets. This reflected the long standing strategy for the area reflected in previous Structure Plans and national documentation on the Thames Gateway. The North Kent authorities within the Kent Thames Gateway sub-region (Gravesham, Dartford, Medway and Swale) retain the shared view that the same spatial strategy for the area should continue to be pursued.

1.3.4 The vision for the development of the Kent Thameside area (the parts of Gravesham and Dartford Boroughs to the north of the A2) has been jointly evolved since the mid 1990s on the basis of significant quantities of previously developed land and the opportunity provided by the International and Domestic Station on the High Speed 1 (HS1) railway line at Ebbsfleet.

1.3.5 The Vision for Kent is the sustainable community strategy for Kent covering the period 2012 – 2022. Gravesham Borough Council is one of the 14 local authorities which have signed up to this with the exception of proposals for a Lower Thames Crossing¹ to the east of Gravesend set out in the "Growth without Gridlock" supporting document. The Vision for Kent seeks:

- to grow the economy - for Kent to be "open for business" with a growing and successful economy and jobs for all
- to tackle disadvantage - for Kent to be a county of opportunity, where aspiration rather than dependency is supported and quality of life is high for everyone
- to put citizens in control - for power and influence to be in the hands of local people so they are able to take responsibility for themselves, their families and their communities.

1.3.6 The Dartford and Gravesham Sustainable Community Strategy only covered the period to 2011, at which point the Dartford and Gravesham Local Strategic Partnership which administered the strategy was dissolved. The government subsequently revoked the statutory duty for local authorities to prepare a Sustainable Community Strategy and, as a result, it is of no relevance to the Core Strategy.

1.3.7 There is a Corporate Business Plan for Gravesham which covers the period 2011 – 2015. This has the following areas of focus:

- Keeping Gravesham safe;
- Working to maintain a clean and green environment;
- Working towards a healthy Gravesham;
- Engaging and empowering communities within the Borough;
- Embracing and celebrating the diverse cultures within the Borough;
- Managing housing developments in the Borough to ensure they meet the needs of the community;
- Delivering a high quality council housing service alongside fully engaged tenants;

¹ The Department for Transport have published a number of documents on the issue of a Lower Thames Crossing (see section on Transport for further details)

- Working with private housing providers in the delivery of quality housing;
- Meeting the housing needs of vulnerable people within Gravesham;
- Promoting healthy lifestyles amongst young people;
- Raising young people's awareness of crime and anti-social behaviour issues;
- Engaging and empowering young people in the delivery of services;
- Driving the economic development of the Borough;
- Ensuring a sustainable high quality built and green environment and safeguarding our cultural heritage;
- Working with partners to develop high quality transport infrastructure;
 - Ensuring a strong customer focus and delivering quality frontline services;
- Managing the Council's business; and
- Working to ensure council services provide value for money and are delivered efficiently

1.3.8 Since the start of the Business Plan period, the Council has experienced challenging economic conditions and unprecedented financial pressures. For these reasons, it was considered prudent to conduct a mid-term review of the Council's 18 areas of focus and to sharpen these into clear, strategic objectives for the Council for the remainder of the Business Plan period. The strategic objectives were developed in conjunction with Members and were adopted by the Council in June 2013. As such, the Council now carries out its key activities against the following five strategic objectives:

- Community well-being
- Housing
- A clean and green environment
- Economic development and regeneration
- Managing the Council's business responsibly

1.3.9 There is also a range of other strategies produced by the Council and other key interested parties which have influenced and informed the policies set out in this document. These include both the adopted and emerging Core Strategies of neighbouring local authorities where the duty to co-operate, introduced under the Localism Act 2011, applies.

1.3.10 The Localism Act 2011 introduced a system of neighbourhood plans. These allow neighbourhood forums and parish councils to establish general planning policies for the development and use of land in a neighbourhood. Neighbourhood plans need to have regard to national planning policy, conform with the development plan for the area, i.e. the Local Plan and the Minerals and Waste Local Plans, and be compatible with EU obligations and human rights requirements. When adopted, they will form part of the development plan. A neighbourhood plan is currently being prepared for Vigo, but there are no other neighbourhood plans currently being prepared in Gravesham. The Council will support and assist any local community that decides to prepare a neighbourhood plan.

1.4 How was this stage reached?

1.4.1 This document has been produced following a process that began in April 2005. It involved gathering information, analysing it and presenting the options for consultation with the public and other interested parties. A summary of the main consultation stages is shown below and the key milestones are shown in a diagram in Appendix 2.

Stage	Date
Issues and Options Consultation	October 2007
Draft Core Strategy and Development Management Policies DPD Consultation	January 2010
Growth Scenarios and Core Strategy Consultation	October 2011
Proposed Submission Core Strategy Consultation	December 2012
Submission of Core Strategy to Secretary of State for Examination	May 2013
Proposed Main and Minor Modifications Consultation	December 2013
Inspector's Report Published	July 2014
Adoption	September 2014

1.4.2 The Core Strategy is supported by a comprehensive evidence base which has been collated throughout the development of the document. The evidence base will be subject to ongoing review and updates during the life of the Core Strategy in line with national policy, particularly to take account of demographic information. This will provide a robust technical understanding of how the Council's policies, and external circumstances, are shaping and influencing the Borough and inform the need for future policy review.

1.4.3 As a result of public consultation and evidence gathered to ascertain the Borough's objectively assessed development requirements, this Core Strategy sets out the development requirements for the plan period (2011 – 2028). However in keeping with existing and past strategic approaches to the area, it maintains an emphasis on economic development, concentrating development on previously developed land in the Gravesend/Northfleet urban area and continuing to promote Ebbsfleet as a mixed use development. This is consistent with the South East Plan spatial strategy, the National Planning Policy Framework, the sub-regional approach to the Kent Thames Gateway and the plans of neighbouring local authorities. It is also consistent with the principle of Localism promoted by the national Government whereby

top-down targets are abolished in favour of locally developed targets. It is on this basis that the vision, strategic objectives and policies set out in this document have been developed and tested through the sustainability appraisal.

1.5 Format of the Core Strategy

1.5.1 The first part of the Core Strategy assesses Gravesham's characteristics, challenges and opportunities. This is followed by the spatial vision for the Borough to 2028 and the strategic objectives to achieve the vision. A key diagram is included after the strategic objectives to show the main elements of the strategy, including a number of Opportunity Areas. There is also a table which shows which Core Strategy policies will achieve each of the strategic objectives. This is followed by policies relating to the location and amount of development. A number of thematic Borough-wide policies are then included. All the policies will be subject to monitoring and review as set out in Appendix 3. An Infrastructure Delivery Schedule has been produced which lists all known infrastructure requirements for the Key Sites and overall development in the Borough as well as other known infrastructure coming forward in the Core Strategy period. As infrastructure requirements are likely to change over time, this schedule is a living document which will be periodically reviewed and updated. It will also be the starting point from which the Council identifies its priorities for the Community Infrastructure Levy. Whilst over time the Community Infrastructure Levy may provide significant contributions to infrastructure delivery, it is intended to fill the funding gaps that remain once existing sources of funding have been taken into account.

1.5.2 A glossary of technical terms is included and footnotes provided where further explanation or definition of terms and policy is required.

1.6 Sustainability Appraisal

1.6.1 The Core Strategy has been subject to sustainability appraisal (SA). This involved identifying and evaluating a plan's impacts having regard to social, environmental and economic factors and helped to ensure that the plan accords with the principles of sustainable development. An objective of carrying out sustainability appraisal at each stage of the plan's development was also to ensure that the most reasonably sustainable option was selected.

1.7 Habitats Regulations Assessment

1.7.1 Gravesham Borough contains sites of international importance for wildlife, i.e. a Special Protection Area, a Special Area of Conservation and a Ramsar site. As a result, the Core Strategy has also been subject to a Habitats Regulations Assessment (HRA). This considered the impacts of the plan on the international sites and ensured that the plan does not have a negative impact on them.

2 What are the Characteristics, Challenges and Opportunities in Gravesham Borough?

2.1 Purpose of this Section

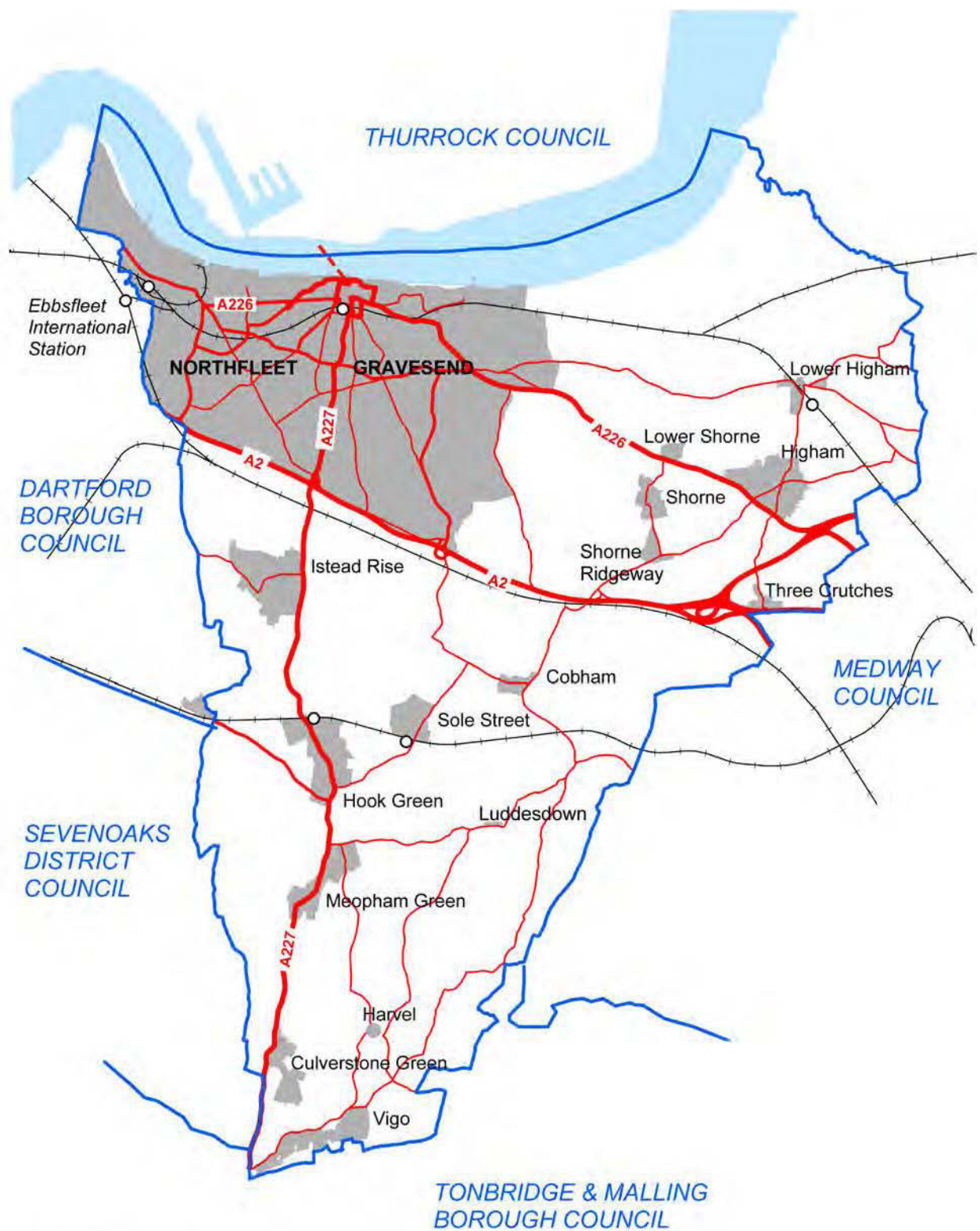
2.1.1 This section summarises Gravesham's key characteristics and assesses the challenges and opportunities facing the area over the lifetime of this plan. It is key to understanding the policies set out later in the document because it describes the context and the issues that the Core Strategy needs to address. It also provides an overview of the direction that the Core Strategy and other components of the Local Plan will take in guiding the Council, the public, and other interested parties in shaping the Borough through to 2028 and beyond.

2.2 Location

2.2.1 Gravesham Borough is located on the south bank of the River Thames in the north of Kent approximately 32 kilometres (20 miles) east of London. It covers an area of 105 square kilometres (40 square miles) and is broadly triangular in shape. It stretches from the River Thames in the north to the crest of the North Downs in the south. The Borough is bounded by the local authorities of Dartford and Sevenoaks to the west, Tonbridge & Malling to the south and Medway to the east. Thurrock lies to the north, on the opposite side of the River Thames.

2.2.2 The Borough is bisected from east to west by the A2/M2 trunk road and by the High Speed 1 railway line (formerly the Channel Tunnel Rail Link). The A2/M2 provides access to Greater London and the Channel Ports as well as the M25. The High Speed 1 line links Gravesend to London St Pancras via Ebbsfleet with journey times of approximately 25 minutes. High Speed 1 also links Ebbsfleet station, which lies just to the west of the Borough, to London St Pancras, Paris, Lille and Brussels. There are traditional rail services running on the North Kent and Chatham main lines from Gravesend, Northfleet, Higham, Sole Street and Meopham stations to London and other areas of Kent. There is also a regular passenger ferry service across the River Thames from Gravesend to Tilbury.

2.2.3 The population of the Borough was 101,700 in 2011, compared to around 95,700 when the 2001 census was taken. This is discussed in more detail in the Population section below. The following sections use data from the 2011 census unless otherwise specified.



(c) Crown Copyright. All rights reserved.
Gravesham Borough Council Licence 100019166.12

Figure 1: Map of Gravesham Borough

2.3 Settlement Pattern

2.3.1 Gravesend and Northfleet comprise the main urban area. They lie to the north of the A2 alongside the River Thames. They are the principal settlements with the widest range of services and facilities and where about 80% of the population of the Borough lives (about 81,400 residents).

2.3.2 Gravesend is an historic riverside town. It has a successful town centre with a good range of shops and multiple stores, including some small department stores. However, the number of vacant units has varied as a result of changes in economic circumstances. Its main retail competition comes from the nearby regional shopping centre at Bluewater in Dartford and from other sub-regional centres such as Chatham and Maidstone. The town centre is a hub for public transport provision and is also where many of the Borough's leisure, cultural and civic facilities are located².

2.3.3 The Gravesend and Northfleet urban area is the main location for housing and employment in the Borough. It contains a number of local centres and a range of other services. There are public transport links to Gravesend town centre. The employment on offer has traditionally been based on heavy manufacturing industry set alongside the River Thames where there are a number of commercial and other supporting river related activities. Many of these industries have contracted over the past few decades leaving behind large tracts of under-used land set at a lower level than the surrounding urban area due to a history of chalk quarrying. These sites are potentially contaminated and may be subject to the risk of tidal flooding. Parts of the urban area suffer from poor air quality as a result of exhaust emissions from traffic and heavy industry. This has led to the declaration of a number of Air Quality Management Areas, e.g. one way system in Gravesend town centre, A2, some of the junctions on Old Road East/West. The realignment of the A2 was completed in December 2008 resulting in air quality improvements. The declaration for particulate matter was revoked in January 2012 whilst the declared area for nitrogen dioxide has been reduced in size.

2.3.4 Outside Gravesend and Northfleet, the Borough is predominantly rural and is where about 20% of the Borough's population lives (about 20,300 residents). 78% of the Borough is designated as part of the London Metropolitan Green Belt. 40% of the Green Belt is either a Ramsar site or part of the Kent Downs Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty. Most of the larger rural settlements are excluded from the Green Belt due to their built up nature although the Green Belt does wash over some of the smaller hamlets. The eastern Green Belt boundary in Gravesham is considered to be very important as the gap between Gravesend and the Medway Towns is now one of the few barriers preventing the merging of settlements along the southern part of the Thames Estuary and the further eastward sprawl of London.

2.3.5 Whilst a significant amount of the Borough is rural, there are few particularly remote areas. Some of the larger rural settlements are comparatively self-sufficient in terms of local

² Gravesend Wider Town Centre Baseline Report October 2011

services as they have their own schools, GP surgeries and shops³, but employment in the rural area is limited. However, residents of the Borough's rural area are dependent on larger towns, such as Gravesend, the Medway towns and Sevenoaks, for access to key services. This means that connections with the urban areas are important.

2.3.6 To the south of the urban area off the A227, Istead Rise is the Borough's second largest settlement (about 3,400 residents). Whilst it does not contain any significant employment uses, it has a range of local services, such as a primary school, a GP surgery, a small supermarket and a post office. It also has a bus service to Gravesend and Sevenoaks.

2.3.7 Further south along the A227, there are two parts to Meopham: Hook Green (about 3,100 residents) and Meopham Green (about 1,200 residents). Hook Green has a number of shops, a post office and an employment site. There is also a railway station with regular services to the Medway Towns, Bromley and London Victoria. Meopham Green has a number of employment sites. Both Hook Green and Meopham Green have a bus service to Gravesend and Sevenoaks and they share a primary school, a secondary school, a library and a GP surgery.

2.3.8 Culverstone Green lies south of Meopham off the A227. It has a population of about 1,200. It has a few facilities including a primary school, post office and small supermarket. It has a bus service to Gravesend and Sevenoaks.

2.3.9 Towards the south of the Borough lies the settlement of Vigo (about 2,100 residents). This has a primary school, a post office and some small shops as well as a regular bus service to Gravesend and Sevenoaks.

2.3.10 Shorne lies east of Gravesend off the A226. It has a population of about 1,300. It has few facilities but it does have a primary school.

2.3.11 Further east along the A226 is Higham. It has approximately 2,600 residents and a number of facilities including a primary school, a GP surgery, a post office and a number of small shops. It has a bus service to Gravesend and the Medway towns.

2.3.12 There are also several smaller settlements scattered throughout the Borough. These vary in population size, the number and range of services available (such as primary school, village shop) and access to public transport.

2.4 Population

2.4.1 The population of the Borough was 101,700 in 2011, an increase of around 6,000 compared to the 2001 census figure due to positive natural change (i.e. more births than deaths) and in-migration. Gravesham has a high proportion of people of black and minority ethnic origin. The census in 2011 showed that nearly 23% of the Borough's population were of

³ Background information on the services and facilities available in the Borough's settlements can be found in Settlement Hierarchy Technical Paper December 2009

an ethnicity other than white British. Around a third of these are of Indian origin and around one quarter are of “other white” origin.

2.4.2 By 2028, the population of the Borough is estimated to increase to around 107,800 residents. It is projected that there will be significantly more people aged over 55 and particularly those aged over 80, i.e. Gravesham has an ageing population. The resident labour supply is forecast to increase by around 2,250 over this period. There are an increasing number of smaller households and by 2028 it is estimated that there will be an increase of over 35% in the number of one person households⁴.

2.4.3 As a result of the above, over the plan period there will be a need to provide:

- Additional new homes and jobs
- Dwellings suitable for one person households
- Dwellings suitable for an ageing population

2.5 Housing

2.5.1 There are approximately 41,700 dwellings in the Borough. In the last five years, an average of 269 dwellings per year have been built in Gravesham⁵. There is a mix of house types – detached, semi-detached, terraced and purpose built flats. The Strategic Housing Market Assessment Update 2012 indicates a particular need for two and three bedroom market housing and one, two and three bedroom affordable housing. The North Kent Strategic Housing Market Assessment 2009 (SHMA) shows that the proportion of owned properties is similar to the South East average but the proportion of socially rented properties in Gravesham is higher and privately rented properties lower.

2.5.2 Gravesham has lower average house prices for all house types than Kent and the South East. Despite this, the vast majority of properties in North Kent, including Gravesham, are unaffordable to most locally resident first time buyers. There are differences within the Borough whereby house prices in the rural area are significantly higher than in the urban area. The different housing sub markets affect the viability of development⁶.

2.5.3 In addition to the need to provide additional homes, including those suitable for one person households and an ageing population identified under the Population section above, there will be a need to provide a mix of house types as well as affordable housing.

2.6 Transport

2.6.1 As outlined earlier, Gravesham Borough has good road, rail and river transport links and Gravesend town centre is a hub for public transport provision in the Borough. These transport links have received significant investment with resultant improvements. However, there are

⁴ Figures derived from a re-run of the long-term migration projection in September 2013

⁵ Gravesham Annual Monitoring Reports

⁶ North Kent Strategic Housing Market Assessment 2009 and Affordable Housing Viability Study February 2010

high levels of out-commuting to work, particularly to Dartford and Central London. In terms of transport modes, over half of working residents travel to work by car. This contributes to congestion, particularly in parts of the urban area and along the A2. Gravesend town centre also experiences congestion as a result of retail and business activities. Levels of congestion will increase as a result of natural growth in traffic and new development. Traffic levels contribute to poor air quality in some areas.

2.6.2 The introduction of high speed rail services from Gravesend to London St Pancras and from Ebbsfleet to both London and the continent provides the opportunity to improve these transport hubs to provide high quality interchange facilities between different types of transport.

2.6.3 The River Thames is an important resource for passenger and freight transport. The Town Pier has been refurbished and a pontoon has been installed to allow access to visiting craft and the Gravesend-Tilbury Ferry. There are also a number of commercial wharves, the majority of which are in operational use, that are important to facilitate the sustainable transport of minerals and other goods by water. Other river related activities serve to support the Thames as a working waterway.

2.6.4 In view of these challenges and opportunities, there will be a need to ensure that:

- new development is mixed use, is located in areas with best access to services and facilities which minimise the need to travel, particularly by car and minimises impacts on the road network;
- support is given to alternatives to car based transport such as improved bus, train, cycling, walking and river transport provision and improved transport hubs in Gravesend town centre and at Ebbsfleet;
- commercial wharves and other sites needed to support the River Thames as a working waterway are retained or appropriate alternative provision is available or will be provided where rationalisation is proposed to allow regeneration to take place; and
- out-commuting is reduced.

2.7 Economy and Skills

2.7.1 Most of Gravesham's employment space is concentrated in the Gravesend/Northfleet urban area. Outside the urban area, there are small industrial areas within larger villages such as Higham and Meopham, and at Hoo junction. Gravesham has the smallest economy in Kent. It has undergone significant restructuring in recent years with a slight fall in employment. The Borough's heavy manufacturing base, mainly located alongside the river, has been hit particularly hard and other sectors, especially those that create high wage, high value jobs, have not grown fast enough to fill the gap.

2.7.2 Just under half of the people living in Gravesham Borough are economically active. There are expected to be around 2,250 more economically active people in the Borough by the end of the plan period. Gravesham Borough has relatively high unemployment compared with Kent,

the South East region and nationally. Unemployment above county and regional rates has prevailed in Gravesham over the past decade. This could be linked to the fact that, on average, Gravesham residents of working age have lower attainment and skills levels than other parts of the South East and nationally.

2.7.3 The lack of jobs in terms of both quantity and quality results in high numbers of the Borough's working population out-commuting to work. Whilst there is also some in-commuting, overall there is a high net out-flow of around 33% of the workforce (2001 census).

2.7.4 As well as contributing to the development of public transport hubs in Gravesend and Ebbsfleet, high speed rail services provide an opportunity to attract more businesses into the Borough due to greater accessibility and, in turn, to create more higher quality jobs locally.

2.7.5 In view of the above, there is a need to improve the local economy by:

- improving the skills of the local workforce;
- providing a greater number, variety and quality of jobs; and
- maximising the economic regeneration potential offered by high speed rail services which now link Ebbsfleet and Gravesend town centre with London and Europe, by ensuring a ready supply of good quality sites for economic development.

2.8 Health, Deprivation and Crime

2.8.1 There are wide variations in the level of overall deprivation in the Borough. Parts of Gravesend and Northfleet are amongst the most deprived in England. Conversely, much of the rural area is amongst the least deprived in England. This has an impact on life expectancy which, for men living in the most deprived areas, is nearly nine years lower than for men living in the least deprived areas. The difference for women is seven years⁷. To help overcome the deprivation issues experienced in Gravesham, there is a need to improve the local economy as well as to ensure that existing communities gain benefits as a result of the new developments in their area such as improved access to better facilities and improvements to the built environment.

2.8.2 Residents of Gravesham Borough experience some significant health issues. Levels of recorded diabetes and childhood obesity are worse for residents in Gravesham than the English average. To enable residents to lead healthier lifestyles, there is a need to ensure that there are sufficient greenspaces and sports facilities to meet the needs of the existing and future population but also to ensure that shops, workplaces and other facilities can be accessed on foot and by bicycle.

2.8.3 The Borough's ageing population will be associated with an increase in those who have difficulties completing household tasks and caring for themselves. There will also be an increase in those with a limiting long term illness. This emphasises the need to provide homes

⁷ Gravesham Health Profile 2014

suitable for an ageing population outlined above and other support facilities.

2.8.4 Gravesham experiences higher levels of recorded crimes than other parts of Kent. Levels of burglary, criminal damage, theft and violence are particularly significant. However, overall crime levels in the Borough have fallen substantially in recent years so that levels are now closer to the Kent average and are below the national average. As a result, new developments should be designed and laid out to minimise the risk of crime. In addition, to discourage anti-social behaviour, there is a need to provide access to safe and attractive indoor and outdoor recreational spaces.

2.9 Heritage and the Built Environment

2.9.1 The Borough has a rich historic built environment, much of which derives from its extensive maritime, military, industrial and transport history. This includes conservation areas in both the older parts of Gravesend and Northfleet and in a number of the rural settlements. There are also a large number of listed buildings including several Grade I listed buildings such as Cobham Hall as well as a significant number of features of local historic and/or architectural value. Gravesham also has a number of Scheduled Monuments such as New Tavern Fort, known archaeological sites and historic landscapes, parks and gardens. The Borough's unique character is part of its attractiveness for investment. Therefore a positive approach to the historic environment will be needed to ensure that the historic character and distinctiveness of the Borough is conserved and enhanced.

2.9.2 In addition to the more historic built up areas, Gravesend and Northfleet have inter war, post war and modern housing suburbs as well as industrial areas. Some of the rural settlements also contain modern housing developments.

2.9.3 Over the plan period the Borough will experience significant change with the creation of new neighbourhoods along the riverfront, at Ebbsfleet and at Coldharbour Road, together with the revitalisation of Gravesend town centre. Change elsewhere is likely to be small scale, involving redevelopment proposals and infilling. There is a need to ensure that all new development is of a high quality. It should improve the existing built environment by protecting and enhancing local character and amenity and by creating new sustainable neighbourhoods with their own sense of place and distinctiveness which enhance their surroundings.

2.10 Climate Change

2.10.1 Climate change is expected to lead to hotter, drier summers and wetter, warmer winters with increased storm and flood events. Similar to the rest of Kent and the South East, the Borough experiences less rainfall/drier weather than other parts of the UK. On occasions, Gravesend has been recorded as the hottest place in the UK. The parts of the Borough alongside the River Thames are within areas where there is a high risk of flooding. There is also a risk of flooding along the Ebbsfleet stream and along the Borough's dry river valleys as well as more general risks of surface water flooding during periods of heavy rainfall. Flooding

and weather patterns in the Borough will be exacerbated by the effects of climate change. In recognition of this, the Thames Estuary 2100 (TE2100) Flood Risk Management Plan sets out the strategic direction for managing floods across the Thames Estuary, and contains recommendations on what actions the Environment Agency and others will need to take up to 2100. It is recognised that action is needed to reduce the impact of human activity on the climate system, primarily through reducing greenhouse gas emissions.

2.10.2 As a result of the above, there will be a need to ensure that development is located in the most accessible locations and facilities can be accessed by means other than the car (see Transport section above). There will also be a need to ensure that development is designed and located to minimise the risk of flooding and flood defence infrastructure is protected. It will be important to encourage water conservation and other measures which protect the supply and quality of water. In addition, measures will be needed to reduce the Borough's carbon footprint such as supporting low carbon and renewable energy generation.

2.11 Natural Environment, Sport and Recreation

2.11.1 Gravesham has significant natural resources. These include sites of international and national significance for wildlife such as the Thames Estuary and Marshes as well as local wildlife sites. It also includes the Kent Downs Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty which is a nationally important landscape as well as large areas of accessible countryside. The Borough also has a number of public greenspaces such as Riverside Leisure Area and Shorne Country Park, indoor sports facilities such as Cygnet Leisure Centre and Meopham Leisure Centre, and outdoor sports facilities such as outdoor tennis courts and bowling greens at Windmill Hill Gardens. There are some issues in terms of the quantity, quality and access to some greenspaces and indoor and outdoor sports facilities in the Borough.

2.11.2 As a result of the above, there is a need to conserve and enhance the Borough's high quality natural environment. There is also a need to protect, enhance and make adequate provision for greenspaces and indoor and outdoor sports facilities to meet the needs of the existing and future population of the Borough. In addition, it will be important to prevent adverse impacts on the birds and habitats of the internationally important wildlife sites, including disturbance to birds from uncontrolled recreational intrusion on the marshes.

3 The Spatial Vision and Strategic Objectives for Gravesham to 2028

3.1 Spatial Vision

3.1.1 By 2028, Gravesham will have reinvented and regenerated itself from an area with predominantly heavy riverside industry to one that offers a more diverse range of employment and housing which respects its unique built, historic and natural environment. The regeneration will have made the most efficient use of land by concentrating mixed use development on previously developed and greenfield urban sites with access to a good range of services and facilities which will have minimised the need to travel. In accordance with national and local planning purposes, the openness of the Green Belt will have been maintained and it will have been protected from inappropriate development. Land unnecessary to be kept permanently open will have been removed to provide additional land for development in appropriate locations.

3.1.2 Gravesham's economy will have grown substantially and the skills of its workforce will have improved. The number, quality and diversity of jobs in the Borough will have increased, leading to improved employment opportunities for residents and a reduction in the need to travel outside the Borough for employment. The majority of existing employment sites will have been safeguarded. At the same time, residents will be benefiting from new housing that meets their needs in terms of type, tenure and size.

3.1.3 Northfleet and Gravesend's riverside will have been transformed with the creation of new thriving residential and mixed use neighbourhoods with access to the riverfront. Both existing and new neighbourhoods will have benefited from an improved public transport network and from the provision of new and improved shopping and other facilities to provide for their needs. New employment sites will have been created, utilising the multimodal opportunities (i.e. accessible by river, rail and road) available in this area. As a minimum, the capacity of commercial wharves and other sites needed to support the River Thames as a working waterway will have been retained.

3.1.4 A new, high quality, mixed use community will have been created at Ebbsfleet which will make the most of its proximity to the international railway station, and will be further developed as a transport hub. It will be well connected by public transport and to existing neighbourhoods and facilities at Northfleet. Ebbsfleet will have provided for the shopping and service needs of its new community. It will have started to provide high quality office/light industrial (B1) jobs and will continue to do so in the longer term, continuing the economic growth occurring in Gravesend and Northfleet and in the wider Ebbsfleet development.

3.1.5 Gravesend Town Centre will have built upon its strengths as a commercial centre, public transport hub and heritage riverside town to establish itself as a dynamic and desirable place to live and work. It will have continued to be a focus for shopping, leisure, service provision,

culture and tourism. Regeneration will have acted as a catalyst for the improvement of the town centre's offer where the high quality design and public realm will enhance the distinctive character of the centre.

3.1.6 A mixed use development will have been created on land at Coldharbour Road which is well connected to the adjoining residential neighbourhood and local services and facilities. Both the existing and new communities will have benefitted from improved open space provision. Employment opportunities will have been enhanced through new office and industrial provision.

3.1.7 In the rest of Gravesend and Northfleet, smaller scale housing development and redevelopment will have taken place which reflect the character of the area. Neighbourhoods will have seen their local centres continue to provide for their local shopping needs and other facilities will have been retained and improved as needed.

3.1.8 Some housing development will have taken place at rural settlements inset from the Green Belt. Local centres in the villages will have continued to provide for the local shopping needs of rural residents and other services will have been retained and improved. Some small scale affordable housing will have been developed in sustainable rural locations to meet local needs. The character of the countryside and the diverse rural landscape will have been conserved and enhanced. Proposals that promote the appropriate expansion and diversification of the rural area economy will have been supported.

3.1.9 Regeneration and development will have conserved and enhanced the Borough's rich historic built environment, landscape character and biodiversity as well as respected its distinctive local character. It will also have responded to the challenges of climate change, by minimising the risk of flooding, protecting flood defences, encouraging water conservation, improving energy efficiency, improving air quality and encouraging the use of low carbon and renewable energy. Furthermore, it will also have reduced the opportunities for crime and embraced the opportunities provided by new technology.

3.1.10 In Gravesham, opportunities to improve health and accessibility will have been seized by the provision of better facilities for recreation, sport, walking and cycling. A Green Infrastructure network will have been created to improve the quality of life, provide benefits to wildlife, protect the landscape and improve access for leisure and sustainable travel purposes particularly within the Gravesend/Northfleet urban area, between the urban area and the rural area and along the River Thames.

3.2 Strategic Objectives

3.2.1 Location and Amount of Development

- SO1 Make the most efficient use of land by concentrating development on underused, derelict and previously developed land in the urban area of Gravesend and Northfleet, in particular former industrial sites along the Thames Riverside and in Gravesend town centre, and at Ebbsfleet.

- SO2 Provide sufficient new homes to meet the future objectively assessed needs of the Borough's population, to include provision of affordable homes, homes for smaller households and older people, and sites for travellers within the urban area and rural settlements inset from the Green Belt.
- SO3 Ensure that the right amount, size and type of employment sites are available in Gravesend and Northfleet to diversify and strengthen the local economy and reduce out commuting.

3.2.2 Gravesend, Northfleet and Ebbsfleet

- SO4 Support existing neighbourhoods and create a number of new residential neighbourhoods, mixed use areas and employment areas along the Thames Riverside at Gravesend and Northfleet and on land at Coldharbour Road.
- SO5 Create a mixed use community at Ebbsfleet including a sub-regionally significant office based employment hub in the longer term, to provide further jobs.
- SO6 Enhance the role of Gravesend town centre as a public transport hub and as the main location for retail, leisure, culture and offices whilst preserving and enhancing its character as a riverside heritage town.
- SO7 Enhance the Borough's public transport network to serve existing and new neighbourhoods and communities in Gravesend, Northfleet and Ebbsfleet.

3.2.3 Rural Area

- SO8 Preserve the openness of the Green Belt, maintain its national and local planning purposes and protect it from inappropriate development.
- SO9 Conserve and enhance the diverse rural landscape including the Kent Downs Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty and its setting.

3.2.4 Across the Borough

- SO10 Safeguard and where possible improve existing employment sites.
- SO11 Seek to retain and improve the provision of existing services and facilities and ensure that sufficient facilities are provided to meet the needs arising from new development.
- SO12 Safeguard and where possible enhance the retail character and function of the Borough's town centre and local centres.
- SO13 Protect and enhance the Borough's heritage assets and historic environment.
- SO14 Ensure that all new development makes a positive contribution to the local character and distinctiveness of the Borough, minimises the risk of crime, responds to climate change, and integrates into the existing built, historic and natural environment.
- SO15 Improve opportunities for recreation, sport, walking and cycling.
- SO16 Safeguard and enhance the biodiversity of the Borough.
- SO17 Increase accessibility, reduce the need to travel, minimise congestion and improve air quality through the improved provision of local public transport and the provision of local jobs and services.
- SO18 As a minimum, safeguard the capacity of commercial wharves and other sites needed to support the River Thames as a working waterway.

3.3 Key Diagram

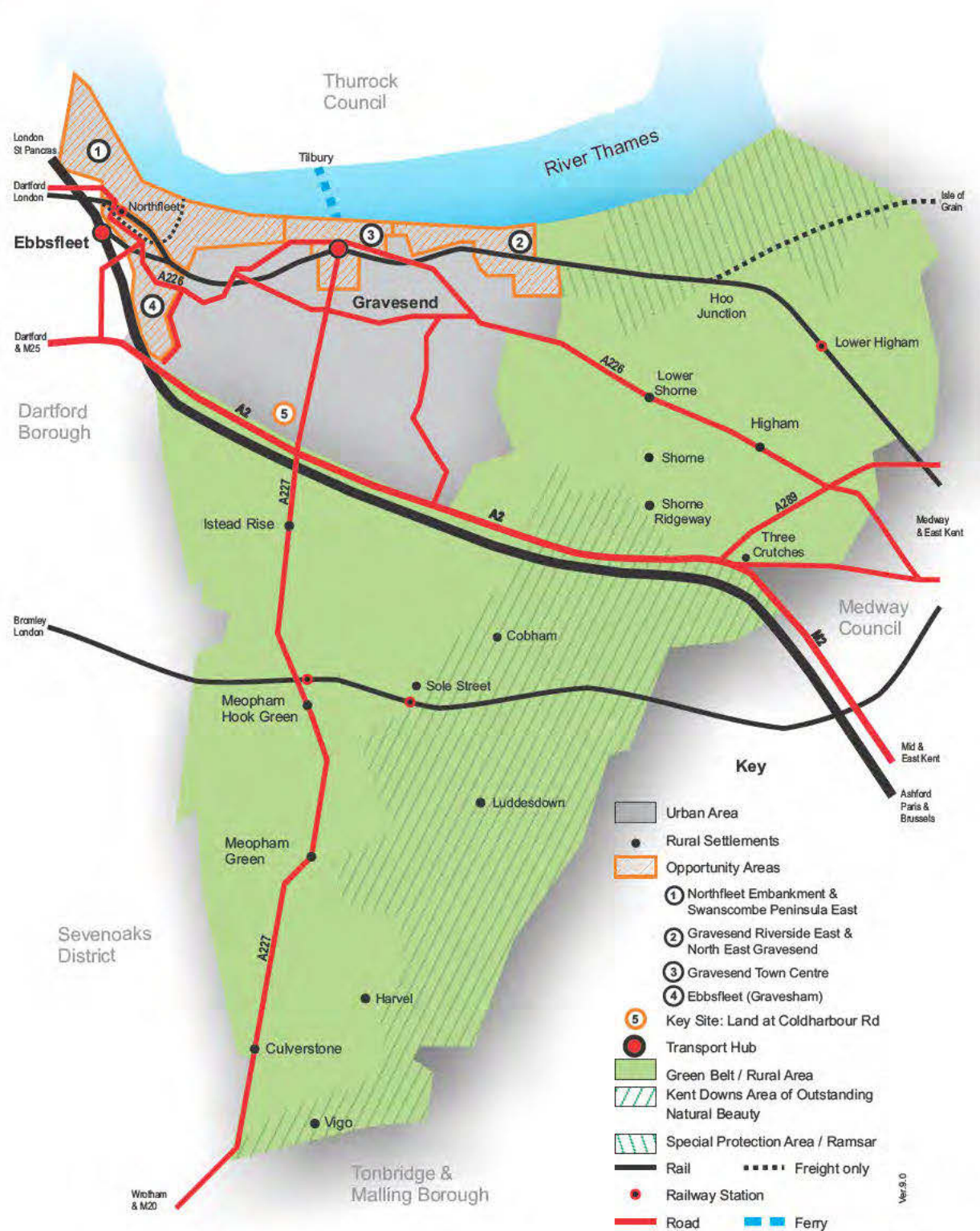


Figure 2: Key Diagram

Table 1: Strategic Objectives and Policies

Strategic Objective	Key Policies
SO1 Make the most efficient use of land by concentrating development on underused, derelict and previously developed land in the urban area of Gravesend and Northfleet, in particular former industrial sites along the Thames Riverside in Gravesend town centre, and at Ebbsfleet.	CS01 - Sustainable Development CS02 - Scale and Distribution of Development CS03 - Northfleet Embankment and Swanscombe Peninsula East Opportunity Area CS04 - Gravesend Riverside East and North East Gravesend Opportunity Area CS05 - Gravesend Town Centre Opportunity Area CS06 - Ebbsfleet (Gravesham) Opportunity Area
SO2 Provide sufficient new homes to meet the future objectively assessed needs of the Borough's population, to include provision of affordable homes, homes for smaller households and older people, and sites for travellers within the urban area and rural settlements inset from the Green Belt.	CS01 - Sustainable Development CS02 - Scale and Distribution of Development CS03 - Northfleet Embankment and Swanscombe Peninsula East Opportunity Area CS04 - Gravesend Riverside East and North East Gravesend Opportunity Area CS05 - Gravesend Town Centre Opportunity Area CS06 - Ebbsfleet (Gravesham) Opportunity Area CS21 - Land at Coldharbour Road Key Site CS14 - Housing Type and Size CS16 - Affordable Housing CS17 - Provision of Traveller Sites

Strategic Objective	Key Policies
SO3 Ensure that the right amount, size and type of employment sites are available in Gravesend and Northfleet to diversify and strengthen the local economy and reduce out commuting.	CS01 - Sustainable Development CS02 - Scale and Distribution of Development CS03 - Northfleet Embankment and Swanscombe Peninsula East Opportunity Area CS04 - Gravesend Riverside East and North East Gravesend Opportunity Area CS05 - Gravesend Town Centre Opportunity Area CS06 - Ebbsfleet (Gravesham) Opportunity Area CS21 - Land at Coldharbour Road Key Site CS07 - Economy, Employment and Skills
SO4 Support existing neighbourhoods and create a number of new residential neighbourhoods, mixed use areas and employment areas along the Thames Riverside at Gravesend and Northfleet and on land at Coldharbour Road.	CS01 - Sustainable Development CS02 - Scale and Distribution of Development CS03 - Northfleet Embankment and Swanscombe Peninsula East Opportunity Area CS04 - Gravesend Riverside East and North East Gravesend Opportunity Area CS05 - Gravesend Town Centre Opportunity Area CS21 - Land at Coldharbour Road Key Site CS07 - Economy, Employment and Skills CS11 - Transport
SO5 Create a mixed use community at Ebbsfleet including a sub-regionally significant office based employment hub in the longer term, to provide further jobs.	CS01 - Sustainable Development CS02 - Scale and Distribution of Development CS06 - Ebbsfleet (Gravesham) Opportunity Area CS07 - Economy, Employment and Skills

Strategic Objective	Key Policies
SO6 Enhance the role of Gravesend town centre as the main location for the Borough's retail, leisure, culture and offices whilst preserving and enhancing its character as a riverside heritage town.	CS01 - Sustainable Development CS02 - Scale and Distribution of Development CS05 - Gravesend Town Centre Opportunity Area CS07 - Economy, Employment and Skills CS08 - Retail, Leisure and the Hierarchy of Centres CS09 - Culture and Tourism
SO7 Enhance the Borough's public transport network to serve existing and new neighbourhoods and communities in Gravesend, Northfleet and Ebbsfleet.	CS01 - Sustainable Development CS03 - Northfleet Embankment and Swanscombe Peninsula East Opportunity Area CS04 - Gravesend Riverside East and North East Gravesend Opportunity Area CS05 - Gravesend Town Centre Opportunity Area CS06 - Ebbsfleet (Gravesham) Opportunity Area CS11 - Transport
SO8 Preserve the openness of the Green Belt, maintain its national and local planning purposes and protect it from inappropriate development.	CS01 - Sustainable Development CS02 - Scale and Distribution of Development
SO9 Conserve and enhance the diverse rural landscape including the Kent Downs Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty and its setting.	CS01 - Sustainable Development CS12 - Green Infrastructure

Strategic Objective	Key Policies
SO10 Retain and where possible improve existing employment sites.	CS01 - Sustainable Development CS07 - Economy, Employment and Skills.
SO11 Seek to retain and improve the provision of existing services and facilities and ensure that sufficient facilities are provided to meet the needs arising from new development at the right time and in the right place.	CS01 - Sustainable Development CS10 - Physical and Social Infrastructure CS13 - Green Space, Sport and Recreation
SO12 Safeguard and where possible enhance the retail character and function of the Borough's Town Centre and local centres.	CS01 - Sustainable Development CS05 - Gravesend Town Centre Opportunity Area CS08 - Retail, Leisure and the Hierarchy of Centres
SO13 Protect and enhance the Borough's heritage assets and historic environment.	CS01 - Sustainable Development CS20 - Heritage and the Historic Environment
SO14 Ensure that all new development makes a positive contribution to the local character and distinctiveness of the Borough, minimises the risk of crime, responds to climate change and integrates into the existing built, historic and natural environment.	CS01 - Sustainable Development CS12 - Green Infrastructure CS15 - Housing Density CS18 - Climate Change CS19 - Development and Design Principles

Strategic Objective	Key Policies
SO15 Improve opportunities for recreation, sport, walking and cycling.	CS01 - Sustainable Development CS11 - Transport CS12 - Green Infrastructure CS13 - Green Space Sport and Recreation
SO16 Safeguard and enhance the biodiversity of the Borough.	CS01 - Sustainable Development CS12 - Green Infrastructure
SO17 Increase accessibility, minimise congestion and improve air quality through the improved provision of local public transport and the provision of local jobs and services.	CS01 - Sustainable Development CS11 - Transport CS07 - Economy, Employment and Skills. CS08 - Retail, Leisure and the Hierarchy of Centres CS10 - Physical and Social Infrastructure CS13 - Green Space, Sport and Recreation
SO18 As a minimum, safeguard the capacity of commercial wharves and other sites needed to support the River Thames as a working waterway.	CS03 - Northfleet Embankment and Swanscombe Peninsula East Opportunity Area CS04 - Gravesend Riverside East and North East Gravesend Opportunity Area CS07 - Economy, Employment and Skills CS11 - Transport

4 Spatial Policies

4.1 Sustainable Development

4.1.1 The National Planning Policy Framework (NPPF) explains that the purpose of the planning system is to contribute to the achievement of sustainable development. This has three dimensions: economic, social and environment. There is a need for the planning system to perform a number of roles under each of these as follows:

- an economic role - contributing to building a strong, responsive and competitive economy, by ensuring that sufficient land of the right type is available in the right places and at the right time to support growth and innovation; and by identifying and coordinating development requirements, including the provision of infrastructure;
- a social role - supporting strong, vibrant and healthy communities, by providing the supply of housing required to meet the needs of present and future generations; and by creating a high quality built environment, with accessible local services that reflect the community's needs and support its health, social and cultural well-being; and
- an environmental role - contributing to protecting and enhancing our natural, built and historic environment; and, as part of this, helping to improve biodiversity, use natural resources prudently, minimise waste and pollution, and mitigate and adapt to climate change including moving to a low carbon economy.

4.1.2 For plan making, the presumption in favour of sustainable development means that:

- local planning authorities should positively seek opportunities to meet the development needs of their area;
- Local Plans should meet objectively assessed needs, with sufficient flexibility to adapt to rapid change, unless:
- any adverse impacts of doing so would significantly and demonstrably outweigh the benefits, when assessed against the policies in the NPPF as a whole; or
- specific policies in the NPPF indicate development should be restricted.

4.1.3 The NPPF advises that the specific policies within it which indicate that development should be restricted include those relating to: sites protected under the Birds and Habitats Directives and/or where development requiring appropriate assessment under the Birds or Habitats Directives is being considered, planned or determined. Also included are: Sites of Special Scientific Interest; land designated as Green Belt, Local Green Space, or an Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty; designated heritage assets; and locations at risk of flooding or coastal erosion.

4.1.4 The NPPF further states that policies in Local Plans should be based on the presumption in favour of sustainable development so that it is clear that development which is sustainable can be approved without delay. It states that Local Plans should contain clear policies that will guide how the presumption should be applied locally.

4.1.5 The vision, objectives and policies in this Core Strategy seek to meet the needs of the Borough in terms of providing homes, jobs and supporting facilities in a sustainable way. They also seek to protect and enhance the built, historic and natural environment. This is fully in accordance with the three roles of the planning system in achieving sustainable development and the results of the Sustainability Appraisal of this Core Strategy reflect this. The following policy reflects the importance of taking into account the principles of sustainable development when taking decisions on future development in the Borough.

Policy CS01: Sustainable Development

4.1.6 Planning applications that accord with the policies in the development plan for Gravesham will be approved without delay, unless material considerations indicate otherwise.

4.1.7 When considering development proposals the Council will take a positive approach that reflects the presumption in favour of sustainable development contained in the National Planning Policy Framework and in this Core Strategy. It will work proactively with applicants jointly to find solutions which mean that proposals can be approved wherever possible, and to secure development that improves the economic, social and environmental conditions in the area.

4.1.8 Where there are no policies relevant to the application or relevant policies are out of date at the time of making the decision then the Council will grant permission unless material considerations indicate otherwise, taking into account whether:

- Any adverse impacts of granting permission would significantly and demonstrably outweigh the benefits, when assessed against the policies in the National Planning Policy Framework taken as a whole; or
- Specific policies in that Framework indicate that development should be restricted.

4.2 Scale and Distribution of Development

4.2.1 In order to meet both current and future economic, social and environmental needs to achieve sustainable development in Gravesham, further development is required within the Borough. Such development will meet the changing housing needs of the population, support and improve the local economy and develop services and facilities to support and benefit the existing local communities.

4.2.2 Regeneration, including new development, can address the needs of communities experiencing deprivation. New development can help provide a range of new homes for local people, improve the environment and provide additional or improved facilities, and introduce new and potentially more affluent households into a deprived area.

4.2.3 The distribution of development set out in this Core Strategy has been developed in line with sustainable development principles. It is consistent with national planning policy and the current and previous regional and sub-regional policy approach to the wider Thames Gateway and Gravesham⁸. It seeks to make the most efficient use of previously developed land, focus development in the most sustainable locations, and preserve the openness and maintain the national and local planning purposes of the Green Belt, protecting it from inappropriate development. It also reflects local priorities to secure regeneration through the creation of new residential neighbourhoods and employment areas along the riverfront and at Ebbsfleet, and revitalising Gravesend Town Centre.

4.2.4 The Council has carried out an assessment of the facilities and services available in the Borough's settlements to identify which are more sustainable. The results are reflected in the settlement hierarchy below.

Table 2: Settlement Hierarchy

First Tier Settlements:	Gravesend/Northfleet/Ebbsfleet, i.e. the urban area
Second Tier Settlements:	Istead Rise, Hook Green Meopham, Higham
Third Tier Settlements:	Culverstone Green, Meopham Green, Vigo
Fourth Tier Settlements:	Cobham, Shorne, Sole Street
Other Settlements:	Harvel, Lower Higham, Luddesdown, Lower Shorne, Shorne Ridgeway, Three Crutches

Source: Settlement Hierarchy Technical Paper December 2009

4.2.5 The hierarchy identifies Gravesend, Northfleet and Ebbsfleet as the most sustainable parts of the Borough. These parts comprise the urban area. The rest of the Borough is rural. The boundaries of the urban and the rural areas are defined on the Policies Map.

4.2.6 Within the rural area, the Council has identified 13 rural settlements inset from the Green Belt and defined on the Policies Map. These boundaries do not define the full extent of each settlement but relate to a coherent and established built up area where infilling would not adversely affect local character and identity, or impact on the openness of the Green Belt.

4.2.7 The national aim of the Green Belt is to prevent urban sprawl by keeping land permanently open. The extent of the Green Belt in Gravesham is defined on the Policies Map. Its local planning purposes are:

- to maintain the break in development between the eastern edge of Gravesend and the Medway Towns which is one of the few barriers preventing the further eastward

⁸ As set out within the South East Plan and its supporting evidence base.

- sprawl of London and the merging of towns along the southern part of the Thames Estuary;
- to assist in safeguarding the countryside by minimising the expansion of the Borough's rural settlements; and
- to assist in concentrating development on underused, derelict and previously developed land in the urban area of Gravesend and Northfleet.

4.2.8 The Core Strategy acknowledges that as development opportunities within the existing urban area and settlements inset from the Green Belt become more limited, some development may be required on land in the rural area before the end of the plan period to meet the Borough's housing needs and sustain rural communities. The Green Belt has therefore been identified as a broad location for future growth and its boundaries will be subject to a review.

Housing

4.2.9 The Core Strategy identifies how the Borough will meet its own objectively assessed needs during the plan period 2011 – 2028 for at least 6,170 new dwellings which will be delivered at three different development rates over the plan period. The distribution of housing over the plan period is shown in Table 5. The greatest capacity for new housing is identified in the Opportunity Areas and Key Sites. There is also capacity on other sites within the existing urban area and rural settlements inset from the Green Belt.

4.2.10 Existing housing will make up around 85% of the housing stock in 2028. As a result, it is important to safeguard and make the best use of the existing stock. Investment is needed to ensure that existing public and private housing meets improving standards. The Council has been undertaking a rolling programme of refurbishment and repairs of its housing stock. Where feasible, the Council also seeks to develop some small, under-used parcels of land that it owns, particularly to meet older persons and specialist housing needs. However, there are areas where a more proactive solution is needed and, for example, the redevelopment of Christianfields has resulted in the replacement of social housing in poor condition with new social and private sector housing. The Council will consider further estate renewal but the scale, location and timing of this will depend on factors such as the funding available, the condition of the units and the needs of the community.

4.2.11 The Council has carried out a Strategic Land Availability Assessment (SLAA) which identifies the main categories of land supply to meet housing needs over the plan period. These are shown in Table 3.

Table 3: Housing Land Supply

A	All sites with extant planning permission at 31 March 2013 including ones subject to a legal agreement being signed*	3,020
B	Emerging Core Strategy Key Sites without planning permission or a resolution to grant planning permission - adjusted capacity (to avoid double counting with approvals set out in A above)	950
C	Unallocated sites which have the potential to make a contribution to housing delivery during the period. These sites are to be allocated in subsequent Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD**	850
D	Small site windfall assumption (less than five dwellings) for 2018 to 2028	330
E	Large site windfall assumption (five dwellings or more) for 2013 to 2028	450
F	Completions 1 April 2011 – 31 March 2013	580
G	Total supply	6,170
H	Core Strategy Housing Requirement	6,170

Note Figures rounded to the nearest 10 dwellings

* Adjusted to take into account Ebbsfleet and Heritage Quarter planning permissions as at 23/08/2013 and excludes completions included in row F

** Component of supply includes unallocated sites from Gravesham Authority Monitoring Report 2012-13 (interim) May 2013

Sources: Gravesham Authority Monitoring Report 2012-13 (interim) May 2013, Ebbsfleet and Heritage Quarter Planning Permissions as at 23/08/2013

4.2.12 The figures show that more than half of the future supply (58%) is either already built, with planning permission or with a resolution to grant planning permission subject to a legal agreement. The remaining supply is made up of Key Sites without planning permission, large and small windfall sites and sites that will be allocated through the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD.

4.2.13 There are other sources of supply that the Council will take into account in monitoring and managing housing supply over the Core Strategy period. These include small windfall sites in the first five years post adoption. In accordance with national guidance, the supply does not include a figure for small sites in this period beyond outstanding planning permissions. However, past trends suggest that small windfall sites are a significant contributor to housing completions and the SLAA concludes that this will continue in the future. Actual completions from small site windfalls will count towards the housing target when they occur, as will rural affordable housing under Policy CS16 which cannot be counted as contributing to housing land supply until after completion.

4.2.14 The housing trajectory in Appendix 4 demonstrates that there are sufficient sites to meet the Borough's housing requirements in the first five years of the plan period post adoption (2014 – 2019). However, the Core Strategy acknowledges that there is insufficient land supply identified in the current SLAA to meet the level of housing need over the whole plan period. To address this, the Council will carry out a revised SLAA to identify additional land to meet the Borough's housing needs and maintain a five year rolling supply of deliverable sites over the plan period. This will be informed by a review of development opportunities in the existing urban area and rural settlements inset from the Green Belt and by a Green Belt boundary review. Sites that emerge from the revised SLAA will be subject to Sustainability Appraisal and will inform the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD and the housing trajectory.

4.2.15 The Green Belt boundary review will identify land that is unnecessary to keep permanently open, to provide land for development. It will also identify land for safeguarding to meet development needs beyond the plan period. The national and local purposes of including land in the Green Belt, the potential for adding land to and removing land from the Green Belt and consideration of wider sustainability principles will all be taken into account in the review process. Any changes to the Green Belt boundary will be included in the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD and shown on the Policies Map.

4.2.16 In parallel with the above, and in line with national policy, the Council will undertake a new Strategic Housing Market Assessment (SHMA). It is recognised that the outcome of such an assessment may result in a new objectively assessed housing need for the Borough, which will have implications for housing land supply. The results of this assessment will therefore inform the SLAA and any policy implications will be addressed in the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD. If the evidence from the new SHMA and/or revised SLAA show that the Borough's housing needs cannot be met in the existing urban area and rural settlements inset from the Green Belt, a review of Policy CS02 (Scale and Distribution of Development) will be undertaken.

Economy and Employment

4.2.17 The limited size and weakness of Gravesham's economy is key to the rationale for maintaining the area's supply of employment land. Research by the Institute for Policy Research in January 2012 listed the worst areas for the number of job seekers chasing every job vacancy and Gravesham was ranked at number 10 with 12 jobseekers for every vacancy. Another measure of the economy is job density which is defined as the number of jobs in an area divided by the resident population aged 16-64 in that area. A job density of 1.0 would mean that there is one job for every resident aged 16-64 even though not everybody in this age group would be in employment or actively seeking work. The latest data from the Office of National Statistics shows that the Borough's job density is much lower than the South East average of 0.80. Gravesham's job density is 0.51 compared with 0.89 for Dartford, 0.61 for Swale and 0.57 for Medway.

4.2.18 The Economy and Employment Space Study Addendum 2011 considered a range of demographic, housing and economic scenarios to provide a demand-side perspective on future employment space requirements up to 2031. This has been supplemented by a re-run of the demographic and labour supply assessment forecasts for a dwelling requirement of 6,170, which indicates that this scale of dwelling provision would increase the economically active population by 2,250 by 2028.

4.2.19 On the basis that Gravesham is seeking to substantially diversify and strengthen its economy and reduce out-commuting, it is planned to provide employment floorspace which should enable the delivery of at least 4,600 new B class jobs over the plan period. Whilst the Council recognises that jobs can be delivered from a range of sectors, the Council's focus is to ensure that there is sufficient land for B class employment, which includes offices, industrial and storage and distribution uses, and the range of job opportunities that this can provide.

4.2.20 The amount of employment floorspace required to facilitate the provision of at least 4,600 new B class jobs over the plan period and its proposed distribution is shown in Table 6. The greatest capacity for new employment development is identified in the four Opportunity Areas within the urban area, then the rest of Gravesend and Northfleet, with no new employment development identified in the rural settlements. This is consistent with the presumption in favour of sustainable development and focusing development primarily on settlements with the widest range of facilities. It is also recognised that Ebbsfleet has the potential to create significantly more new jobs beyond the plan period. This reflects the long standing and continuing strategy for the area of creating a regional hub for the location of a major business district in a mixed settlement.

4.2.21 The figures in Table 6 exclude jobs generated from non-B Class employment use classes, such as retail development, and jobs in the rural area but this is estimated to equate to around 1,500 additional jobs.

4.2.22 The rural economy of the Borough has traditionally been dependent on agriculture, and to a lesser extent forestry, but has increasingly diversified as the agricultural industry has changed in response to modern requirements. This has resulted in the re-use of existing buildings and the development of new enterprises that do not necessarily relate to traditional farm uses. The Green Belt designation has assisted in protecting the best and most versatile agricultural land and conserving soil resources and this will continue to occur. At the same time, the support for rural diversification needs to recognise the nature of the business and its potential traffic generation and other impacts.

Retail Development

4.2.23 The Retail Study Update 2012 concludes that future retail needs, as set out in table 4, should be met primarily in Gravesend town centre, with a small allowance to meet localised needs elsewhere in the Borough. This 2012 update does not take into account the latest population information from the census 2011 or the commitments at Ebbsfleet, Northfleet

Embankment West and Canal Basin because of the uncertainty of the scale and timing of delivery. A new retail study will be undertaken to take account of any revised population figures and the latest retailing trends. Any implications for the Core Strategy from this work will be considered through the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD to ensure that the needs for main town centre uses are met in full over the Plan period.

Table 4: Summary of Quantitative Retail Need

2028	Sq m
Comparison goods - net sq m	16,660
Comparison goods - gross sq m	22,210
Convenience goods - net sq m	1,620
Convenience goods - gross sq m	2,180
Total - net sq m	18,280
Total - gross sq m	24,390

Source: Retail and Commercial Leisure Background Paper December 2012

Development Distribution

Table 5: Distribution of Residential Development

	Key Sites and Other Sites	Sub-Total 2011-2028	Total 2011-2028
Northfleet Embankment & Swanscombe Peninsula East Opportunity Area	Land East of Grove Road and Robin's Creek Key Site Old Northfleet Residential Extension Key Site Northfleet Embankment East Regeneration Area Key Site Other Sites	200 530 250 50	 1,030
Gravesend Riverside East & North East Gravesend Opportunity Area	Canal Basin Regeneration Area Key Site North East Gravesend Regeneration Area Key Site	650 130	 780
Gravesend Town Centre Opportunity Area*	Heritage Quarter Key Site Other Sites	330 560	 890
Ebbsfleet (Gravesham) Opportunity Area*	Springhead Quarter Key Site Northfleet Rise Key Site	690 0	 690
Rest of Borough (Additional sites with known development potential)	Land at Coldharbour Road Key Site Other Sites (5 or more dwellings) – Urban Other Sites (5 or more dwellings) – Rural Projected completions of currently permitted schemes of 4 or less dwellings	500 850 60 140	 1,550
Borough-wide (Unidentified sites)	Small and large site windfalls Unidentified sites to be allocated in Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD	780 460	 1,240
Total		6,170	6,170
Housing Requirement		6,170	6,170

Note: Figures rounded to the nearest 10 dwellings

Total is based on un-rounded figures

* Adjusted to take into account the Ebbsfleet and Heritage Quarter Planning Permissions as at 23/08/2013

Sources: Strategic Land Availability Assessment, Gravesham Authority Monitoring Report 2012-13 (interim) May 2013

Table 6: Distribution of B Class Employment Development

	Key Sites and Other Sites	B Class Employment Floorspace sq m Gross	Anticipated Employment Generating Uses	Approximate Jobs Numbers	Total anticipated floorspace
Northfleet Embankment & Swanscombe Peninsula East Opportunity Area	Northfleet Cement Works Regeneration Area Key Site*	46,000	B1, B2, B8	1,330	133,550
	Northfleet Embankment East Regeneration Area Key Site	87,550	B1, B2, B8	940	
Gravesend Riverside East & North East Gravesend Opportunity Area	Canal Basin Regeneration Area Key Site	4,650	B1a, B1c	100	22,230
	North East Gravesend Regeneration Area Key Site	17,570	B1, B2, B8	410	
Gravesend Town Centre Opportunity Area	Heritage Quarter Key Site	300	B1a	20	5,670
	Other Sites	5,370	B1a	380	
Ebbsfleet (Gravesham) Opportunity Area	Springhead Quarter Key Site	5,000	B1a, B1b, B1c	350	20,000
	Northfleet Rise Quarter Key Site	15,000	B1a, B1b, B1c	1,060	
Rest of Urban Area (Parts of the Urban Area not covered by Opportunity Area Policies)	Land at Coldharbour Road Key Site	5,050	B1a, B1c	240	5,050
Total		186,490		4,840	186,490

Note: Figures rounded to the nearest 10 sq m and 10 jobs

*Includes approximate job numbers for Lafarge Tarmac Bulk Aggregates Import Terminal (BAIT) Northfleet but excludes BAIT floorspace figure

Sources: Economy and Employment Background Paper December 2012, Addendum to Gravesham Economy and Employment Space Study Final Report August 2013

Policy CS02: Scale and Distribution of Development

4.2.24 The development strategy for the Borough is to retain and improve the existing stock of housing and suitable employment land and to make provision for the Borough's objectively assessed need for at least 6,170 new dwellings delivered at a variable rate as follows; at least 325 dwellings per year for 2011/2012 – 2018/2019, at least 363 dwellings per year for 2019/2020 – 2023/2024, at least 438 dwellings per year 2024/2025 – 2027/2028, and at least 186,490 sq m gross employment floorspace (within use classes B1, B2 and B8) during the plan period.

4.2.25 Development will be distributed throughout the Borough as follows: around 3,890 new dwellings and around 186,490 sq m gross employment floorspace (within use classes B1, B2 and B8) will be provided in the Opportunity Areas at Northfleet Embankment and Swanscombe Peninsula East; Gravesend Riverside East and North East Gravesend; Ebbsfleet (Gravesham) and Gravesend Town Centre and on land at the Coldharbour Road Key Site; around 2,280 new dwellings will be provided on other sites in the urban area and rural settlements inset from the Green Belt.

4.2.26 The strategy prioritises development in the urban area as a sustainable location for development. This will be achieved by:

- Promoting regeneration by prioritising the redevelopment and recycling of underused, derelict and previously developed land in the urban area. This will be principally through redevelopment of former industrial sites in the Opportunity Areas of Northfleet Embankment and Swanscombe Peninsula East, and Gravesend Riverside East and North East Gravesend to create new residential neighbourhoods and employment areas;
- The continued development of a new sustainable mixed use community in the Ebbsfleet (Gravesham) Opportunity Area, which will include the provision of high quality employment floorspace;
- Revitalising the Gravesend Town Centre Opportunity Area as a focal point for retail, leisure, cultural and tourism facilities and small scale office provision to serve the needs of the Borough whilst preserving and enhancing its character as a riverside heritage town; and
- Bringing forward a range of suitable sites in other parts of the urban area for residential and employment
- development, including Land at Coldharbour Road Key Site.

4.2.27 In the rural area, development will be supported within those rural settlements inset from the Green Belt and defined on the Policies Map. Development outside those settlements, including affordable housing and proposals to maintain and diversify the rural economy, will be supported where it is compatible with national policies for protecting the Green Belt and policies in this plan. The extent of the Green Belt is defined on the Policies Map. A strategic Green Belt boundary review will be undertaken

to identify additional land to meet the housing needs up to 2028 and to safeguard areas of land to meet development needs beyond the plan period, while maintaining the national and local planning purposes of the Green Belt.

4.3 Opportunity Areas in Gravesham

Introduction

4.3.1 Four Opportunity Areas in the urban area are identified in this Core Strategy which give it resilience and flexibility whilst showing where most change within the Borough will occur over the plan period. Within the Opportunity Areas are a number of Key Sites which are strategic site allocations. The Key Sites have the capacity to deliver new housing, employment and retail development to meet most of the Borough's needs over the plan period. Both the Opportunity Areas and the Key Sites are shown on the Policies Map. The Opportunity Areas are also shown on the Key Diagram. The Key Sites are accompanied by schematic plans which provide an indication of the main principles to be applied to each site in accordance with the policy. These schematic plans are located after each of the Opportunity Area policies.

4.3.2 The concept of Opportunity Areas has been developed by the Council to establish a broad framework within which development can take place and an overall vision can be realised. The Opportunity Areas together form a significant regeneration area in the Thames Gateway, extending along the whole of the urban riverside and its hinterland and occupying almost a third of the built up area of Gravesham.

4.3.3 This Core Strategy aims to transform and revitalise previously developed land, strengthen the vitality and vibrancy of Gravesend as the Borough's principal town centre and create modern, integrated, accessible and sustainable communities which meet the full range of people's needs and aspirations.

4.3.4 Within this area opportunities have been recognised, not only for the development of nine Key Sites during the plan period, but also for the maintenance, improvement and development of adjoining sites as part of a comprehensive approach, which will benefit both existing and new communities. The concept of opportunity goes further, recognising the development potential of Swanscombe Peninsula and Ebbsfleet, which will carry the regeneration process beyond the plan period and beyond the boundaries of Gravesham as part of a longer term, sub-regional vision.

4.3.5 Whilst the Opportunity Areas have characteristics which are specific to them, they have a number of issues in common. The section below is included to avoid repetition in the Opportunity Area policies. It should be noted that other Core Strategy policies also apply. All policies in the Development Plan should be taken into account in the consideration of development proposals.

Common Issues

4.3.6 The proposed developments on the Key Sites within the Opportunity Areas are of a scale that they will have a significant impact on their localities. They will need to be carefully planned and phased to ensure that they are well integrated with and maximise benefits for the existing communities as well as providing for the needs of new communities. In some cases, development will result in the provision of new services such as schools and open space which will benefit existing and new communities. In other cases, transport infrastructure will be required to provide links between new and existing communities, e.g. bus services, footpaths. Policies CS10, CS11, CS12 and CS13 on Physical and Social Infrastructure, Transport, Green Infrastructure and Green Space, Sport and Recreation will apply.

4.3.7 The Opportunity Areas all lie within areas where there is a potential risk of flooding which is a major constraint on the type and form of development that can be accommodated. Policy CS18 on Climate Change sets out the relevant requirements for developments in areas at risk of flooding and the requirements in relation to surface water run-off and Sustainable Drainage Systems (SUDs).

4.3.8 On all the Key Sites, the scale of development will be such that developments should take the opportunity to deliver carbon reduction, renewable energy and water efficiency measures in accordance with Policy CS18 on Climate Change.

4.3.9 The Opportunity Areas all contain heritage interest including listed buildings, conservation areas, and scheduled monuments. These are referred to where relevant in the background text to the policies. It is important that the development of the Key Sites ensures that the heritage features are preserved, or enhanced and interpreted in accordance with Policy CS20 on Heritage and the Historic Environment.

4.3.10 Three of the Opportunity Areas are located alongside the River Thames and there are specific issues which apply to them. Within these areas, there will be a need to:

- Maintain, improve and replace tidal flood defences in line with the Thames Estuary 2100 plan (see Policy CS18 on Climate Change);
- Facilitate the creation of a high quality, dedicated pedestrian and cycle link alongside the River Thames, as part of the proposed Thames Estuary Path, or, where this is not possible due to the nature of riverside activity, as close as possible to it (see Policy CS12 on Green Infrastructure and Policy CS11 on Transport); and
- Safeguard the capacity of commercial wharves and other sites needed to support the River Thames as a working waterway (see Policy CS07 on Economy, Employment and Skills, and CS11 on Transport)



Figure 3: Opportunity Areas within Gravesham

4.4 Northfleet Embankment and Swanscombe Peninsula East Opportunity Area

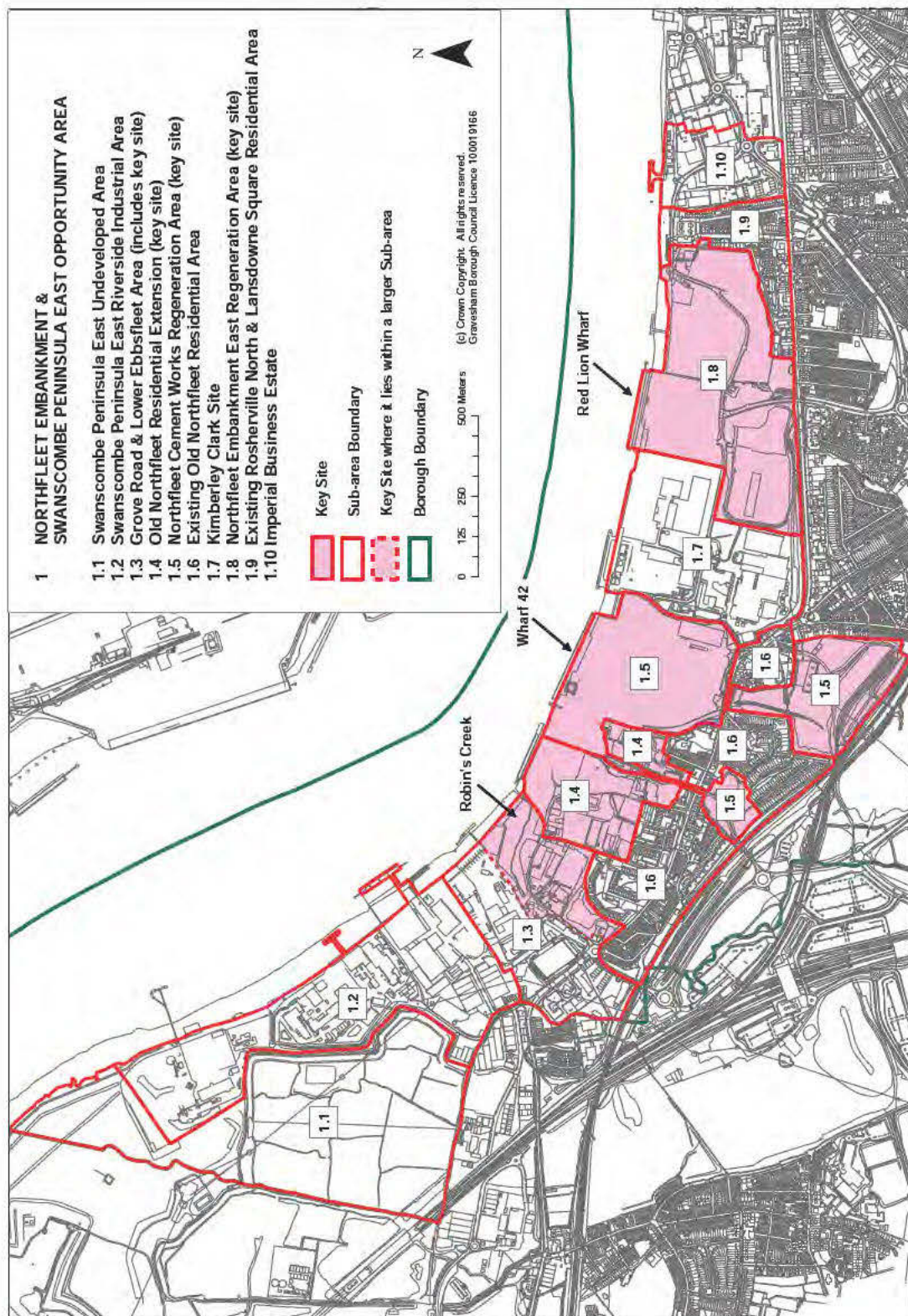


Figure 4: Northfleet Embankment and Swanscombe Peninsula East Opportunity Area

4.4.1 The Northfleet Embankment and Swanscombe Peninsula East Opportunity Area

lies on the Thames waterfront and extends around four kilometres from the boundary with Dartford Borough in the west to the Gravesend Town Centre Opportunity Area in the east. Much of the area is characterised by its industrial past, with deep chalk workings that once supported the local cement industry creating abrupt changes in level and dividing the older settlements on higher ground from the river below. The riverside quarries once accommodated a variety of heavy industrial uses but these have largely disappeared, leaving an area that is environmentally degraded and with many vacant or under-used sites. There are clear opportunities in this location to make more efficient use of the land, facilitate river-related activity, accommodate new development and secure environmental improvement as part of the wider regeneration of the area. Figure 4 shows the main sub-areas comprising this Opportunity Area.

4.4.2 Most of this Opportunity Area (with the exception of sub-areas 1.6 and 1.9) is within the Northfleet Industrial Air Quality Management Area which was declared because of high levels of particulate matter, i.e. dust, arising from uncontrolled emissions from industrial processes. The closure of the Northfleet Cement works has removed a major source of dust, but current activities and the open nature of some of the area mean that it remains a potential issue. It will be important to take account of air quality in bringing forward any development of the area and a key objective will be to secure continued improvements to air quality through the redevelopment and environmental improvement of sites.

4.4.3 Swanscombe Peninsula East Undeveloped Area (sub-area 1.1) is a large area of land that projects northwards into a bend of the River Thames on the boundary between the Boroughs of Dartford and Gravesham. It is mainly low lying and comprises a mixture of residual marsh used for agriculture/grazing and raised ground. The development potential is likely to be constrained by:

- Transport and access - the Gravesham side of the peninsula is only served by a single junction onto the A226 at Galley Hill Road, a private access road on its eastern periphery, and the unmade Lower Road private lane to the south;
- Ground conditions - the northern part of the peninsula has been raised using Cement Kiln Dust and the southern part in Gravesham is former marsh;
- Proximity to existing industrial uses - the eastern side of the peninsula in Gravesham is occupied by heavy and port related industries that may impede development nearby;
- Biodiversity - although not subject to any designation, the marshes and mudflats provide important habitats and the biodiversity interest would need to be taken into consideration;
- Utilities - the Gravesham part of the peninsula is crossed by high voltage power lines forming part of the National Grid;
- Navigation - the northern part of the peninsula is affected by navigational sight line, radar and telecommunication constraints; and
- Railways - the High Speed 1 (HS1) railway line effectively severs the southern part of the marsh before going into tunnel and passing under the River Thames.

4.4.4 The Council considers that there is development potential at Swanscombe Peninsula. However, the constraints and the absence of any definitive proposals showing how they could be overcome suggest that any development in this area is only likely to be deliverable in the longer term. As a result, any development should come forward using a comprehensive masterplan approach that has regard to proposals for the Dartford part of the peninsula, development phasing and the possible need for a new highway link to relieve the existing A226 and improve accessibility to the peninsula. The presumption is that any development in this sub-area is most likely to comprise industrial/commercial uses together with greenspace to protect the biodiversity of the area. Residential development is not ruled out as part of a mixed use development of the site but would need to overcome the constraints and provide a sustainable form of development that integrates well with the adjoining urban areas.

4.4.5 Swanscombe Peninsula East Riverside Industrial Area (sub-area 1.2) comprises mainly industrial and port-related uses that sit behind the existing tidal flood defences. Access to this area is from the junction with the A226 at Galley Hill Road and a narrow privately maintained road. It is anticipated that this area will remain in active employment uses over the plan period. The retention and expansion of industrial and port related employment in this area will be supported.

4.4.6 Grove Road and Lower Ebbsfleet Area (sub-area 1.3) consists of a number of separate sites that have regeneration potential. These may be realised during or beyond the plan period depending on the aspirations of the landowners and the viability of development. Viability is likely to be influenced by the relative success of the Ebbsfleet development to the south. The development potential of this area is likely to be further constrained by:

- Ground conditions - the area has been actively used for industrial purposes for over 200 years and is likely to be subject to contamination;
- Heritage and archaeology - the area around Robin's Creek (outflow of the Ebbsfleet into the Thames) was the site of a medieval watermill later converted to grind cement in the 1790s, Portland cement was later invented here and Aspdin's Kiln (Scheduled Monument) and other features of heritage interest are likely to remain; and
- Existing uses - development of sites on a piecemeal basis is likely to be constrained by the proximity of existing poor neighbours (including the importation and processing of minerals at Robin's Wharf) or the need to retain/decant existing uses (including the local football ground).

4.4.7 Part of this sub-area has the potential for residentially-led regeneration to complement the proposal to extend the existing residential development in sub-area 1.4 (see paragraphs 4.4.9 and 4.4.10) and this is identified as a key site. Initial estimates suggest that this area could deliver around 200 new homes. Such development would be expected to: improve and enhance Robin's Creek and the Ebbsfleet stream; improve the greening of this area; and reduce the heavy commercial traffic and parking on Grove Road.

4.4.8 The Council supports the creation of a new navigable harbour for recreational purposes at Robin's Creek as this has the potential to create a high quality development, add value to other developments in the vicinity and contribute to the re-establishment of Northfleet as an historic riverside settlement. This would be subject to ensuring that the drainage functions of the Creek and its biodiversity interest are not adversely affected and that there is no potential conflict between recreational boats and commercial shipping on the river, and other proposals in the Opportunity Area.

4.4.9 Old Northfleet Residential Extension (sub-area 1.4) comprises an area of previously developed land extending northwards from The Hive local centre down College Road to the River Thames. A separate spur of land, divided from the main area by a cutting that carries the access road to the former cement works site from Thames Way (A226), extends northwards from the existing residential area down the former alignment of Lawn Road.

4.4.10 This area is identified as a Key Site. The Council's approach to this area is that residential development will be supported as it forms a logical extension to the existing established community of Northfleet and will re-connect it with the River Thames. This will include an extension to the Hive local centre and facilities to support the development. There is a resolution to grant planning permission for such use.

4.4.11 Northfleet Cement Works Regeneration Area (sub-area 1.5) consists of the remainder of the former Lafarge cement works site and lies at a lower level than the adjoining residential community on the banks of the River Thames. Access to the site is primarily via a road tunnel from the A226 Thames Way that passes through Vineyard Pit. A rail connection to the North Kent line has also been reinstated via Church Path Pit, a connected site to the south, which has the potential to be extended to sub-areas 1.7 (Kimberly Clark) and 1.8 (Northfleet Embankment East) in due course. There is also good deep water access via the existing Wharf 42.

4.4.12 This area is identified as a Key Site. There is a resolution to grant planning permission for around 46,000 sq m gross employment floorspace for business, industrial and storage and distribution uses under use classes B1, B2 and B8. In conjunction with this, listed building consent has also been given for the dismantling, relocation and reassembly of the Grade II listed Bevan's War Memorial. The other Grade II listed building in the vicinity of the site is the Northfleet Lower Lighthouse located at the eastern end of Wharf 42. The lighthouse is expected to remain in its present position and retain its industrial setting. The Port of London Authority also has an important navigational installation on-site, on the former cement works office block.

4.4.13 A planning permission also exists for the use of part of the site as a Bulk Aggregates Import Terminal, whilst a major cement importing facility has been created through the conversion of the former cement works coal store. In the short term, much of the site will be used for the importation and onward transshipment of Crossrail spoil. In the longer term, it is anticipated that the employment development will come forward.

4.4.14 Old Northfleet Residential Area (sub-area 1.6) comprises a series of residential neighbourhoods and the local centres at The Hill and The Hive. The area around The Hill forms part of a conservation area. The area around The Hive was rebuilt during the 1960s, along with Huggins College and Wallis Park. As a result, the area lost much of its distinctive character as an historic riverside industrial town associated with the early development of the cement industry. The loss of residential and other development to the northern end of College Road, along with the impounding of Robin's Creek in the 1980s by the creation of a new flood defence, effectively completed the severance of this community from the River Thames.

4.4.15 Although linked together by the line of the B2175 Northfleet High Street, the different parts of Old Northfleet are separated by deep chalk workings that make the area quite disjointed. Whilst there is a limited range of facilities in this location to serve the local community, it suffers from high levels of deprivation and would benefit from a co-ordinated approach to improvement. A recent award of Big Lottery Funding provides an opportunity to draw the community together and establish local priorities for investment.

4.4.16 The Council supports the improvement of the local centres to meet the needs of the local community. It will also require new development to be well integrated with the existing residential neighbourhoods. This includes improving connectivity with the Ebbsfleet development to the south and public access to the River Thames and Robin's Creek to the north.

4.4.17 Kimberly Clark site (sub-area 1.7) comprises a flat area of land set at a low level adjoining the River Thames. It is separated from the Northfleet Cement Works Regeneration Area to the west by the chalk spine of Granby Road. The site is currently occupied by the Kimberly Clark tissue mill and associated buildings. The deep water wharf is used for the import of raw materials used in tissue manufacture and the transhipment of other goods.

4.4.18 It is anticipated that this use will continue beyond the plan period and the Council will support its continued operation and expansion. The Council will also support the extension of a heavy rail connection with the Lafarge Tarmac site (in sub-area 1.5) to allow Kimberly Clark and the Northfleet Embankment East Regeneration Area access to the North Kent and High Speed railway lines.

4.4.19 Northfleet Embankment East Regeneration Area (sub-area 1.8) comprises a relatively flat area of land set at a low level adjoining the River Thames lying to the north of a tall chalk cliff face. Road access to this area is primarily via Rosherville Way and Thames Way under a chalk spine carrying the B2175 London Road. Whilst much of the site is currently cleared and empty, the area has a long industrial past and was last occupied by the former Northfleet Power Station and AEI Cable Works (TT Electronics). STEMA Aggregates continue to operate from Red Lion Wharf in the north western part of the area, taking advantage of the deep water jetty that once served the power station. The Council supports the principle of mixed use development in this sub-area and hence its identification as a Key Site.

4.4.20 A distribution warehouse facility of around 40,000 sq m gross floorspace on land west of Rosherville Way and south of Crete Hall Road has recently been built.

4.4.21 Land levels are currently being raised on the former AEI Cable Works site and part of the former Power Station site. This will take it out of the flood risk zone. The Homes and Communities Agency is developing a masterplan for this site to promote its development for a multimodal industrial and warehousing facility based on the heavy rail connection (see paragraph 4.4.18) and the availability of deep water wharfage. The site is expected to deliver a significant volume of jobs and is therefore important in achieving an improved balance between housing and jobs in Gravesham, irrespective of the rail connection. Whilst the multimodal terminal remains the Council's preferred option, it is necessary at this stage to retain a degree of flexibility given identified constraints and the need to agree a detailed masterplan. For example, the alignment of the railway may have implications for the operation of STEMA Aggregates at Red Lion Wharf. However, it is anticipated that this constraint could be overcome as the design, mix and layout of the site evolves. Should this not prove possible, the Council will seek to ensure, as a minimum, that sufficient minerals capacity is maintained through appropriate alternative provision, so that wider regeneration initiatives do not prejudice the parallel requirements of the Kent Minerals and Waste Local Plan. This approach is consistent with Policies CS07 (Economy, Employment and Skills) and CS11 (Transport).

4.4.22 The eastern part of the sub-area is expected to accommodate residential development reinforcing the existing Rosherville North and Lansdowne Square Residential Area (sub-area 1.9). A buffer zone comprising open space, landscaping and office/light industrial employment or other appropriate uses will be required between this and the multimodal industrial and warehousing facility to the west.

4.4.23 The north eastern part of the site is within the Lansdowne Square Conservation Area which includes the former Art Deco AEI office block. This is likely to form part of the residential component of the redevelopment of the site and any proposals will need to protect and enhance its setting. The Grade II listed Rosherville Quay Walls, steps, drawdock and World War II mine watching post lie within sub-area 1.9 to the east. The Council will seek the restoration of the listed remains of Rosherville Pier with links to new public open space as part of the development of this site.

4.4.24 The Council supports the principle of development likely to come forward as a result of the existing planning permissions and the emerging masterplan. Current estimates are that this could comprise around 250 new dwellings and around 87,550 sq m (gross) of B1, B2 and B8 employment floorspace.

4.4.25 Existing Rosherville North and Lansdowne Square Residential Area (sub-area 1.9) consists mainly of an existing residential area that sits on a chalk spine above the River Thames and the former quarries to the east and west. Lansdowne Square is a conservation area and the southern part of the sub-area lies within The Overcliffe Conservation Area. The listed Rosherville Pier is referred to under sub-area 1.8.

4.4.26 It is unlikely that this area will be subject to substantial change over the plan period. However, adjoining development should be designed to improve connectivity and access to the riverside so that existing residents benefit from improvements to community facilities to be provided.

4.4.27 Imperial Business Estate (sub-area 1.10) mainly comprises an existing 1980s industrial estate. It is a busy employment area that is anticipated to remain in-situ over the plan period. A small undeveloped area adjacent to the western end of the former Clifton Marine Parade, the White House offices and Imperial Wharf complete the site. Except for possible rounding-off of employment uses, it is not anticipated that this sub-area will be subject to substantial change over the plan period. Subject to the need for planning permission, the Council will support proposals for bringing Imperial Wharf back into a river based use that is appropriate to context.

Policy CS03: Northfleet Embankment and Swanscombe Peninsula East Opportunity Area

4.4.28 The Northfleet Embankment and Swanscombe Peninsula East Opportunity Area is a substantial opportunity for major riverside regeneration in Gravesham. Development will bring significant benefits to existing adjoining residential communities and the Borough as a whole through the delivery of new housing and jobs whilst achieving environmental improvement, especially in air quality, and a high standard of design.

4.4.29 Any future proposals for the Swanscombe Peninsula East Undeveloped Area will be subject to a comprehensive masterplan approach which deals with the issues of flood risk, transport and access, ground conditions, proximity to existing industrial uses, air quality, biodiversity, utilities, navigation and the presence of the HS1 railway line.

4.4.30 The Swanscombe Peninsula East Riverside Industrial Area, Kimberly Clark Site and Imperial Business Estate will be retained in employment use. The Council will support proposals which expand and support their operation.

4.4.31 The Council will support the regeneration for residential and employment uses of the Grove Road and Lower Ebbsfleet Area taking into account the ground conditions and existing uses.

4.4.32 Development of the Key Sites will lead to the provision of around 980 dwellings and around 133,500 sq m gross employment floorspace. Development on the Key Sites will be in accordance with the principles set out below.

Land East of Grove Road and Robin's Creek Key Site (within sub-area 1.3)

4.4.33 This will provide a residentially led mixed use development with the potential to create around 200 dwellings. Such development will be expected to: improve and enhance Robin's Creek and the Ebbsfleet stream; improve greenspace; and reduce heavy commercial traffic and parking on Grove Road.

Old Northfleet Residential Extension Key Site (sub-area 1.4)

4.4.34 This will provide a residential development of around 530 dwellings, open space, an extension and improvements to the Hive local centre and provision of community facilities.

Northfleet Cement Works Regeneration Area Key Site (sub-area 1.5)

4.4.35 This will provide an employment development of around 46,000 sq m gross new employment floorspace comprising business, industrial, and storage and distribution facilities (use classes B1, B2 and B8) and a Bulk Aggregates Import Terminal. Such development will be required to satisfactorily relocate Bevan's War Memorial.

Northfleet Embankment East Regeneration Area Key Site (sub-area 1.8)

4.4.36 This will provide an employment led development of around 87,550 sq m gross new employment floorspace including a major industrial and warehousing development (use classes B1, B2 and B8) with multimodal access, subject to masterplanning and overcoming identified constraints. It will also provide around 250 dwellings at the eastern end of the site which will reinforce the existing adjacent residential areas. A buffer zone comprising open space, landscaping and business development (use class B1) will be required between the residential development and the industrial and warehousing development. Such development should seek to restore the listed remains of Rosherville Pier and maintain an east-west route for public transport and general traffic accessing the Imperial Business and Retail Estate and Gravesend town centre. Proposals for the Key Site will be required to retain Red Lion Wharf for commercial river based use that is appropriate to context, subject to capacity for the transhipment of minerals being maintained through appropriate alternative provision off-site.



Figure 5: Key Site 1.3 Land East of Grove Road and Robin's Creek Schematic Plan

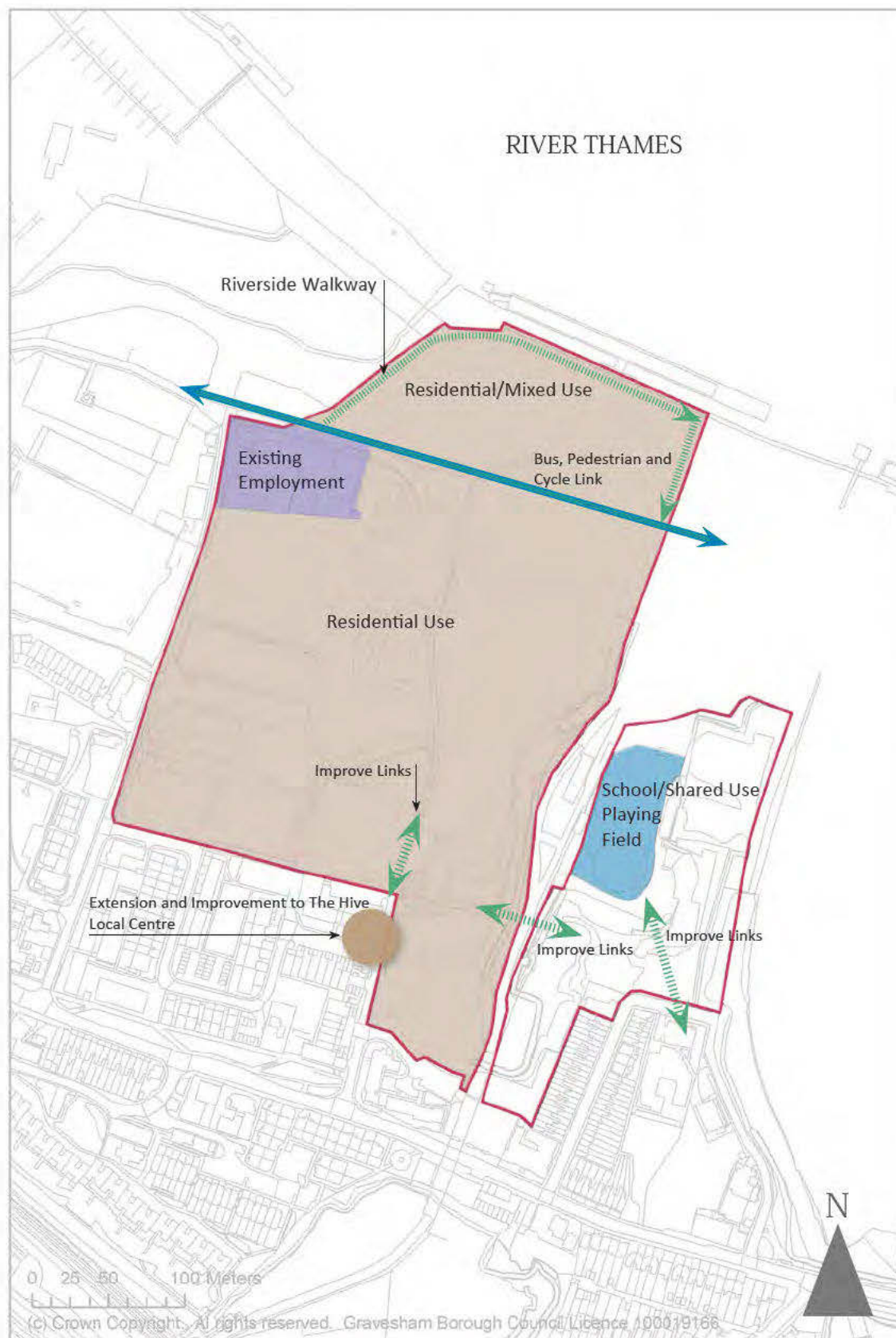


Figure 6: Key Site 1.4 Old Northfleet Residential Extension Schematic Plan

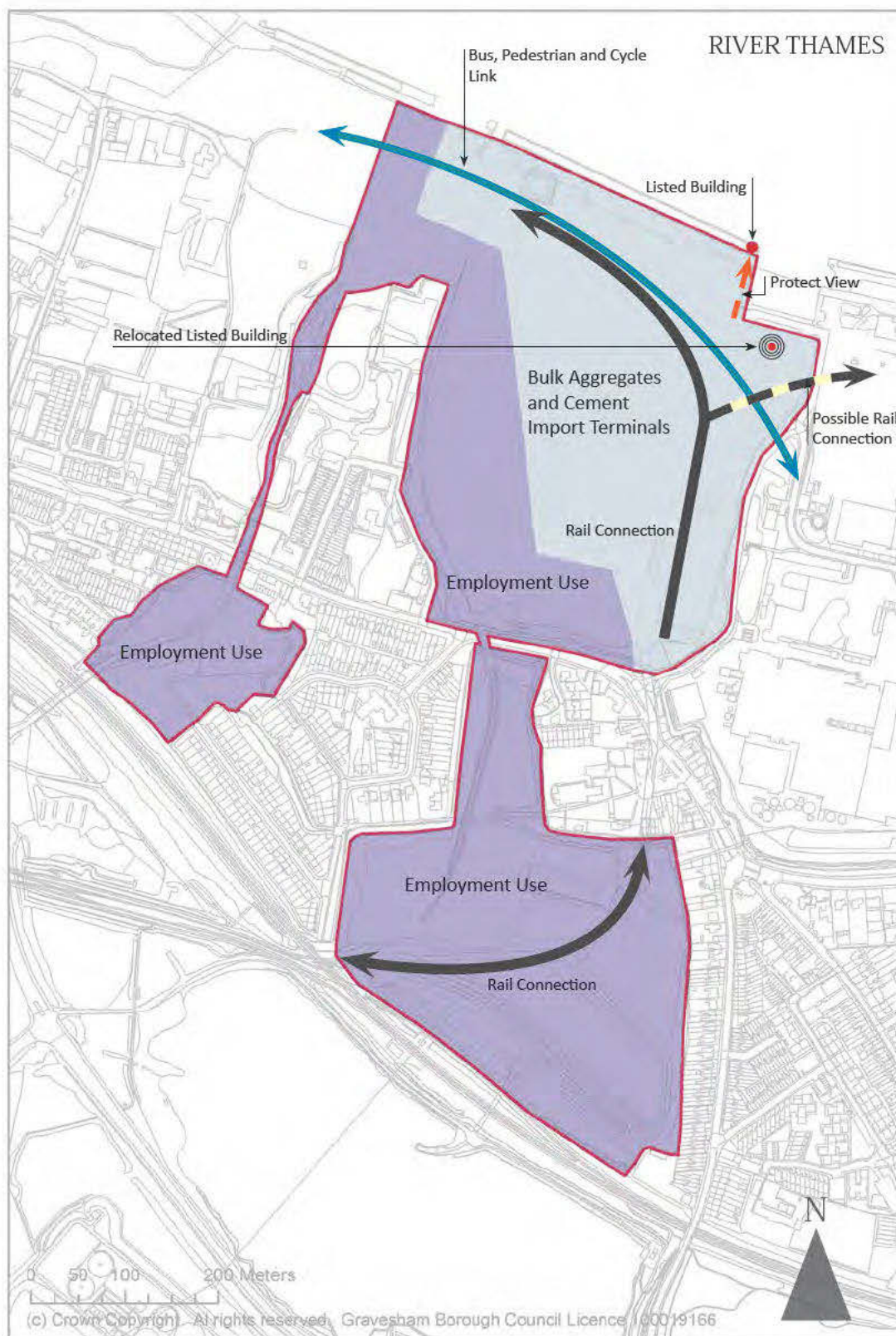


Figure 7: Key Site 1.5 Northfleet Cement Works Regeneration Area Schematic Plan

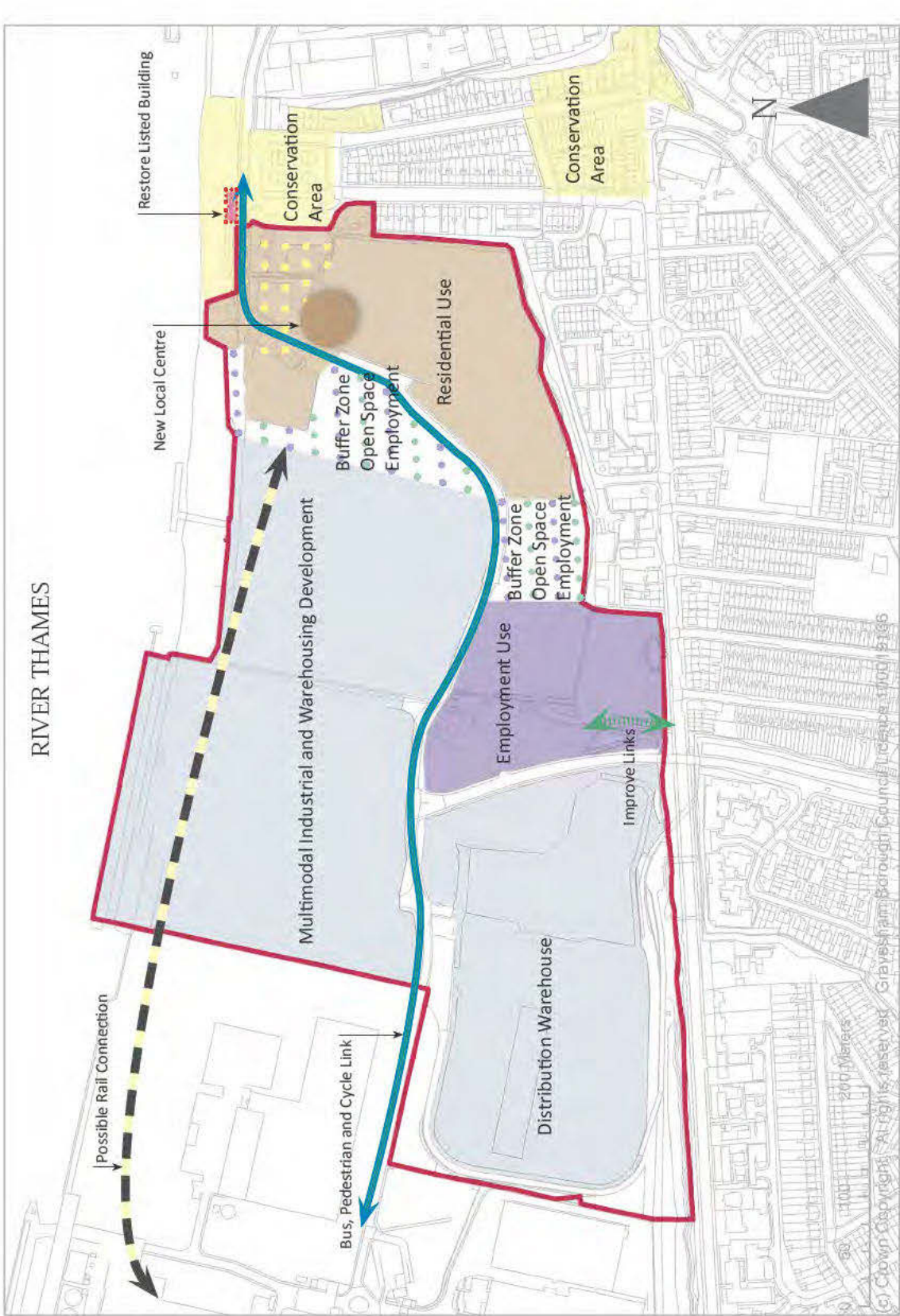


Figure 8: Key Site 1.8 Northfleet Embankment East Regeneration Area Schematic Plan

4.5 Gravesend Riverside East and North East Gravesend Opportunity Area

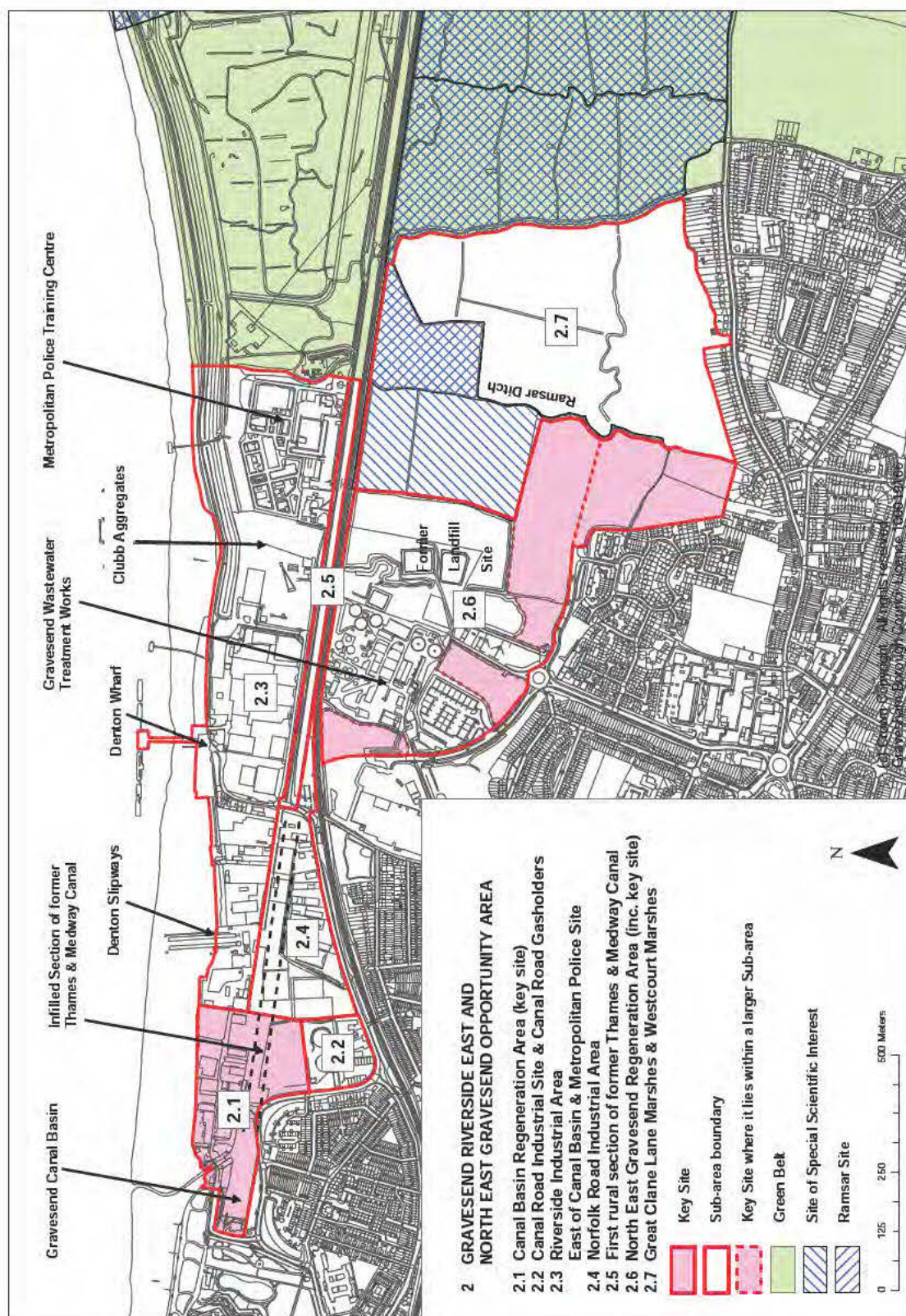


Figure 9: Gravesend Riverside East and North East Gravesend Opportunity Area

4.5.1 The **Gravesend Riverside East and North East Gravesend Opportunity Area** lies immediately to the east of Gravesend town centre, extending around 1.8 kilometres along the waterfront to the boundary of the urban area with the Metropolitan Green Belt. Included within this area is land to the south of the North Kent Railway line, surrounding the Gravesend Wastewater Treatment Works, and north of existing residential development at Northcourt Estate and Dalefield Way. To the east, still south of the railway, lies the remainder of the Westcourt Marshes and Great Clane Lane Marshes. Part of this area is included within the South Thames Estuary Site of Special Scientific Interest (SSSI) and the Thames Estuary and Marshes Ramsar Site which means that it is of significant biodiversity value.

4.5.2 A number of existing uses constrain the type and form of development likely to be acceptable in this Opportunity Area. These include the Gravesend Wastewater Treatment Works, the Metropolitan Police Training Centre and the Canal Road Gasholders. There are also a number of existing uses which demand a waterfront location because of the types of activity undertaken. These include the Denton Wharf (Port of London Authority), Denton Slipways (Ship Repairs) and Clubb's Wharf (Marine Dredged Aggregates). Notwithstanding these constraints, this area provides opportunities to continue the successful regeneration of the Canal Basin, make more efficient use of the land, facilitate river-related activity, accommodate new development and secure environmental improvement as part of the wider regeneration of the area. Figure 9 shows the main sub-areas comprising this Opportunity Area.

4.5.3 Due to the severance effect of the railway and the Thames and Medway Canal, the area to the east of the Canal Basin and north of the railway is served almost entirely from the Ordnance Road junction which links to the Gravesend town centre one-way system. This is a major constraint on what development and uses can be accommodated on the riverside because of the highway capacity, particularly at the junction, and any potential adverse environmental impacts of increased traffic on air quality. The Ordnance Road/Canal Road route is also a designated National Low Loader Route. This will also need to be taken into account in any development proposals. At North East Gravesend, capacity constraints at the junction of Dering Way and the Lion Roundabout will also need to be considered as well as impacts upon the wider highway network.

4.5.4 The Opportunity Area is in close proximity to the Thames Estuary and Marshes Special Protection Area (SPA) and Ramsar site to the east which are of international biodiversity importance, particularly for birds. Recent evidence suggests that there has been a decline in bird populations in the internationally significant Special Protection Areas (SPA) and Ramsar sites that make up the North Kent Marshes (Thames Estuary and Marshes SPA/Ramsar Site, Medway Estuary and Marshes SPA/Ramsar Site, and The Swale SPA/Ramsar Site). There is currently insufficient evidence to adequately assess the cause of this decline although interim findings indicate that recreational activity causes disturbance to birds and that more development will lead to an increase in disturbance. Further work is being carried out by the North Kent Environmental Planning Group (NKEPG) in relation to this matter. In the meantime, a precautionary approach to development will be applied. This means that developers may need to provide or contribute to mitigation measures for the recreation needs arising from their

developments, which may include provision of alternative greenspace, contributions to visitor control mechanisms and/or management of the SPAs, to ensure that detrimental impacts on the integrity of the SPAs/Ramsar sites are avoided.

4.5.5 There are important links for walkers and cyclists that connect Gravesend town centre with the North Kent Marshes beyond Mark Lane. These include the Saxon Shore Way long distance path and the National Cycle Route 1 (NCR 1). These routes are currently of poor quality in a number of places but still very well used and the Council supports their upgrading as part of the Green Infrastructure and transport network. Policies CS11 on Transport and CS12 on Green Infrastructure are also relevant.

4.5.6 Considerable progress has been made in restoring and upgrading the Thames and Medway Canal as a contribution to the Green Infrastructure network. The section between the Canal Basin and Mark Lane has been infilled and the Council is seeking the reinstatement of this part of the canal where this is shown to be feasible. Where cost precludes reinstatement at the time development takes place, the design will be required to facilitate future reinstatement.

4.5.7 Canal Basin Regeneration Area (sub-area 2.1) comprises the Canal Basin itself and the area lying north of the gasholders as far east as the Denton Slipways site. The Canal Basin has been restored as part of the first phase of redevelopment of the area and is in active use as a boating marina. This complements the recreational function of the Riverside Leisure Area to the west and is the type of marine related use that the Council would wish to see expand.

4.5.8 To the north and east of the Canal Basin lies an area that is currently in general employment use. The buildings are mainly old and in poor condition, with much of the land used for open storage. It has long been recognised that this area has potential for regeneration and it is shown as a Key Site. The Council's approach to this area is that mixed use regeneration that complements the development which has already taken place to the south of the Canal Basin will continue to be supported. This will comprise a mix of residential and business uses that have regard to the constraints imposed by its location in a flood risk area and the proximity of gasholders at Canal Road. A range of shops and services to serve the development and the existing residential area to the south should be included. Planning permission has been granted for these uses.

4.5.9 The Canal Basin along with the locks, swing bridge and other associated features are Grade II listed. There are thought to be significant buried archaeological remains associated with the canal, early railway, previous industrial uses and Albion Baths. It is also thought that there is a war grave containing the remains of Flight Sergeant Eric Williams from a World War Two crash site around Albion Parade. These features will need to be investigated and the heritage interest preserved and interpreted. The Canal Basin was a maritime hub and, as such, is within the Gravesend Riverside Conservation Area. Any proposals will need to preserve and/or enhance the character or appearance of the conservation area.

4.5.10 Canal Road Industrial Site and Canal Road Gasholders (sub-area 2.2) comprises an area of land immediately south of the Canal Basin Regeneration Area. It is primarily in employment use. The presence of the gasholders is a major constraint on the potential redevelopment of the area as they have health and safety implications. It is understood that these are likely to remain in-situ over the plan period.

4.5.11 The Council considers that this area is likely to remain in active employment use over the plan period and the presence of the gasholders would largely preclude the introduction of residentially-led mixed use regeneration.

4.5.12 Riverside Industrial Area East of Canal Basin and Metropolitan Police Site (sub-area 2.3) comprises an extensive tract of riverside land extending 1,300 metres east of the Canal Basin Regeneration Area along Wharf Road and to the east of Mark Lane, north of the alignment of the former Thames and Medway Canal. It is currently well occupied by a range of business and other uses.

4.5.13 Denton Slipways is a significant river-related facility which should be retained as it provides a range of services supporting water-borne transport and business on the wider River Thames. The Metropolitan Police Training Centre at Mark Lane and the Port of London's Denton Wharf and Denton Slipways (ship repairs) also provide facilities that are strategically important. Clubb's Wharf is an important facility for the importation of marine dredged aggregates.

4.5.14 The council's approach is that the current role of the area should continue over the plan period and support will be given to proposals that improve the environment of the area. The above strategic uses will be given protection from the encroachment of sensitive uses that may impede their operation.

4.5.15 It is understood that the Port of London Authority is currently considering the possibility of creating a Centre of Marine Excellence based on Denton Wharf and adjoining land. This could help to deliver further river-related services and diversify the local economy in the marine sector. The Council supports the expansion of such marine related employment uses that make active use of the waterfront between Denton Slipways and Denton Wharf.

4.5.16 Norfolk Road Industrial Area (sub-area 2.4) comprises the area lying south of the alignment of the former Thames and Medway Canal extending from the Canal Road Industrial Site and the Canal Road Gasholders site 450 metres to the east to Mark Lane. It is currently well occupied by a range of business uses.

4.5.17 The current role of this area should continue over the plan period as it is an important component of existing employment land supply. Proposals to improve the environment of the area will be supported.

4.5.18 The first rural section of the former Thames and Medway Canal (sub-area 2.5)

comprises a restored section of waterway lying immediately north of the North Kent Railway to the east of Mark Lane. The depth of channel has been increased as part of a publicly funded project and a pumping system installed to maintain water levels.

4.5.19 Whilst this part of the canal is not navigable, it is important for the contribution it makes towards the Green Infrastructure network. The northern tow-path carries the vehicular access to the Metropolitan Police Training Centre and the route is well used as part of the public rights of way network and National Cycle Route 1. This part of the canal has been designated as a Local Wildlife Site.

4.5.20 The canal should be maintained in its current form and progressively restored as resources permit. Proposals that result in its loss will be resisted given its biodiversity, amenity and local heritage value.

4.5.21 North East Gravesend Regeneration Area (sub-area 2.6) comprises all the land lying south of the North Kent Railway and north of Dalefield Way and Dering Way. A proposed extension to the residential area south of Dalefield Way is also included within this sub-area.

4.5.22 This sub-area includes the Gravesend Wastewater Treatment Works which causes some odour issues. Parts of the sub-area are also subject to noise pollution from the shooting range to the east of the Metropolitan Police Training Centre. This means that the location and type of development in this area will need to have regard to odour nuisance and noise pollution. This sub-area also includes a former landfill site. This is likely to be subject to contamination which would make it unsuitable for built development without significant remediation.

4.5.23 This sub-area abuts the Site of Special Scientific Interest (SSSI) and the Ramsar site which are important for their nature conservation interest. As outlined in paragraph 4.5.4, it will be imperative that developers address and mitigate any detrimental impacts on biodiversity.

4.5.24 Whilst some commercial development has occurred at the Lion Business Park immediately south of the Wastewater Treatment Works, this has yet to be completed. Other sites to the east and west have been allocated for employment use in the past and a number benefit from extant planning permissions. These sites are allocated for employment use as they are important to the future delivery of jobs in accordance with the strategy. Therefore, they are shown as part of the Key Site.

4.5.25 There is a planning permission for residential use on land to the east of the existing residential area at Dalefield Way. This will make an important contribution to housing land supply over the plan period and is also shown as part of the Key Site.

4.5.26 Both the employment and residential components will be expected to meet the open space needs of workers and residents on-site and incorporate suitable boundary treatments to

reduce the risk of recreational pressure on the adjacent protected sites of nature conservation value.

4.5.27 Great Clane Lane Marshes and Westcourt Marshes (sub-area 2.7) comprises an area of largely undeveloped marshland lying between the Green Belt boundary and the North East Gravesend Regeneration Area. Westcourt Marshes is part of the South Thames Estuary and Marshes SSSI and the biodiversity value of this area has been damaged by past operations. Some of the sub-area (including a ditch extending southwards along the boundary of sub-area 2.6) also forms part of the Thames Estuary and Marshes Ramsar site.

4.5.28 The proposals for residential and industrial development at the eastern end of Dalefield Way in the North East Gravesend Regeneration Area, including the restoration of the damaged part of Westcourt Marshes SSSI to a more favourable condition, are supported.

4.5.29 The Thames Estuary 2100 Flood Risk Management Plan (see Policy CS18 on Climate Change) includes the proposal for a new north-south flood defence across the marshes to the north east of Gravesend. The alignment and form of this are not yet known. Given this and the significant biodiversity value of the area, the Council's approach is that this area should remain undeveloped over the plan period.

Policy CS04: Gravesend Riverside East and North East Gravesend Opportunity Area

4.5.30 The Gravesend Riverside East and North East Gravesend Opportunity Area will be the subject of riverside regeneration complemented by additional development to the south of the railway which improve the poor urban environment and make the most efficient use of vacant, derelict and underused land in the area. This will comprise a mix of uses including new housing, jobs and supporting development.

4.5.31 Development of the Key Sites will provide around 780 dwellings and 22,230 sq m gross employment floorspace. Development on the Key Sites will be in accordance with the following quantities:

4.5.32 The Canal Basin Regeneration Area Key Site (sub-area 2.1) will provide a mixed use development of around 650 dwellings and around 4,650 sq m gross new employment floorspace (use classes B1a and B1c). It will also provide a local centre to serve the resident and daytime population of the development. The employment uses will be located in the southern part of the site to minimise the health and safety impacts which arise from the proximity of the gas holders.

4.5.33 The North East Gravesend Regeneration Area Key Site (sub-area 2.6) is made up of a number of areas which will provide around 130 dwellings and around 17,570 sq m gross employment floorspace (use classes B1, B2 and B8).

4.5.34 The Canal Road Industrial Site, Canal Road Gasholders, Riverside Industrial Area East of Canal Basin, Metropolitan Police Site and Norfolk Road Industrial Area will be retained in employment use. The Council will support proposals which improve their operation and the quality of their environment.

4.5.35 Great Clane Lane Marshes and Westcourt Marshes will remain undeveloped. Proposals which restore the Site of Special Scientific Interest to a more favourable condition will be supported.

4.5.36 The Council will support proposals that retain and increase marine related activity making active use of the River Thames. This will include support for recreational boating activity within the Canal Basin Regeneration Area and the expansion of marine related employment uses between Denton Wharf and Denton Slipways.

4.5.37 Proposals that have the potential to prejudice the operation of the Gravesend Wastewater Treatment Works, Denton Wharf and Denton Slipways or the strategic security related functions of the Metropolitan Police Training Centre, through the introduction of uses that are sensitive to the activities on these sites, will not be accepted unless it can be shown that any adverse impact can be fully mitigated.

4.5.38 Improvements will be sought to the Saxon Shore Way and National Cycle Route 1.

4.5.39 The alignment of the former Thames and Medway Canal will be protected from development, with the objective of delivering a high quality multi-purpose Green Infrastructure link between the Canal Basin and Mark Lane that secures the reinstatement of the canal where it is viable to do so.

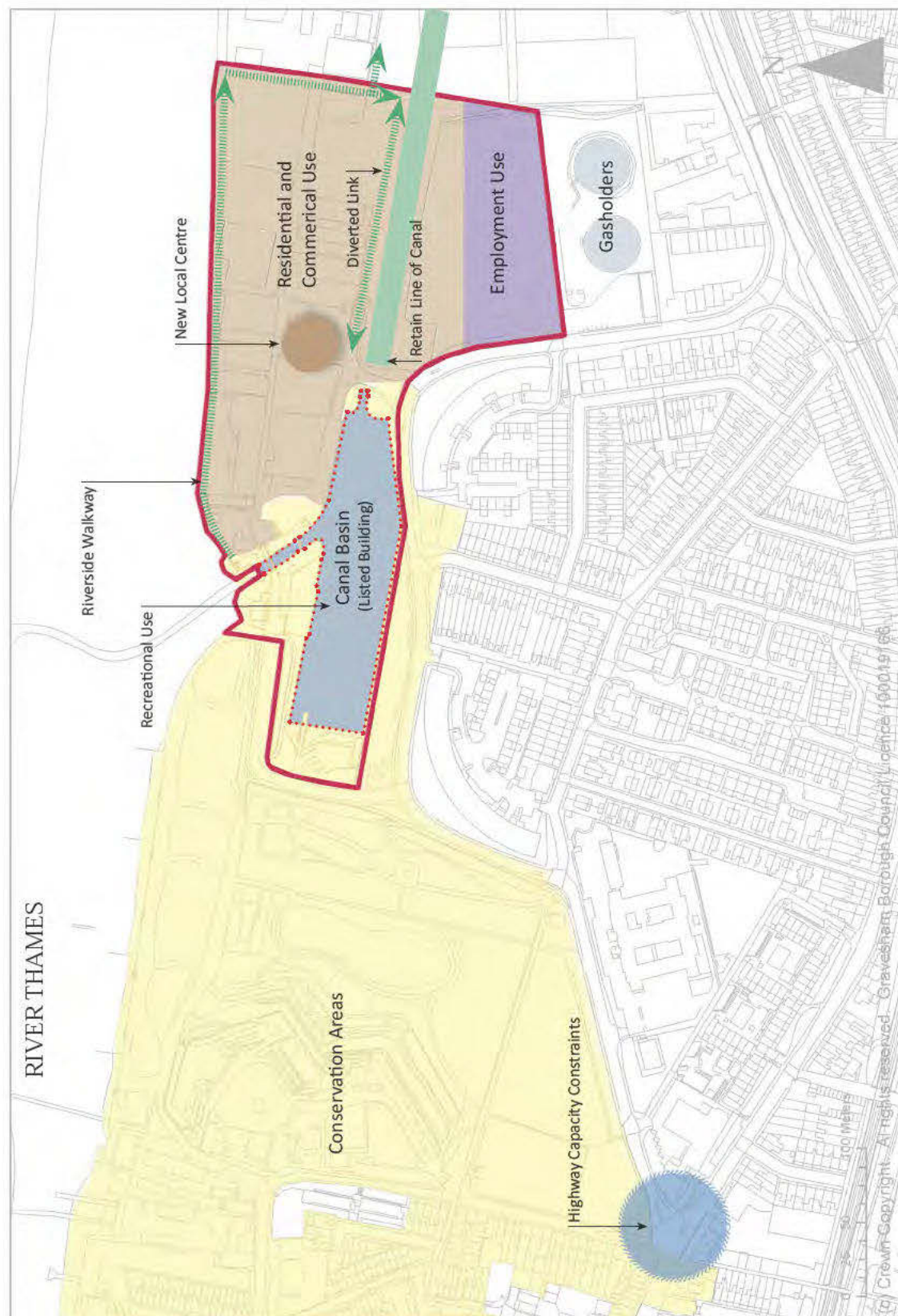


Figure 10: Key Site 2.1 Canal Basin Regeneration Area Schematic Plan

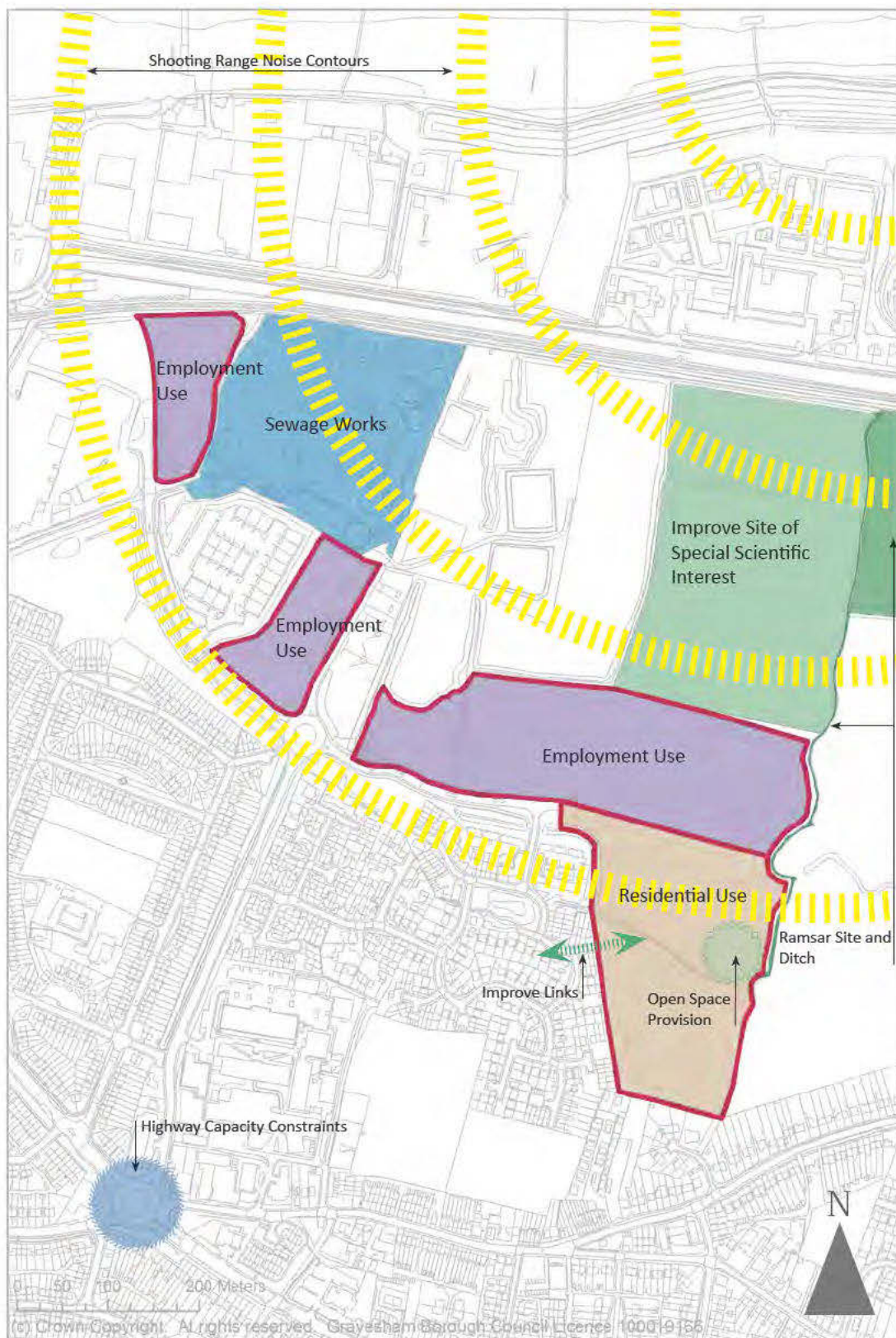


Figure 11: Key Site 2.6 North East Gravesend Regeneration Area Schematic Plan

4.6 Gravesend Town Centre Opportunity Area

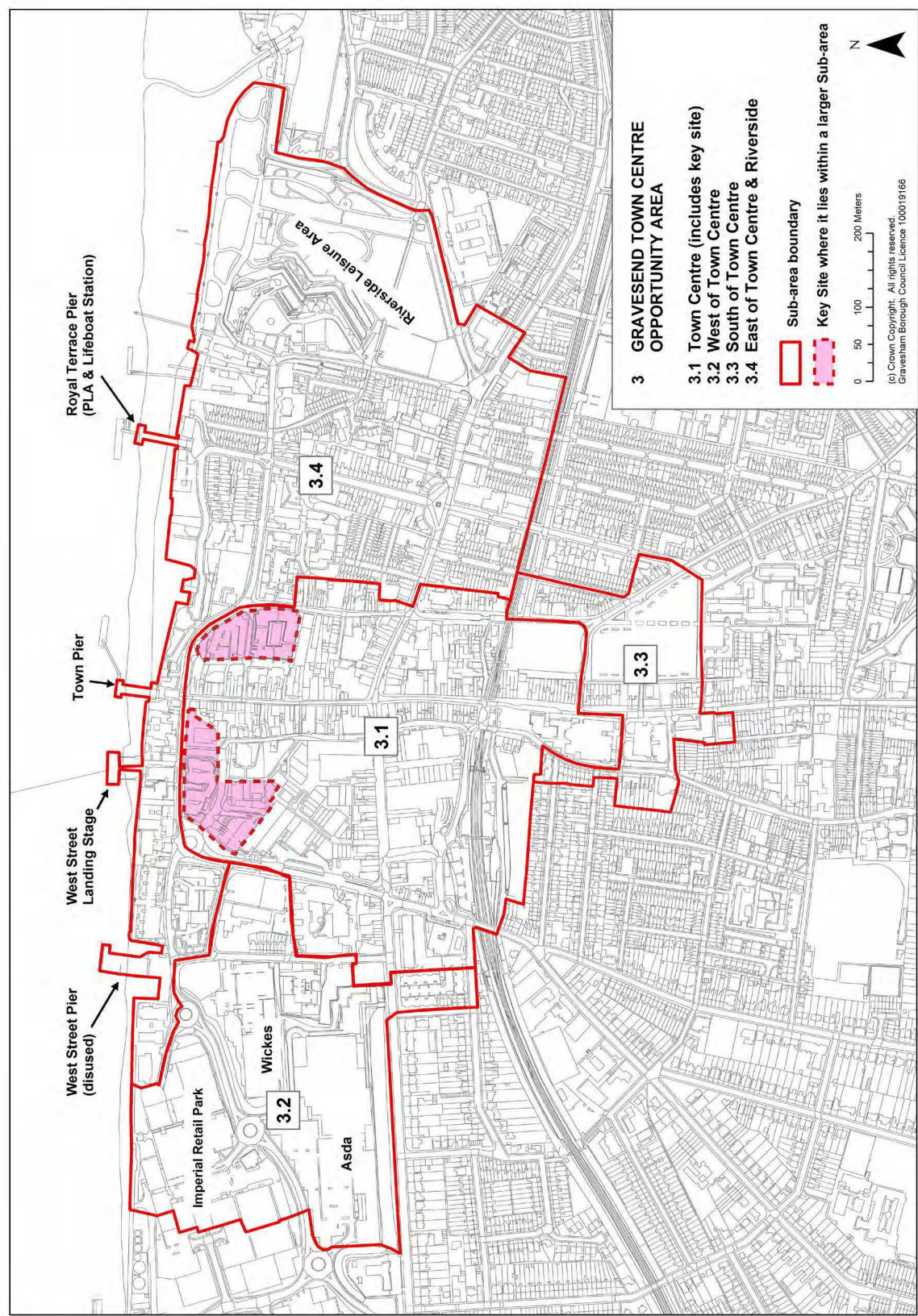


Figure 12: Gravesend Town Centre Opportunity Area

4.6.1 The Gravesend Town Centre Opportunity Area lies in a central urban location on the River Thames waterfront, directly opposite Tilbury on the Essex shore. Occupying an area of ground that rises towards Windmill Hill to the south, it is an historic town intimately connected with the nation's maritime past and the development of its overseas trade. For centuries, it has acted as the river gateway to the Port of London as well as being the central focus for the wider Borough. It is without doubt a very special place and one with great potential. This Opportunity Area not only includes the core of the town centre (sub-area 3.1) itself but adjoining areas that function together with it. These sub-areas are shown in Figure 12.

4.6.2 The vision for the Gravesend Town Centre Opportunity Area is that, by the end of the plan period, it will have built upon its strengths as a commercial centre and heritage riverside town to establish itself as a dynamic and desirable place to live and work and be a focus for shopping, leisure, service provision, culture and tourism. Regeneration will have acted as a catalyst for the improvement of the town centre's offer where high quality design and public realm will enhance the distinctive character of the centre.

4.6.3 Underlying principles of the planning system are that sustainable development should be promoted, the town centre's competitiveness should be improved and its local character should be preserved. The key features that make Gravesend's town centre distinctive and special are:

- It is an important historic riverside town on one of the world's great rivers that retains much of its architectural and heritage interest;
- It is a compact town that is built largely to a human scale;
- It is a traditional town with a mix of retail, service and residential uses;
- It is a well-connected town with good and improving transport links and good public car parking provision; and
- It is a safe, clean and well-managed town and an attractive place to live, work and visit.

4.6.4 However, there are also the following issues to resolve:

- Town centres need to constantly reinvent themselves if they are to remain relevant to the people who use them and to keep the mix of uses up to date and vibrant. This means that provision has to be made for modern retail, services and employment uses in terms of quantity, quality and range of supply whilst also accommodating new dwellings so more people can live there;
- As the Opportunity Area has significant heritage interest, its form influences where new units designed to meet modern commercial needs can be located;
- Competition from other centres and opportunities to buy goods and services over the internet has changed the way in which people shop. As a result, some of the retail offer of Gravesend town centre has become dated, although the demand for modern retail units of a larger size to meet the requirements of multiple retailers remains;
- Commercial leisure provision within the Gravesend Town Centre Opportunity Area has declined over time, following trends seen nationally in this sector;

- The cultural offer of the Opportunity Area is limited and this reduces its attractiveness as a heritage riverside town and place to visit;
- Whilst the environment of Gravesend town centre has been significantly upgraded over the past 20 years, further environmental improvements will be needed to ensure it remains a good place to live, work and visit and competes well with other centres;
- Some parts of the Opportunity Area are dominated by traffic resulting in noise and poor air quality with the one-way system being declared an Air Quality Management Area. The existing one-way system also has an adverse impact in that it divides the core town centre from the riverside and badly affects one of our finest heritage assets - Harmer Street;
- The River Thames is one of our most important assets but Gravesend town centre fails to make the most of the advantages it brings - it has become increasingly disconnected from the river over time and some new developments have tended to block important views; and
- Whilst the Opportunity Area includes the Riverside Leisure Area, it is recognised that open space provision elsewhere is constrained by urban form and available space but making it more pleasant and adaptable to climate change through additional greening would be beneficial.

4.6.5 As noted in paragraph 4.6.3, the Gravesend Town Centre Opportunity Area benefits from good public car parking provision and this is distributed around the Opportunity Area. Some of these car parks are short stay, used mainly by shoppers and visitors. Others are long stay, used by people who work in the area and by those who commute by train to work. There are also car parks associated with the retail stores to the west of the town centre. The overall provision of public car parking in this area is under review and the results will inform the future provision and distribution strategy to ensure an appropriate level of long and short stay parking is maintained. This car parking strategy will also be informed by the need to: reduce the adverse townscape impact of open car parking; make more efficient use of the land; manage traffic flows; and improve air quality.

4.6.6 The Council recognises the importance of the public realm and the built environment in this Opportunity Area, particularly in the core of the town centre (sub-area 3.1). Some areas would benefit from public realm and environmental enhancements, e.g. Milton Road as an eastern gateway to the town, yards to the rear of Queen Street, areas to the rear of Harmer Street. Therefore, the Council will support environmental enhancements where opportunities arise, especially when new development comes forward. This is in accordance with Policy CS19 on Development and Design Principles.

4.6.7 This section sets out the approach that the Council will take towards the future development of the sub-areas in this Opportunity Area. It should be read in conjunction with Policy CS08 on Retail, Leisure and the Hierarchy of Centres. Also of relevance are Policies CS07 on Economy, Employment and Skills, and CS09 on Culture and Tourism.

4.6.8 For the purposes of consistency, it should be noted that sub-area 3.1 (Town Centre) under this policy coincides with the boundaries of Gravesend Town Centre under Policy CS08.

4.6.9 The **Town Centre (sub-area 3.1)** comprises the main commercial part of Gravesend town centre. It is relatively compact and has the main concentration of retail, leisure, cultural, tourist, civic and service facilities in the Borough. This includes shops, banks, restaurants, bars, the Towncentric visitor and information centre, Gravesham Community Hospital, The Woodville, and the Council's offices. These serve the whole Borough. It also acts as a transport hub for both conventional and high speed train services as well as buses (see paragraph 5.5.8).

4.6.10 Gravesend's main shopping area is centred around the St George's Centre, Thamesgate Centre and the pedestrianised part of New Road. The units are mainly occupied by multiple retailers selling comparison goods (e.g. clothing, games and toys, books and stationery, jewellery). Convenience goods are available from Tesco, Farmfoods and a number of retailers which sell both convenience and comparison goods. There are a number of areas close to the main shopping area which consist of more independent shops, estate agents, banks, building societies, restaurants and pubs. These include: High Street; the indoor Borough Market; Queen Street; King Street; Windmill Street; Stone Street; Manor Road; Parrock Street; New Road (West); The Overcliffe; Darnley Road; and Barrack Row.

4.6.11 This sub-area wholly contains the defined Primary Shopping Area on the Policies Map (see Policy CS08 on Retail, Leisure and the Hierarchy of Centres). The retail function of the area will be supported and enhanced. There is an identified need for more and better quality comparison goods retail floorspace in the Borough. Larger sized modern units are required to meet the needs of multiple retailers. There is also a need for better quality convenience goods retail floorspace in the Borough to improve competition and consumer choice⁹. In accordance with the sequential approach set out in Policy CS08, the Primary Shopping Area is the preferred location for new retail development. However, given the townscape character and the scale of development anticipated, it is unlikely that all of the Borough's retail need can be accommodated in the existing Primary Shopping Area. For this reason, a site has been allocated for development adjacent to the Primary Shopping Area to enable future retail need to be met. Details of the Key Site are in paragraphs 4.6.22 – 4.6.25 on the Heritage Quarter.

4.6.12 The Town Centre sub-area has an important role in providing for an evening economy to serve the Borough. It is the first priority for the location of leisure, entertainment, culture and tourism development under Policy CS08 and support for the provision of cultural and tourism facilities are given in Policy CS09. There is scope for new restaurants, cafes, a cinema and hotels in the town centre, some of which could be accommodated on the Heritage Quarter Key Site (see paragraphs 4.6.22 - 4.6.25). There may also be potential for provision to be made on sites to the South of the Town Centre (sub-area 3.3) and details are given under the relevant sections. The Council will support proposals which retain and enhance the evening economy and provide improved leisure, entertainment, cultural and tourism facilities.

⁹ Retail and Commercial Leisure Study December 2009

4.6.13 Given the Borough's ageing population and the increasing number of residents expected to locate in and around Gravesend town centre over the plan period, there will be an increasing need for supporting local services. As the town centre is a transport hub with good public transport accessibility, it is a good location for such uses, as shown by the success of the Gravesham Gateway as a central service hub. The Council will support the retention or enhancement of services through Policy CS10 Physical and Social Infrastructure.

4.6.14 The Council supports improved public transport provision, including enhancements to the transport hub at the Gravesend railway station to provide high quality interchange facilities between bus, rail, walking and cycling (see Policy CS11 on Transport). Planning permission was granted for an integrated public transport interchange at Garrick Street/Barrack Row immediately adjoining the railway station as well as a multi-storey car park. The one-way system has already been partly diverted. A further diversion would be required to take it away from Clive Road and create a new Rathmore Road link between Stone Street and Darnley Road. In the event that this scheme is not fully implemented, the Council would still require the provision of a public transport interchange in this location. Subject to the provisions of the car parking strategy referred to in paragraph 4.6.5, it would also support the provision of offices at this location.

4.6.15 There are some larger scale office buildings located in this sub-area. Joynes House and the Civic Centre provide office employment. The Council would wish to see these maintained in office use over the plan period as they are part of the established Gravesend town centre office market and this would accord with the need to protect existing employment floorspace (see Policy CS07 on Economy, Employment and Skills). In addition, there may be opportunities to provide new office floorspace in the town centre for businesses wishing to locate there to exploit the potential offered by HS1. These are referred to where relevant.

4.6.16 The eastern part of the Town Centre sub-area has significant heritage interest. Much of this is within one of a number of conservation areas, centred around High Street, King Street and Windmill Street. There are also a number of listed buildings including the Grade II* listed Old Town Hall and St George's Church. Policy CS20 Heritage and the Historic Environment will apply.

4.6.17 There are few open spaces in the sub-area. Provision has been improved by the enlargement and refurbishment of the square in front of the Civic Centre, now known as Community Square, as a result of changes to the one-way system.

4.6.18 A particular feature of the town centre is its public alleys, particularly to the east and west of High Street. These provide important pedestrian links, e.g. between Queen Street, High Street and St George's Centre. There are also other important routes for pedestrians, e.g. New Road West provides a pedestrian link to Asda superstore and Imperial Retail Park (in sub-area 3.2). It will be important to improve pedestrian connections where the opportunities arise, especially between new development, the historic High Street and the riverside as well as areas to the east and west of the town centre.

4.6.19 Lord Street is used as a temporary long stay car park. Whilst this site is within the town centre boundary, its future is most sensibly considered with Parrock Street car park which is outside the town centre within sub-area 3.3. This is discussed further in paragraph 4.6.29.

4.6.20 Apart from the Heritage Quarter Key Site and the possible offices which may come forward as a result of development of the public transport interchange, there are a number of other sites which may be developed in this sub-area during the plan period. These are:

- former Cinema site on King Street which has the potential for retail units, offices and residential on the upper floors; and
- former Gala Bingo site on New Road West which has planning permission for retail/commercial uses on the ground floor with offices and residential uses on the upper floors.

4.6.21 Ground floor premises in the rest of this sub-area are likely to continue with their existing retail, commercial and service functions over the plan period. The upper floors are currently a mix of offices and residential uses. Both are important to maintain a mix of development in the town centre, provide employment and add to the life and vibrancy of the area. The Council will support the continued provision of such uses and changes of use where a satisfactory living environment can be provided.

4.6.22 Heritage Quarter West lies to the north of St George's Centre which is part of the town's main shopping area. It comprises a family centre, West Street open air car park, part of St George's Centre car park and the former Blockbuster store. Heritage Quarter East lies to the north of the Borough Market. It consists of the open air Horn Yard and Market Square car parks. Given the clear opportunities to make more efficient use of these under-used areas, improve townscape character and improve links to the river, the High Street and surrounding areas, both are identified as a Key Site.

4.6.23 As explained in Policy CS08, whilst new retail development will be directed to the existing Primary Shopping Area, there are insufficient sites available within that Area to accommodate the total need for retail development over the plan period. The Heritage Quarter Key Site, located adjacent to the Primary Shopping Area, is the Council's sequentially preferred location for new larger scale retail provision.

4.6.24 Heritage Quarter West would function as a logical extension to St George's Centre and be located relatively close to the proposed public transport interchange. It is anticipated that it could accommodate around 10,500 sq m gross retail floorspace. This could be entirely comparison retail floorspace or it may include a convenience retail floorspace element. Heritage Quarter East could provide complementary uses such as restaurants and bars which help improve the town's evening economy and a hotel to improve tourist provision. The Key Site could also accommodate residential development, especially Heritage Quarter East, and make provision for office uses. It would need to make provision for public car parking to replace that lost as a result of development.

4.6.25 It will be important that proposals for the Heritage Quarter Key Site are appropriate to context; fully integrate with the existing townscape; preserve key views to and from the river; improve the public realm; and enhance the setting of the key heritage assets including the Grade II* listed St George's Church in accordance with Policies CS19 and CS20. It is also important that development improves pedestrian connections with the historic High Street and the riverside and Imperial Retail Park and Asda superstore to the west. There will be a requirement for this development to improve the open space at St Andrew's Gardens (within sub-area 3.4) for existing and new residents and visitors as well as improve Market Square and the open space around St George's Church.

4.6.26 The **West of Town Centre area (sub-area 3.2)** is bisected by Thames Way. To the north lies Imperial Retail Park which provides retail warehouse type facilities and to the south west lies the Asda superstore. These are located in a former chalk quarry and there is a steep cliff face between Asda and The Overcliffe but an escalator provides a pedestrian link between the two. To the south east of Thames Way is the Wickes DIY store which sits at a higher level from it. Wickes is accessed from Stuart Road and this road also includes a number of residential properties. The number of large retail stores in this sub-area means that large areas are used for associated car parking. To the east of Stuart Road lies the redundant M block, part of the former hospital on the site. There is also a small area of residential properties to the south of The Overcliffe.

4.6.27 There are opportunities to make more efficient use of under-used sites which would also improve townscape character, e.g. the redevelopment of the Wickes site. Links between Asda/ Imperial Retail Park and the town centre could also be improved, e.g. the provision of further decked parking at Asda could create a link to The Overcliffe. The Council will support such proposals. It is likely that the M Block site will be redeveloped for residential use during the plan period and this should include active uses on the ground floor to help create a more pedestrian friendly route to Imperial Retail Park. The existing residential areas are likely to remain.

4.6.28 There are a number of larger scale office buildings located in the **South of Town Centre area (sub-area 3.3)**. The former Police Station on Windmill Street is vacant. The council considers that this site is suitable for a range of town centre uses including a significant component of residential development. Active commercial uses should occupy the ground floor to complement The Woodville to the north and existing business uses on the east side of Windmill Street. The site currently has an outstanding planning permission for redevelopment to provide residential uses on the upper floors and shops/financial and professional services/ business/non-residential institutions (use classes A1/A2/B1/D1) on the ground floor. Cygnet House is currently being redeveloped for residential use.

4.6.29 The Lord Street/Parrock Street sites are used as car parks. There is a planning permission for the Lord Street car park site, involving the provision of residential development, live-work units and commercial/community floorspace at ground floor level along the street frontages. The sites may offer scope for mixed use development but their future will depend on the outcome of work being carried out on public car parking provision. Lord Street is within the

defined town centre and Parrock Street is just outside it and neither site is within the Primary Shopping Area. It may be possible to accommodate additional retail/leisure/hotel/office uses and/or residential development on one or both of the sites but the sequential approaches to these uses outlined in Policies CS08 and CS09 will be applied.

4.6.30 Outside these development sites, there is a mixture of predominantly commercial uses which are likely to remain over the plan period. The shops on the east side of Parrock Street are peripheral to the town centre and their future role will be considered if the Lord Street/ Parrock Street sites come forward for regeneration.

4.6.31 The **East of Town Centre and Riverside area (sub-area 3.4)** is centred around Thames Riverside, Harmer Street and Milton Road. It is largely residential though there are pockets of land in employment use and some ground floor retail uses. There are some open spaces and a number of piers along the Riverside.

4.6.32 The Thames Riverside in this location significantly contributes to Gravesend's role as a riverside heritage town. The Town Pier has been refurbished and a pontoon has recently been installed to allow access to visiting craft and the Gravesend-Tilbury Ferry. The Saxon Shore Way and Wealdway long distance walking routes both start at the Town Pier whilst National Cycle Route 1 runs along this part of West Street. There are also open spaces (see paragraph 4.6.36). The Council will seek to improve public access to the riverside. It will also require proposals to maintain and enhance riverside character and views in accordance with Policy CS19 Development and Design Principles.

4.6.33 Harmer Street and Berkley Crescent were historically a mixed use area with retail and business premises on the ground floor with residential above. This has changed over time. It suffers from a poor environment due to its location on the one way system and the resulting poor air quality and disturbance from traffic. The Council will support the provision of offices and financial and professional services in this area. It will also allow the conversion of upper floors to residential use where a satisfactory living environment can be provided.

4.6.34 Milton Road consists of a number of retail and restaurant uses at ground floor level. The retail units are peripheral to the town centre and this area is considered to perform a local centre function serving the residents of this and surrounding areas. The Council supports this role for the area and will take this forward as a new proposed local centre in the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD.

4.6.35 This area has significant heritage interest, much of which is within one of a number of conservation areas. There are also a significant number of listed buildings, particularly along Harmer Street, Berkley Crescent and the Clocktower which are distinctive historic features of Gravesend's townscape. New Tavern Fort and Milton Chantry within the Riverside Leisure Area and Gravesend Blockhouse along the riverfront are Scheduled Monuments. Policy CS20 Heritage and the Historic Environment will apply.

4.6.36 The Riverside Leisure Area lies in the east of the sub-area. It is a large open space which forms an important part of the Green Infrastructure network serving both the local area and the wider Borough, with many leisure events being held in this location. The area has benefitted from some improvements but there may be further opportunities, especially linked to the Canal Basin Regeneration Area Key Site to the east. St Andrew's Gardens alongside the river is an important area of open space close to the town centre but it is not currently meeting its full recreational potential. Lower St Andrew's Gardens has more potential as the upper gardens are limited due to the slopes. The Council will seek to improve the recreational potential of both these areas and Policies CS12 on Green Infrastructure and CS13 on Green Space, Sport and Recreation are also relevant.

4.6.37 There are a number of larger scale office buildings located in this area. The Port of London Authority offices and associated land around Royal Terrace Pier form part of the river-related employment in the Borough. The Post Office and Department for Work and Pensions buildings on The Grove to the south of Milton Road also provide employment. There are some smaller employment sites interspersed with residential uses to the north and south of Milton Road, including Milton Road Business Park and Bentley Street Industrial Estate. These serve the needs of smaller scale businesses requiring a central location, although the type and scale of these activities is constrained by their proximity to residential areas and local road access. The strategy for employment sites is to protect employment floorspace unless it is truly redundant for modern needs, support the refurbishment and upgrading of existing premises and facilitate the expansion of river-related employment (see Policy CS07 on Economy, Employment and Skills).

4.6.38 The remainder of the area is largely residential. This includes a mix of modern flatted developments alongside the river, terraced houses to the north and south of Milton Road and around Royal Terrace Pier, and some post war flatted development to the west of Harmer Street. These areas are likely to remain in residential use over the plan period. It is likely that the Clifton Slipways/West Street pier site will be redeveloped for residential use.

Policy CS05: Gravesend Town Centre Opportunity Area

4.6.39 The Gravesend Town Centre Opportunity Area will be the principal focus for town centre related economic and social activity in the Borough. This will be achieved by consolidating the existing retail area, encouraging a mix of employment and residential uses, improving its role as a transport hub by the creation of a public transport interchange, promoting an evening economy through giving support to the provision of leisure uses and taking full advantage of its heritage and riverside setting.

4.6.40 Development of the Heritage Quarter will provide a high quality, mixed use development of around 330 dwellings, around 10,500 sq m gross of, primarily comparison, retail floorspace (use class A1), some office floorspace (use class B1a) and a hotel. It will reconnect the town centre with the River Thames, High Street and surrounding areas and reinforce Gravesend's character as a riverside heritage town.

Replacement public car parking and improvements to the open space at St Andrew's Gardens will be provided as well as a replacement St George's Church Hall.

4.6.41 Within the Opportunity Area, the Council will:

- Seek to improve pedestrian access between the town centre, the River Thames and surrounding areas and reduce the physical barriers created by the one-way system;
- Manage traffic accessing and passing through the area through its approach towards the provision and distribution of public car parks;
- Support improved public transport access, including the provision of an integrated transport interchange at Garrick Street/Barrack Row;
- Support and enhance retail, leisure, entertainment, cultural and tourism provision in accordance with the sequential approach;
- Support the provision of new offices in accordance with the sequential approach, in particular where they have good access to the proposed integrated transport interchange;
- Support the provision of new residential development where a satisfactory living environment can be achieved;
- Support the redevelopment of under-used sites where this makes more efficient use of the sites and improves townscape character; and
- Support existing retail, commercial and service functions on the ground floors and the provision of offices and residential uses on upper floors subject to achieving a satisfactory living environment.

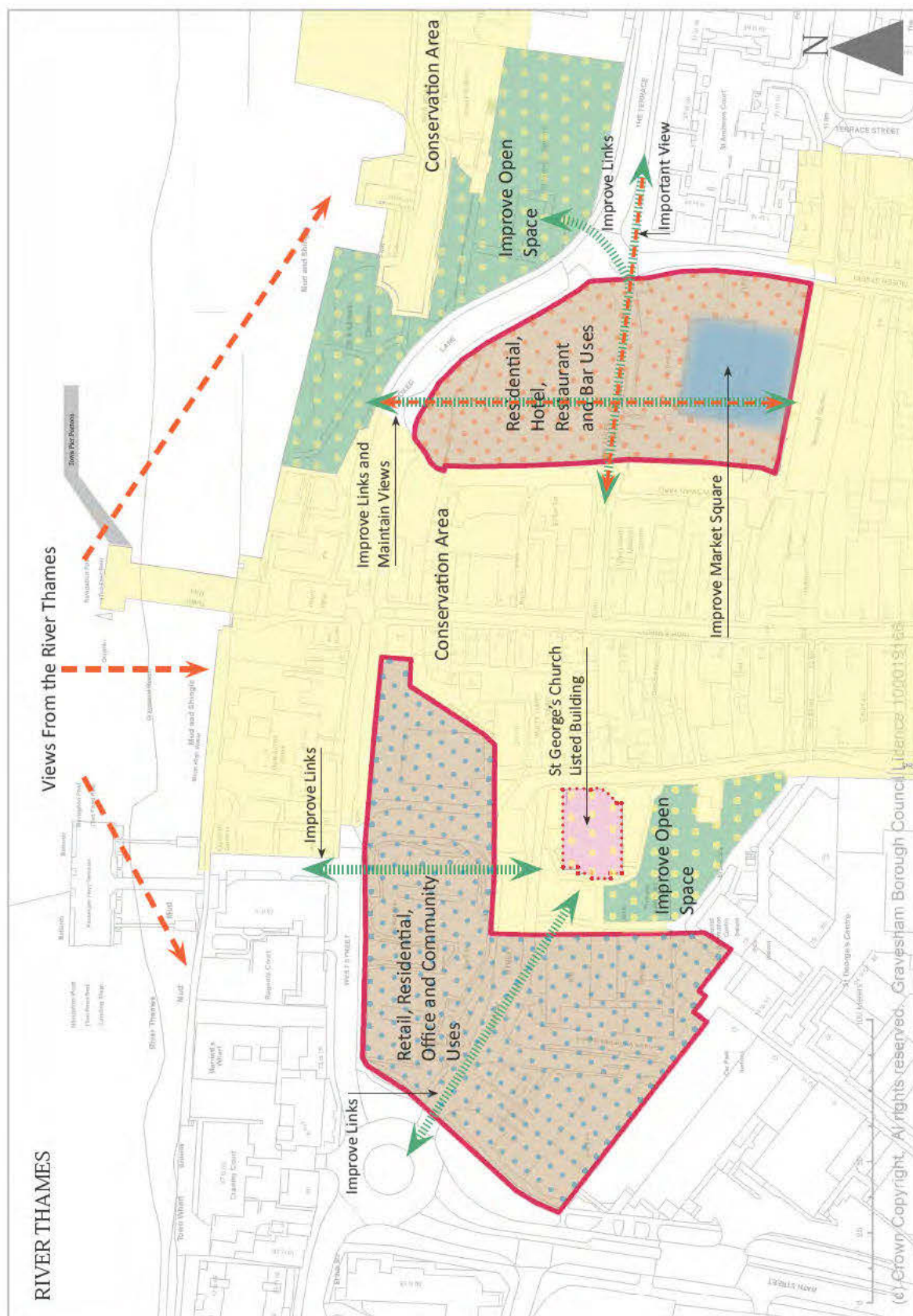


Figure 13: Key Site 3.1 Heritage Quarter Schematic Plan

4.7 Ebbsfleet (Gravesham) Opportunity Area

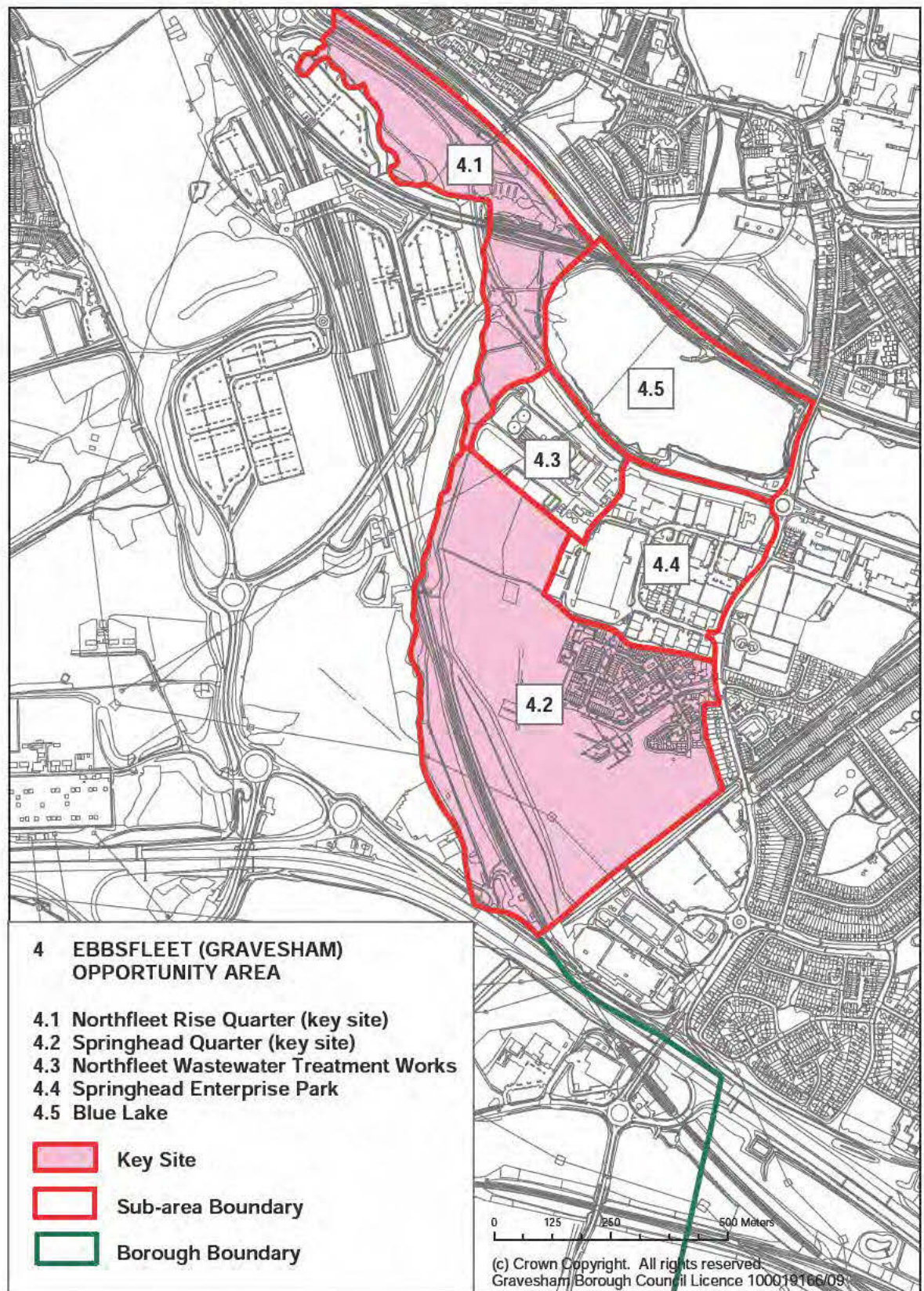


Figure 14: Ebbsfleet (Gravesham) Opportunity Area

4.7.1 The Ebbsfleet (Gravesham) Opportunity Area lies immediately east of the boundary with Dartford Borough and Ebbsfleet International railway station, south of the North Kent railway line and west of Springhead Road. This area has previously been the subject of mineral working and the Springhead area was farmland. The sub-area is partly occupied by the High Speed 1 (HS1) railway line and an extensive network of highways including the A226 (Thames Way) and A2260 (Ebbsfleet Gateway), as well as a small part of one of the station car parks. The valley floor is largely flat and low lying but rises to the east and south where both industrial and residential development has already taken place at Springhead Enterprise Park and Springhead Park (Springhead Quarter). The Northfleet Wastewater Treatment Works and the Blue Lake (a water-filled quarry) occupy central locations to the south of Thames Way. Figure 14 shows the main sub-areas comprising this Opportunity Area.

Northfleet Rise Quarter and Springhead Quarter (sub-areas 4.1 and 4.2)

4.7.2 The immediate area around the Ebbsfleet International railway station in both Dartford and Gravesham Boroughs has long been identified as the location for a major business district in a mixed settlement with the opportunity to create a regional transport hub around the international rail station. The employment potential of the site was a major reason for the Government selecting the location as the preferred option for an intermediate station on the then Channel Tunnel Rail Link in 1994 (now High Speed 1).

4.7.3 Outline planning permission was granted by both Gravesham and Dartford Boroughs in 2002 for a comprehensive mixed use public transport oriented development across the Ebbsfleet site. This split the site into four linked quarters – two in Dartford (Station Quarter North and Station Quarter South) and two in Gravesham (Northfleet Rise and Springhead). Within Gravesham, up to 1,064 dwellings and up to 125,000 sq m gross business employment floorspace plus supporting uses were granted planning permission. Although the planning permissions are flexible, the vision has been for a high density office employment driven, mixed use development which is public transport oriented and has supporting infrastructure to meet the needs of the resident and daytime population, making the most of its proximity to the international railway station.

4.7.4 Quarter Master Plans have been approved across the site to reflect the above approach. Detailed plans have also been approved for much of Springhead Quarter, where the emphasis has been on providing residential development. Around 200 dwellings had been completed by the start of the plan period. Recent changes to the planning permission means that Springhead Quarter is likely to be a more residentially led development and Northfleet Rise Quarter is likely to be a more employment led development. Despite international rail services having operated from 2007 and domestic rail services from 2009, no commercial development has occurred to date. This period has coincided with the economic recession and the emergence of competing developments at Stratford in East London. However, the vision for the site in both Dartford and Gravesham remains the same.

4.7.5 The Council will require the provision of measures to ensure that a public transport oriented development is delivered in accordance with the vision. This will include the provision of bus services, footpath and cycle links to connect the different Quarters, to provide easy access to the station and to provide wider access to the surrounding area. As part of this, the developer will be expected to provide a bridge link between Springhead Quarter and the Ebbsfleet Station access road.

4.7.6 To further encourage a high proportion of trips by sustainable means and discourage the need to travel by private car, the Council supports the development of a transport hub at Ebbsfleet to provide high quality interchange facilities between bus, rail, walking and cycling. It also supports the provision of a pedestrian and cycle link between Ebbsfleet and Northfleet stations. Further details are set out under Policy CS11 Transport.

4.7.7 The planning permissions identify a number of transport schemes that the full development would require in both Gravesham and Dartford Boroughs. The precise form of these will depend on the actual development, phasing and the cumulative implications of proposals for other sites that feed off the same transport system.

4.7.8 There are a number of car parks which serve Ebbsfleet station. These are mainly located in Dartford Borough. As a result of a development agreement with the Government, the developer has the right to build on the car parks serving Ebbsfleet station provided that any spaces that are displaced are replaced in a suitable location or form. Therefore, provision will need to be made for replacement car parking within the Ebbsfleet development site.

4.7.9 Northfleet sidings, adjoining Northfleet railway station in Northfleet Rise Quarter, have been reinstated. These restore the connection between the North Kent line and the Northfleet Cement Works Regeneration Area Key Site (sub-area 1.5).

4.7.10 The proximity of the Key Sites to the Northfleet Wastewater Treatment Works (sub-area 4.3) and the high speed railway line mean that they could be subject to odour and noise pollution. As a result, the location and type of development will need to have regard to these constraints. Less sensitive buffer uses such as employment may need to be located between residential development and the sources of the pollution to mitigate the impacts. A high voltage power line also runs along the southern part of Springhead Quarter and the layout of development will need to have regard to this.

4.7.11 The Ebbsfleet stream runs along the western part of the two quarters. Both the stream and the surrounding reedbeds and slopes have biodiversity interest and are part of the Ebbsfleet Marshes Local Wildlife Site. A public right of way runs along much of it. The Council will require the improvement and management of the Ebbsfleet stream corridor as part of wider greenspace and Green Infrastructure provision within the new development.

4.7.12 Part of the Ebbsfleet Neolithic Site Scheduled Monument is within Northfleet Rise Quarter. Both quarters are areas of archaeological interest, being the site of a former Roman

settlement. The Council will require the preservation and interpretation of the site's heritage assets in accordance with Policy CS20 Heritage and the Historic Environment.

4.7.13 Northfleet Wastewater Treatment Works (sub-area 4.3) lies to the west of the Springhead Enterprise Park and south of Blue Lake. The plant has been upgraded to increase capacity and to meet European legal requirements. It is anticipated that this use will remain over the plan period. The Council recognises that it is a potential source of odour pollution and development proposals will need to reflect this.

4.7.14 Springhead Enterprise Park (sub-area 4.4) lies to the west of Springhead Road and south of Thames Way, immediately adjacent to the new residential development at Springhead Park (Springhead Quarter) and the Northfleet Wastewater Treatment Works. It is a well-established employment location consisting of a range of light and general industrial and warehouse units of different sizes. It has good levels of occupation although some of the larger units are more difficult to let. The Council considers that this area is likely to remain in employment use over the plan period. Proposals that result in improvements to the site and its employment carrying potential within the same range of uses will be supported.

4.7.15 Blue Lake (sub-area 4.5) is a deep water filled quarry lying to the north of Thames Way. The site is currently fenced to prevent unauthorised access due to the dangers associated with such workings but is used by a local fishing club. Water is abstracted from the lake to serve the Kimberly Clark tissue mill in the Swanscombe and Northfleet Riverside Opportunity Area. Lafarge Tarmac maintains rights to abstract water from the lake, although it is understood that no other abstraction takes place other than to maintain levels and to prevent flooding. The site is part of the Ebbsfleet Marshes Local Wildlife Site which means that it has some nature conservation value. However, it is understood that there is a degree of saline intrusion due to the proximity of the area to the River Thames.

4.7.16 The Council considers that Blue Lake will remain in its current use over the plan period. It would support proposals that better integrate the lake with the Northfleet Rise Quarter Key Site, secure environmental improvements and improve its biodiversity value whilst not prejudicing public safety and the abstraction of water for industrial purposes. It may be possible to increase use of the area for leisure purposes, for example. This would bring the area into active use and provide an income stream for its future maintenance and improvement.

Policy CS06: Ebbsfleet (Gravesham) Opportunity Area

4.7.17 The Ebbsfleet (Gravesham) Opportunity Area is a substantial opportunity for a high quality, sustainable, mixed use development in line with the long-standing strategy to create a major business district at Ebbsfleet within Dartford as well as Gravesham. Development will bring significant benefits to the Borough and surrounding communities through the delivery of new housing, business employment (within use classes B1a, B1b and B1c) and supporting facilities centred around and well linked to the Ebbsfleet Station transport hub.

4.7.18 Development of the Key Sites will lead to the provision of around 690 new dwellings and around 20,000 sq m gross business employment floorspace (use classes B1a, B1b and B1c), together with supporting retail (use class A1) and other facilities, leisure/entertainment floorspace (use class D2), hotels and restaurants. There is potential for the provision of additional dwellings and business floorspace in the longer term.

4.7.19 Development of the Key Sites will be in accordance with the principles set out below.

4.7.20 The Springhead Quarter Key Site will provide a residentially led mixed use development of around 690 additional dwellings with the potential to provide some business employment floorspace (use classes B1a, B1b and B1c) and some retail floorspace to support the residential development.

4.7.21 The Northfleet Rise Quarter Key Site will provide an employment led development comprising business employment floorspace (use classes B1a, B1b and B1c), leisure/entertainment floorspace (use class D2), and hotels and restaurants. It will provide a local centre to support the development.

4.7.22 Retailing will be provided to meet the needs of the resident and daytime population and should safeguard the role of Gravesend town centre as the primary retail centre.

4.7.23 Facilities will be provided to support development of the Springhead Quarter and Northfleet Rise Quarter Key Sites and will be accessible to both existing and future communities. These will include the provision of educational, health, social care, sports and community facilities, open space to meet a variety of needs and recycling and waste transfer facilities. These will be provided in accordance with the phasing schedule set out in the Infrastructure Delivery Schedule.

4.7.24 Development will be designed to be public transport oriented to encourage a high proportion of trips by sustainable means and discourage the need to travel by private car. This will be achieved by the provision of frequent bus services and a high quality network of publicly accessible footpath and cycle links between the Springhead Quarter Key Site, Northfleet Rise Quarter Key Site and the Dartford Quarters of the development, Ebbsfleet Station and Northfleet. This will include the provision of a bridge over the Ebbsfleet stream to provide a pedestrian, cycle and road link between the Springhead Quarter Key Site and Ebbsfleet Station access road.

4.7.25 The Council will support the creation of an enhanced transport hub at Ebbsfleet Station (in the Dartford Borough Council area) providing high quality interchange facilities between bus, rail, walking and cycling and the provision of pedestrian and cycle links between Ebbsfleet and Northfleet stations.

4.7.26 Provision will be made for replacement car parking to serve Ebbsfleet Station if any is displaced by development.

4.7.27 The layout of development and mix of uses will have regard to railway noise from HS1 and odour from Northfleet Wastewater Treatment Works. Suitable buffer uses will be required between new residential development and this infrastructure to mitigate the impact of noise and odour.

4.7.28 A network of multi-functional, accessible greenspace will be provided, forming part of the wider Green Infrastructure network, to meet the needs of the resident and daytime population and to enhance biodiversity. This will include the improvement and management of the Ebbsfleet stream corridor.

4.7.29 The Springhead Enterprise Park will be retained in employment use. The Council will support proposals which increase its employment potential and make it more responsive to the market.

4.7.30 The Council will support proposals for Blue Lake that better integrate it with the Northfleet Rise Quarter Key Site, secure environmental improvements, increase its nature conservation value and introduce more beneficial uses where these are compatible with the need to maintain its water abstraction functions and public safety.

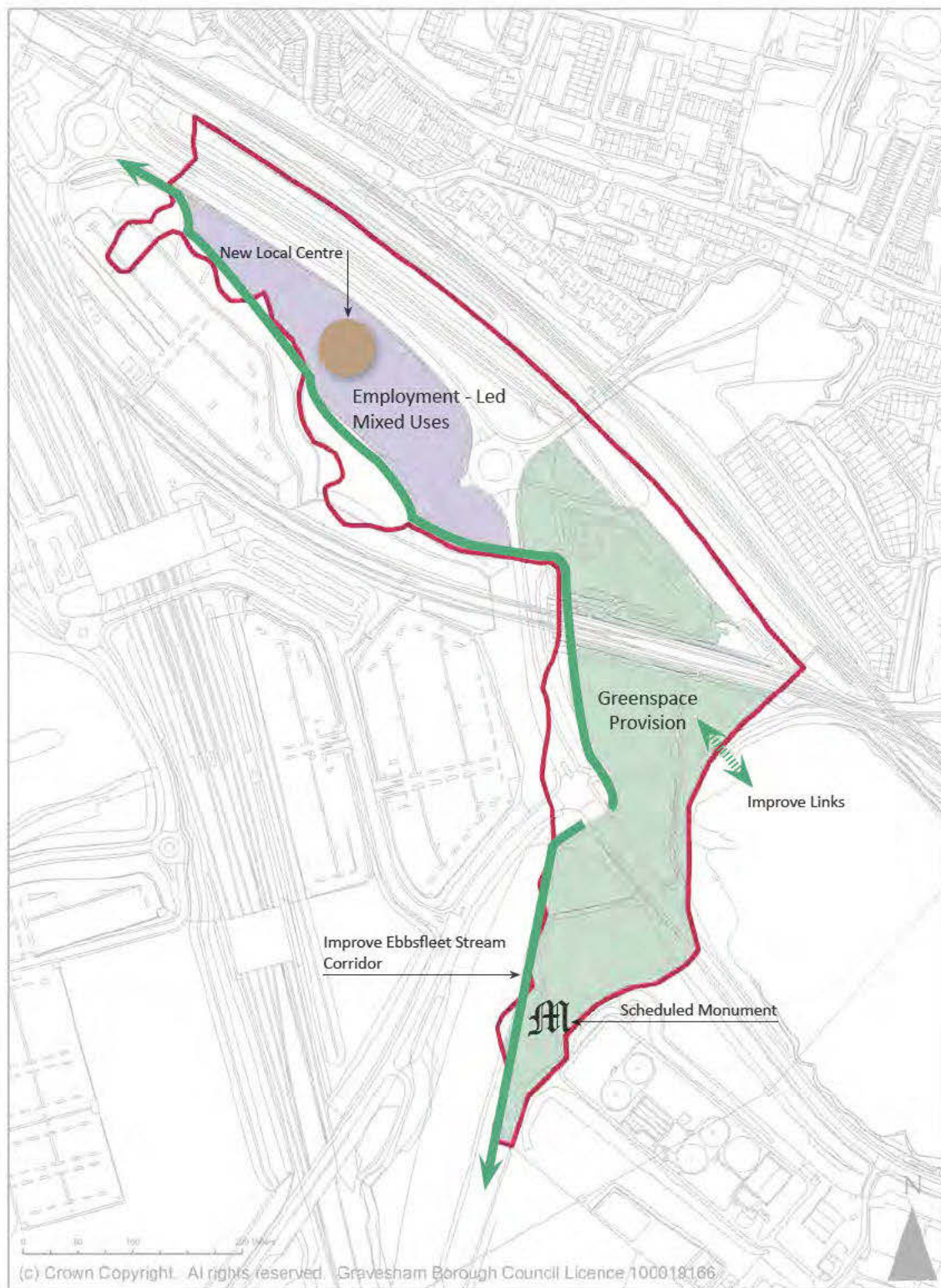


Figure 15: Key Site 4.1 Northfleet Rise Quarter Schematic Plan

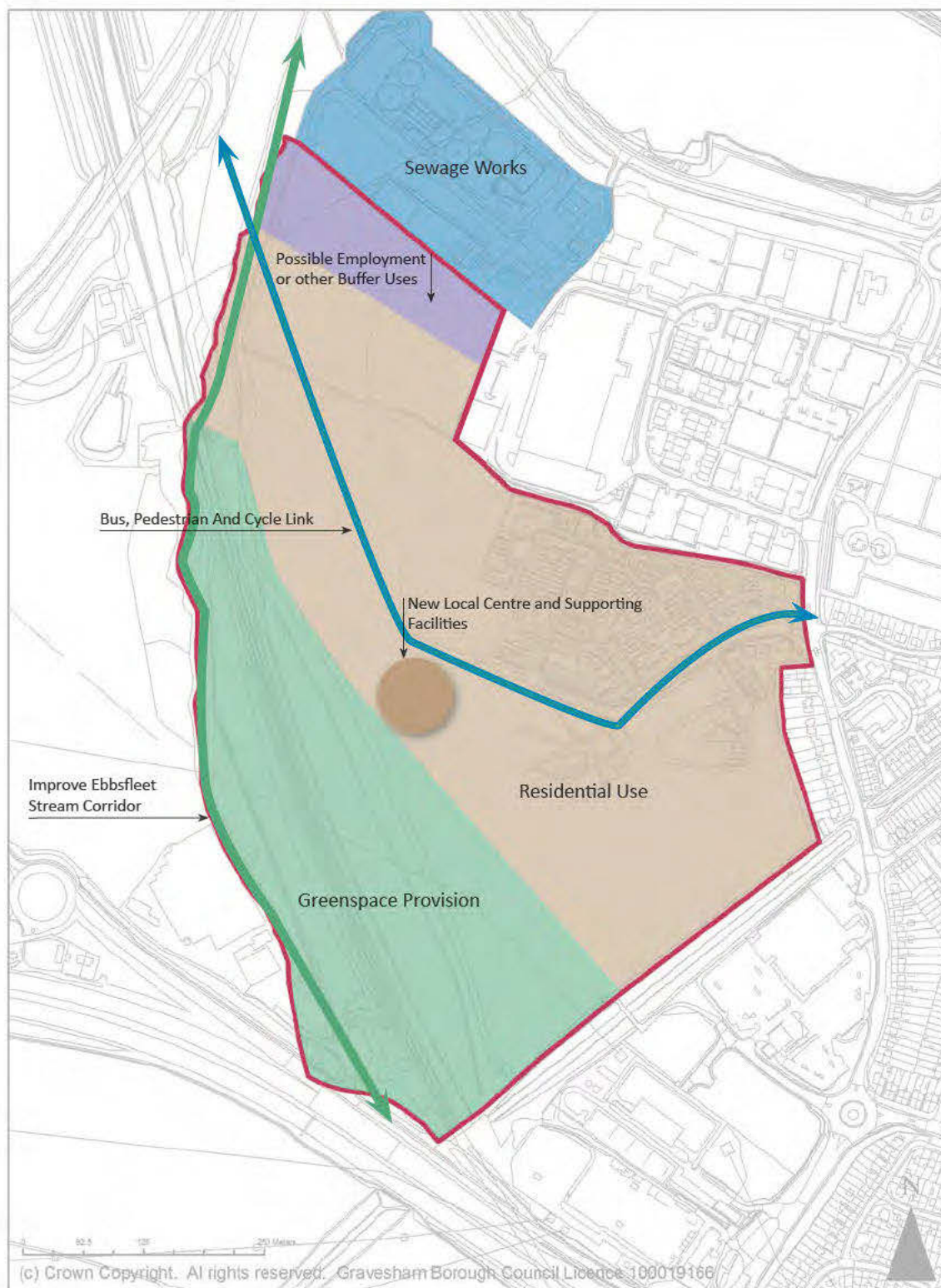


Figure 16: Key Site 4.2 Springhead Quarter Schematic Plan

4.8 Land at Coldharbour Road Key Site

4.8.1 The Land at Coldharbour Road Key Site which is located within the Gravesend Urban Area, and lies immediately west of Wrotham Road, is split into two parts by Coldharbour Road. Both parts of the site are currently in agricultural use.

4.8.2 To the north of the site lie the playing fields and buildings of St George's Church of England secondary school. To the west is the Shears Green residential area which includes a local centre, community centre and a hospice, and a supermarket with associated petrol station and restaurant. To the east is the Mid Kent Golf course, some residential development, a restaurant and a site with permission for a hotel. To the south is the Cyclopark.

4.8.3 The Key Site is in close proximity to the A2, which is raised at this point and as a result, much of the site experiences background traffic noise. The A2 is also covered by an Air Quality Management Area. Any development of the site will need to be located, designed and constructed to mitigate this impact in accordance with Policy CS19 (Development and Design Principles).

4.8.4 The allocation of additional development land at Coldharbour Road would bring forward the need for capacity and safety improvements at the A2/A227 Tollgate junction, as identified in recent technical work. The detail of the design, along with its timing and appropriate funding contributions, will be the subject of further discussion between the planning and highway authorities, and developers.

4.8.5 The Key Site lies within the Gravesend Southern Fringe landscape character area which consists of small arable fields and has a gently undulating topography rising from north to south. The dry valley into Gravesend, in the eastern part of the site, is the strongest landscape feature and therefore it should be protected and enhanced in accordance with Policy CS12. It has also been identified through Environment Agency modelling as an area at high risk of flooding. Consequently to the north of Coldharbour Road, only the western part of the site is regarded as having development potential.

4.8.6 On the land south of Coldharbour Road, planning permission has been granted for provision of an enterprise centre comprising offices and light industrial units of around 5,100 sq m gross with vehicular access from the existing roundabout to the west of the site. The Economy and Employment Space Study (2009) highlighted that development of this site would considerably enhance employment provision in an accessible location along the A2 and that study assesses it as one of the best employment sites in the Borough.

4.8.7 Masterplanning for the land north of Coldharbour Road site will be expected to take the following into account:

- The potential for the dry valley area in the eastern side of the site to be liable to flooding during extreme rainfall events

- The A2 Trunk Road Air Quality Management Area adjoins a small stretch of the site boundary at the south eastern corner of the site
- Public rights of way on and adjoining the site
- Noise created by the A2
- Existing local services and facilities available at the adjacent Morrisons supermarket in Coldharbour Road, the Shears Green Community Centre in Westcott Avenue and a local centre at Lawrance Square, and improving pedestrian accessibility to these and other community facilities as applicable, including those to be provided by the developer
- The proximity to and impact on the existing St George's School site
- How the layout will encourage the use of sustainable transport, and how the new development will be served by local bus services
- The site is an area of archaeological potential

4.8.8 The western part of the site is capable of accommodating around 500 dwellings during the plan period. Key to the development of the land north of Coldharbour Road is the achievement of a design solution that successfully integrates the new development with the existing Shears Green residential area to the west and respects the character of the site and the surrounding area. Improved connectivity with adjoining areas and significant open space and biodiversity improvements will also be expected, as a benefit for new and existing residents in the locality, through the creation of a north-south linear park within the dry valley feature as part of the Strategic Green Infrastructure Network (see Policy CS12, Figure 19).

4.8.9 The main vehicular access will be from the existing roundabout on Coldharbour Road to the south west of the site. Another road access is likely to be required. A secondary access could be provided at the northern end of the site to help strengthen the local centre but it may need to be restricted to public transport, emergency vehicles, pedestrians and cyclists.

4.8.10 In addition, there is currently poor vehicular access from Meadow Road to St George's School to the north. Development of this area provides the opportunity to improve vehicular access to the school whilst providing a second access to the development site. The Council will work with the developer and the school to consider whether this can be achieved as part of the new development.

4.8.11 The developer will be expected to make contributions to community infrastructure. Due to the lack of spare capacity within the primary school network within Northfleet and Gravesend, proposals for this Key Site may need to include provision for a primary school which which would affect the scale of dwelling provision.

Policy CS21: Land at Coldharbour Road Key Site

4.8.12 Development of the land at the Coldharbour Road Key Site will provide a mixed use development in accordance with the principles set out below:

Land north of Coldharbour Road

4.8.13 This will provide a residential development of around 500 dwellings with significant open space and biodiversity improvements and the provision of community facilities, potentially including a new primary school on-site. Off road pedestrian and cycle links will be provided in the eastern part of the site as part of suite of improved links facilitating connectivity between the town centre and the A2 corridor through the site.

Land south of Coldharbour Road

4.8.14 This will provide office and light industrial development in the form of an enterprise centre/incubation space of approximately 5,050 sq m gross with pedestrian links to surrounding developments which provide facilities for workers and visitors.

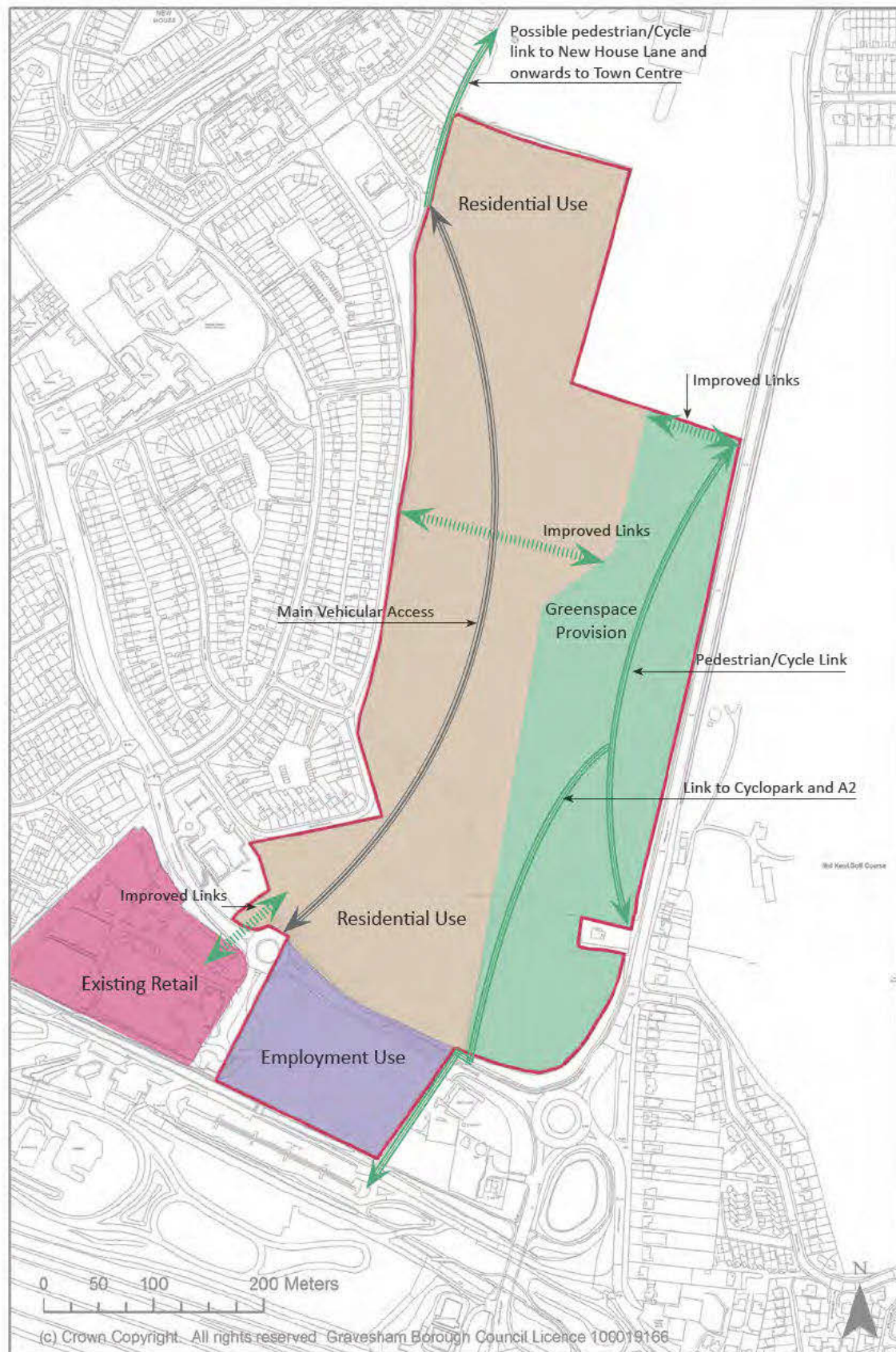


Figure 17: Key Site Land at Coldharbour Road Schematic Plan

5 Thematic Policies

5.0.1 In addition to the spatial policies in section 4, there are also a number of thematic issues which need to be addressed through Borough-wide policies in order to implement the vision and spatial objectives. As well as providing the long term policy framework for the Borough, they will support the delivery of development and corporate actions, and they will guide the content of other policies in the Local Plan such as the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD. The thematic policies and the spatial policies are complementary so it is important that the policy framework is read as a whole.

5.1 Economy, Employment and Skills



5.1.1 Gravesham's local economy is one of the smallest in Kent. The loss of employment in the lower skilled traditional sectors coupled with limited growth in the higher skilled, professional and office based sectors to replace this loss, together with a lack of well located, modern premises and a generally poorly skilled workforce, have constrained local economic growth. This has resulted in a low number of jobs per head of population with significant numbers of people having to travel outside the Borough for employment.

5.1.2 Opportunities exist to capitalise on the strengths of the area to improve its economic position. These include: taking advantage of investment in High Speed Rail connections and the associated development of Ebbsfleet; proximity to the A2/M25 trunk roads; the opportunities afforded by new technology; the availability of previously developed sites to accommodate new employment; and the Borough's riverside location and heritage.

5.1.3 The approach has been developed against a backdrop of national economic uncertainty that has the potential to affect investment decisions and timing of delivery of jobs at the local level. With the uncertainty about the economic recovery, the Council's economic strategy will enable the Borough to benefit from the economic upturn and prosper economically.

5.1.4 In recognition of the above factors, the Council aims to:

- make Gravesham a place where enterprise can thrive in a sustainable and responsible way;
- build on its strengths to increase economic diversity so that the local economy is more adaptable and resilient to change; and
- facilitate the provision of education and skills training to enable local people to prosper

by taking advantage of the employment opportunities that arise.

5.1.5 The Council recognises that jobs can be delivered from a range of sectors. One of the Council's areas of focus is to ensure that sufficient provision is made for B class employment, which includes offices, industrial and storage and distribution uses, and the range of job opportunities that this can provide. For clarity, B class employment is that in use classes:

- B1(a) Offices;
- B1b Research and Development;
- B1c Light Industrial;
- B2 General Industrial; and
- B8 Warehouse & Distribution

5.1.6 It will seek to achieve this by identifying sufficient employment floorspace to facilitate the provision of at least 4,600 new Full Time Equivalent (FTE) jobs in B class employment by:

- providing for a generous supply of employment sites, to allow market choice and to enable the regeneration of identified sites with appropriate uses;
- ensuring a range of provision for all employment sectors, to allow firms to start-up, grow and adapt to change;
- supporting office development at Ebbsfleet and in Gravesend Town Centre, to expand activity in an under-represented sector;
- supporting the expansion of commercial use of the riverside, where it does not conflict with other stated regeneration objectives;
- protecting existing employment sites, unless they are truly redundant for modern needs or identified elsewhere in this strategy as regeneration opportunities;
- supporting improvements in information communication technology, to increase competitiveness and flexible working practices; and
- supporting proposals that enable local residents to improve and diversify their skills and qualifications.

5.1.7 The policy focuses primarily on the approach to B class employment uses whilst not disregarding the important contribution from other sectors such as retail and hotels. The Council's approach towards meeting retail and commercial leisure, cultural, and tourism needs (which also have the potential to generate employment, along with other land uses) can be found in Policies CS08 and CS09.

5.1.8 The National Planning Policy Framework (NPPF) requires local planning authorities to set out a clear economic vision and strategy for their area to encourage sustainable economic growth. Priority areas should be identified for economic regeneration with sufficient sites available for local and inward investment to match the strategy. Policies should also be flexible enough to accommodate needs that have not been anticipated over the Plan period.

5.1.9 The NPPF also states as a general principle that local planning authorities should avoid the long term protection of sites allocated for employment use where there is no reasonable prospect of a site being used for that purpose. In addition, it advises that planning applications for changes of use from commercial buildings (currently under the B use classes) to residential use and any associated development should normally be approved where there is an identified need for additional housing in that area, provided that there are not strong economic reasons why such development would be inappropriate. The weak economy and the need to apply a precautionary principle to employment land release, whereby new employment must be provided before existing employment land is considered for release to other uses, provide the strong economic reasons for the Council's approach in this policy.

5.1.10 The context within which Gravesham's approach towards the economy, employment and skills has been developed is the South East Plan (which has now been partially revoked) and the designation of the Borough north of the A2 as part of Kent Thames Gateway. This envisaged the creation of a new sub-regional employment hub at Ebbsfleet that would allow for the development of a high density mixed use office based scheme delivering more than 20,000 jobs in Dartford and Gravesham.

5.1.11 Whilst the Council supports this, no employment floorspace has yet been delivered at Ebbsfleet and it is only likely to come forward post 2021. The policy approach is therefore based on the assumption that Ebbsfleet will come forward as a high density office employment driven, mixed used development, acting as a key economic driver across North Kent but that this will be slower than originally anticipated.

5.1.12 This context, coupled with the uncertain economic conditions nationally, underline the need to diversify and reinforce the local economy. It is important that the Council is not overly reliant on one development to drive forward jobs and prosperity and its response is sufficiently flexible to accommodate a range of contingencies.

5.1.13 To address these factors and the need to off-set loss of existing supply at identified regeneration sites, the Council has planned initially for a generous supply of employment land. The monitoring framework will guide the subsequent release of land if it is later found to be surplus, suitable for alternative uses, and has the ability to contribute towards the delivery of sustainable forms of other development needed in the area.

5.1.14 Table 6 sets out, in broad terms, the distribution of new employment floorspace and the approximate number of jobs that this may facilitate over the plan period. Policies CS03 – CS06 set the detailed policy requirements in respect of each of the Opportunity Areas.

5.1.15 The Economy and Employment Space Study (2009) looked at opportunities for growth and identified a high potential to grow employment in the construction and hotels/catering sectors, subject to the Ebbsfleet development coming on stream. Prospects were described as moderate for: marine-related industries; distribution; advanced manufacturing/engineering; media and telecommunications; and retail/leisure. It also identified opportunities for growing the

Gravesend Town Centre office market based on improved rail accessibility and developing a role related to creative, media and design activity. A site at Coldharbour Road was identified as a particular opportunity to bring forward an Enterprise Centre meeting the needs of expanding small and medium sized firms and the provision of incubation space for small business start-ups well located relative to the main road network.

5.1.16 The Council proposes to capitalise on these opportunities for local economic growth and diversification by:

- the creation and expansion of office based employment at Northfleet Rise and Springhead Quarter within the Ebbsfleet (Gravesham) Opportunity Area (sub-areas 4.1 and 4.2) and Gravesend Town Centre (sub-area 3.1);
- delivery of new employment floorspace as part of the mixed use development of Northfleet Embankment (sub-area 1.5), Canal Basin Regeneration Area Key Site (sub-area 2.1), North East Gravesend Regeneration Area Key Site (sub-area 2.6) and Land at Coldharbour Road Key Site; and
- supporting proposals for industrial and warehousing development with multi modal access at Northfleet Embankment East Regeneration Area Key Site (sub-area 1.8); supporting the expansion of commercial use of the riverside and associated marine activities; and seeking improvements to information technology.

5.1.17 Aside from the sites identified for the delivery of new B class floorspace set out in the policy, the potential exists for further development at Swanscombe Peninsula East (sub-area 1.1). However, this is likely to be a longer term option requiring significant improvements to infrastructure and joint working with key stakeholders (including Dartford Borough Council) in order to develop a coherent masterplan approach.

Protection of Existing Employment Sites

5.1.18 As a result of the inherent weakness of the Gravesham local economy and the need to expand it to support choice, diversity and sustainable lifestyles, the Council considers it is important to protect existing employment sites, unless they are truly redundant for modern needs or have been identified through this Core Strategy as suitable for regeneration to alternative uses.

5.1.19 The Economy and Employment Space Study (2009) examined in detail existing and potential employment land supply in the Borough, taking into account the quality and accessibility of the various sites. This found that much of the stock comprises older premises with many poorly located. The lack of supply of good quality modern premises in the right places was seen as a factor in affecting levels of demand. However, the stock makes an important contribution to meeting local needs and little scope for the release of sites for redevelopment was identified.

5.1.20 The future of existing employment sites and the potential for flexibility in terms of the types of employment they might accommodate will be considered in more detail through the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD. In the interim, a criteria based approach using market testing will be applied to assess whether sites should be released to alternative uses.

5.1.21 A similar approach is adopted to marine related uses, such as commercial wharves and land-side support infrastructure, given the potential for such sites to be lost to higher value uses taking advantage of attractive riverside locations. Policy CS11 on Transport also applies where wharves are safeguarded in order to protect the movement of freight and other goods by water. Where rationalisation of wharves or other sites needed to support the River Thames as a working waterway is proposed to support wider regeneration objectives, this will only be acceptable where appropriate alternative provision is available or will be provided which, as a minimum, maintains capacity and provides equivalent or better facilities.

Rural Area

5.1.22 There are few major employment sites within the rural area and supply within or adjacent to the rural settlements, tends to be dominated by small sites. However, such sites do facilitate sustainable lifestyles by providing opportunities for people to live and work locally and they also help to support the delivery of local services. As identified in the Economy and Employment Space Study 2009, interest in new employment space in the rural area is low and opportunities are constrained by the Green Belt. Therefore, it is not proposed to allocate additional land for such uses. Any future demand for employment space will be met through the retention and refurbishment of existing employment space and support for the appropriate conversion of rural buildings in suitable locations to employment use. This includes culture and tourism uses (see Policy CS09 on Culture and Tourism) and the creation of live-work units where there is a reasonable proportion of work space. In assessing proposals, regard will be given to the sensitivity of the location and the impact on the openness of the Green Belt.

Offices

5.1.23 The Council's approach to locating office employment is influenced by:

- existing planning permissions and the desire to bring forward sustainable mixed use developments, reducing the need to travel to work;
- the identification of Ebbsfleet as a future sub-regional office location, with the potential to reduce out-commuting and to make more efficient use of the rail network by encouraging reverse-commuting; and
- recognition of the potential of Gravesend Town Centre as an office location, based on High Speed Rail and improved connectivity with London.

5.1.24 The inclusion of office floorspace as part of the mixed use development of Key Sites included in the Opportunity Areas as set out in Table 6 will therefore continue to be supported.

5.1.25 The location of proposals for new office development will be subject to a sequential test. In line with national policy, Gravesend Town Centre (as defined on Figure 18 in Policy CS08) will be the sequentially preferred location for new office development.

5.1.26 If suitable sites are not available in the Town Centre, the sequentially preferred location will be accessible sites that are on the edge of the Town Centre, along with those areas within 500 metres walking distance of Gravesend Railway Station and Ebbsfleet Station, before out of centre locations will be considered. Ebbsfleet Station is supported as a sequentially preferable location after Gravesend Town Centre to reflect its sub-regional importance as an office location with a public transport hub.

5.1.27 Proposals for new office development which lie outside the Town Centre and are not identified elsewhere in this Core Strategy, which exceed 2,500 sq m floorspace, will be subject to an impact assessment in line with national policy.

Skills

5.1.28 For local residents to take advantage of employment opportunities that arise, it is important that they are equipped with the necessary skills. Conversely, it is important that economic growth is not constrained by the lack of a suitably skilled labour force. Recent investment in educational facilities in Gravesham provide a foundation for the delivery of skills training and it is anticipated that further planned investment will result in the upgrading of a number of other school premises. Therefore, the Council will continue to support the upgrading of educational and training facilities and will seek the delivery of training initiatives through agreement with the developers of Key Sites (see Infrastructure Delivery Schedule).

Policy CS07: Economy, Employment and Skills

5.1.29 In conjunction with the private sector and its regeneration partners, the Council will seek to secure the delivery of around 186,490 sq m gross new employment floorspace over the plan period focusing on the following:

- a major new B1/office employment centre as part of a wider mixed use sustainable development of Ebbsfleet;
- office, industrial and warehousing facilities on Key Sites in the Swanscombe Peninsula and Northfleet Embankment Opportunity Area;
- office development in Gravesend Town Centre as well as retail, culture and leisure (see Policy CS05);
- office, industrial and warehousing development on Key Sites in the Gravesend Riverside East and North East Gravesend Opportunity Area; and
- office and light industrial development in the form of an enterprise centre/incubation space on greenfield land South of Coldharbour Road, Northfleet.

5.1.30 Proposed office development, in addition to that allocated elsewhere within this plan, will be directed in the first instance to Gravesend Town Centre, and then to edge of centre locations, including sites within 500 metres walking distance of Gravesend Railway Station and Ebbsfleet Station, in accordance with the NPPF sequential test. Only if suitable sites are unavailable in these locations, will consideration be given to out of centre locations.

5.1.31 Proposals for office development exceeding 2,500 sq m floorspace which lie outside Gravesend Town Centre and are not identified elsewhere in this Core Strategy, will be subject to an impact assessment in line with the NPPF.

5.1.32 The Council will work with its partners and landowners at Swanscombe Peninsula East to deliver additional employment-led mixed use development subject to a comprehensive masterplan approach.

5.1.33 In considering development proposals, particular support will be given to schemes incorporating small and flexible industrial and/or office workspaces of high quality intended to support the start-up and expansion of small and medium sized enterprises. The Council will also support the refurbishment and upgrading of existing industrial and commercial premises and improvements in information and communications technology to facilitate more flexible working practices and the changing economic needs of the Borough.

5.1.34 Development resulting in the loss of B class employment floorspace will not be supported unless otherwise allowed for by policies set out in the Core Strategy or where:

- the proposal will deliver at least an equivalent number of new jobs on-site or elsewhere within the Borough and the proposed use is consistent with other policies set out in this plan; or
- the existing premises are no longer suited for employment purposes or are incapable of being made suitable at reasonable cost and it has been shown that there is no demand for them through an appropriate marketing exercise carried out in accordance with Council guidance (Appendix 5); or
- the existing premises have an unacceptable environmental impact on the area within which they are situated and this is incapable of reasonable mitigation or the environmental benefit that would arise from the existing use stopping would outweigh the potential loss in employment.

5.1.35 Development proposals facilitating the expansion of river-related employment will be supported, particularly where these involve the use of the river for transport and/or provide specialist training or other facilities intended to support the continued use of the River Thames as a major commercial waterway.

5.1.36 The loss of existing commercial wharves shown on the Policies Map and other land-side supporting infrastructure will not be supported unless a study and supporting evidence shows that they are no longer viable for marine related employment purposes or are incapable of being made so at reasonable cost, and it has been shown that there is no demand for them through an appropriate marketing exercise carried out in accordance with Council guidance (Appendix 5), or appropriate alternative provision is available or will be provided as part of the rationalisation of facilities that, as a minimum, maintains capacity and provides equivalent or better facilities.

5.1.37 The Council will support proposals that promote the appropriate expansion and diversification of the rural area economy. Support will be given to the conversion of rural buildings to employment use/live-work units where it is compatible with national policies for protecting the Green Belt and where it accords with policies in this plan, in particular relating to Green Infrastructure.

5.1.38 The Council will work with its regeneration partners to enhance opportunities for all local people to access the greater range of higher skilled jobs that will arise as a result of the policies above. Support will be given to upgrading educational and training facilities and major development projects will be expected to contribute (either directly or through other agencies) towards the delivery of skills training, the promotion of apprenticeships and work placements.

5.2 Retail, Leisure and the Hierarchy of Centres



5.2.1 A central component of sustainable development is the definition and reinforcement of a network and hierarchy of centres where people can access shops and a range of other uses often found in town centres by all types of transport. This means that all residents can have good access to shops and services, and make choices about how they travel, with opportunities to walk, cycle or use public transport instead of the private car.

5.2.2 In conformity with the National Planning Policy Framework (NPPF), main town centre uses are defined as: retail development (including warehouse clubs and factory outlet centres); leisure, entertainment facilities and the more intensive sport and recreation uses (including cinemas, restaurants, drive-through restaurants, bars and pubs; night-clubs, casinos, health and fitness centres, indoor bowling centres, and bingo halls); offices; and arts, culture and tourism development (including theatres, museums, galleries and concert halls, hotels and conference facilities).

5.2.3 This policy sets out the approach the Council will adopt in relation to the main town centre uses, except office development which is addressed separately under Policy CS07 on Economy, Employment and Skills, and arts, culture and tourism development which is addressed under Policy CS09 on Culture and Tourism.

5.2.4 The NPPF states that planning policies should be positive and promote competitive town centres lying at the heart of the local community. The need for retail, leisure, office and other main town centre uses over the plan period should be met in full and should not be compromised by limited site availability. Below the town centre, the advice is to plan for the management and growth of a resilient network and hierarchy of local centres. The NPPF requires that a sequential test be applied. Large developments are required to undertake an impact assessment and the NPPF requires local planning authorities to refuse planning applications that fail to satisfy the sequential test or are likely to have a significant adverse impact on one or more of the above factors.

The Hierarchy and Role of Centres in Gravesham

5.2.5 In Gravesham, priority will be given to Gravesend Town Centre as the preferred location for new retail, leisure and entertainment facilities, and the more intensive sport and recreation uses. The focus on Gravesend Town Centre is set in the context of the sub-regional hierarchy of centres contained in the South East Plan (2009) which has now been partially revoked.

This established the role of Chatham (also a centre for significant change) and Maidstone as Primary Regional Centres. Gravesend and Dartford were Secondary Regional Centres. Bluewater was treated separately as a specialist comparison Regional Shopping Centre, located out of centre and not forming part of the hierarchy of traditional town centres.

5.2.6 The South East Plan reflected the existing outline planning permission for Ebbsfleet, in allowing for the creation of new local centres, at Springhead Quarter and Northfleet Rise in Gravesham, which provides supporting retail, leisure and service functions to meet the needs of the resident and daytime population. It remains unclear what form or scale this will ultimately take because the retail element will be subject to impact assessment. Ongoing discussions with Dartford Borough Council and the developers will be needed to ensure that these new centre are delivered in a form compatible with both authorities' Core Strategy policies and retail capacity, and will depend on the scale and nature of the development that actually occurs.

5.2.7 The Council's approach to the planning of Gravesend Town Centre Opportunity Area is to ensure that it develops as a multi-functional heritage riverside town. In support of this the Council has defined the extent of the Town Centre as shown on Figure 18 below. Within the Town Centre, in line with the recommendations of the Gravesham Retail Study Update (2012) the Council will seek to improve its comparison retail offer as part of a mix of uses, focusing in particular on providing new larger scale units (250 – 500 sq m) suitable to accommodate national multiple retailers of fashion goods. This is seen as part of a wider strategic approach that also supports the diversification of uses in the town centre; enhancing its cultural/leisure and service functions; strengthening the independent retail sector, as complementary to the offer of national multiples; and improving consumer choice in the offer of convenience goods.

Local Centres

5.2.8 Under Gravesend Town Centre, a network of local centres provides retail shops and services such as post offices, petrol stations and public houses, which enable local communities to meet their everyday needs. In some locations, such as the smaller villages, a lone shop may be the only facility for people to meet their day-to-day retail needs. It is important that these centres and lone village shops are protected and their role and function are retained and enhanced as opportunities arise so that they continue to maintain their ability to perform this function. Proposals for new development will therefore be encouraged which are appropriate to the size of the centre and the local catchment area and where they safeguard the retail character and function of the centre. Over the plan period the network of local centres will change. Development of the Key Sites will create a need for new and expanded local centres to meet the everyday needs of the new residents and the daytime population in these areas.

5.2.9 The local centres are identified on the Policies Map. These centres and their boundaries will be reviewed through the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD.

The Scale of Retail and Leisure Development to be Accommodated

5.2.10 The likely scale and form of retail and leisure development that may need to be accommodated over the plan period has been considered through the: Gravesham Retail and Commercial Leisure Study (2009); Gravesham Retail and Commercial Leisure Study Addendum (2010); and Gravesham Retail Study Update (2012). These retail floorspace projections have been further modified to take account of planned development in the adjoining areas of Dartford and Medway .

Table 7: Summary of Quantitative Retail Need

2028	Sq m
Comparison goods - net sq m	16,660
Comparison goods - gross sq m	22,210
Convenience goods - net sq m	1,620
Convenience goods -gross sq m	2,180
Total - net sq m	18,280
Total - gross sq m	24,390

Source: Retail and Commercial Leisure Background Paper December 2012

5.2.11 These figures should not be taken as imposing a ceiling on the maximum amount of retail floorspace that can be built. The planning system does not exist to constrain growth, competition or consumer choice, rather to promote sustainable development through the application of the NPPF sequential approach and impact testing. The actual phasing and delivery of retail floorspace will therefore be subject to market demand and detailed justification at the time of application, where qualitative as well as quantitative factors may be material considerations.

5.2.12 In accordance with the recommendations of the Gravesham Retail Study Update (2012), no separate allowance is made for retail warehouse type development. Such proposals will be assessed on a case by case basis, with the presumption that comparison retail should be accommodated in line with general policy unless it can be demonstrated that it is not possible to sell the intended range of goods in a normal "High Street" format. Where the case is made for retail in the "warehouse" format and no sequentially preferable site is available in accordance with the policy set out below, the Council's preferred option is that such development should be directed to the West of Town Centre sub-area (3.2) where linked trips to the town centre can be facilitated.

5.2.13 Whilst the Gravesham Retail and Commercial Leisure Study (2009) also considers the potential for attracting new commercial leisure development, the lack of an industry standard approach to identify future needs makes it difficult to recommend levels or forms of provision. Growth in leisure expenditure over the plan period may mean that there is scope for new facilities such as a new cinema; new branded/family restaurants and cafes in large well located

modern units; and new health and fitness facilities.

5.2.14 However, the existing outline planning permissions for Ebbsfleet as a whole, not just within Gravesham, and Eastern Quarry include over 40,000 gross sq m commercial leisure floorspace and this has the potential to compete directly with any new facilities provided in Gravesend Town Centre. Whilst the proposals for Heritage Quarter may include provision for branded/family type restaurants, the absence of current market interest in cinema or other commercial leisure provision precludes the allocation of sites for such uses at this stage (see also Policy CS09 on Culture and Tourism).

Sequential Test and Impact Assessment

5.2.15 The Council requires main town centre uses to be located in the Borough's town and local centres in a form and scale appropriate to the position of the centres in the hierarchy and their character. Within Gravesend Town Centre, the Council has defined a Primary Shopping Area as shown on Figure 18, on the basis of where retail development is currently concentrated (generally comprising primary frontages and those secondary frontages which are adjoining and closely related to them). The primary and secondary frontages will be defined in the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD.

5.2.16 In order to strengthen the vitality and viability of the Town Centre and maintain its role in the sub-region, the Council will direct new retail development to the Primary Shopping Area, as its sequentially preferred location for such uses, and then sites on the edge of the Primary Shopping Area. If suitable sites are unavailable in these locations or the Borough's other centres, out of centre locations will be considered.

5.2.17 Where a case is made for retail in the warehouse format and no sequentially preferable site is available, the Council's preferred option is that such development should be directed to the West of Town Centre sub-area (3.2) where linked trips to the town centre can be facilitated.

5.2.18 Aside from proposals in accordance with Policy CS08 that are designed to reinforce existing or create new local centres, any proposals for other main Town Centre uses will be directed sequentially to the Town Centre then edge of centre before out of centre sites are considered. Proposals for retail development on sites which lie outside the Primary Shopping Area or for any other main town centre uses that lie outside the Town Centre, as shown on Figure 18, and are not identified elsewhere in this Core Strategy, and exceed 2,500 sq m floorspace, will be subject to an impact assessment in line with national policy. For office developments, see also paragraph 5.1.30 of Policy CS07.

Indicative Distribution of New Retail Development

5.2.19 Within the Town Centre, the Primary Shopping Area is the Council's sequentially preferable location for new retail development. It is recognised that there are insufficient sites available within the Primary Shopping Area to accommodate the total need for retail

development over the Plan period. The Heritage Quarter Key Site, located adjacent to the Primary Shopping Area, is the Council's sequentially preferred location for new larger scale retail provision. Heritage Quarter West enables the Council to meet the need for new retail floorspace which is well connected to the existing St George's Centre, the Thamesgate Centre, New Road and the High Street, while Heritage Quarter East enables the provision of a mix of retail and other uses.

5.2.20 Further allowance is made in Table 8 below for retail development to be accommodated within or adjoining the Primary Shopping Area on sites with existing planning permission or other sites suitable for such uses. These include the Lord Street/Parrock Street open air car park sites, both of which are considered to be edge of centre in terms of the Council's sequential approach.

5.2.21 The remaining identified capacity for retail development includes other sites with planning permission in Opportunity Areas outside the town centre, where it is intended to create or expand existing local centres. The figures used are based on assumptions regarding the comparison/convenience goods mix and the ratio of retail to other permitted uses. Further information on this is contained in the Retail and Commercial Leisure Background Paper.

5.2.22 It should be noted that the figures in Table 8 below are indicative and are intended to show that sufficient sites are available to meet identified retail needs in full over the plan period and that this is not compromised by limited site availability. They do not preclude a different floorspace mix as allowed for within the parameters set by planning permissions applying to the respective sites.

Table 8: Guideline Distribution of Retail Development to meet Full Quantitative Need over Core Strategy Period

	Convenience Goods net sq m	Comparison Goods net sq m
Gravesend Town Centre Opportunity Area	-	15,900
Ebbsfleet (Gravesham) Opportunity Area	1,690	1,120
Northfleet Embankment and Swanscombe Peninsula East Opportunity Area	400	-
Gravesend Riverside East and North East Gravesend Opportunity Area	300	-
Total	2,390	17,020
Combined Total	19,410	

Source: Retail and Commercial Leisure Background Paper December 2012

5.2.23 As a result of the uncertainty regarding future requirements for leisure, entertainment facilities and the more intensive sport and recreation uses requiring a town centre site, no strategic site allocations have been included in this Core Strategy but, if identified, they will be considered in subsequent DPDs.



Figure 18: Gravesend Town Centre Plan

Policy CS08: Retail, Leisure and the Hierarchy of Centres

5.2.24 The Council will seek to reinforce a sustainable network and hierarchy of centres by maintaining the sub-regional role of Gravesend Town Centre; protecting and enhancing existing local centres, as shown on the Policies Map, and creating additional local centres to meet local retail needs generated by new development on Key Sites. In support of this the Council will:

- apply a sequential approach to the location of main town centre uses;
- require an impact assessment of larger retail and leisure development;
- support development of a scale and type appropriate to the position of the centres in the hierarchy and their character;
- safeguard the retail character and function of existing and new centres by resisting development that would adversely affect their vitality and viability, and protect lone village shops; and
- encourage the provision of a mix of units including opportunities for small shops and independent traders in all centres.

Gravesend Town Centre*

5.2.25 Gravesend Town Centre will be maintained as the highest order centre within the Borough and retail, leisure, entertainment facilities and the more intensive sport and recreation uses will, unless otherwise allowed for under this policy, be directed as follows:

- The Primary Shopping Area as shown on the Policies Map will be the sequentially preferred location for new retail development followed by edge of centre sites and then out of centre sites;
- The area within the Town Centre (inclusive of the Primary Shopping Area) as shown on the Policies Map will be the sequentially preferred location for leisure, entertainment facilities and the more intensive sport and recreation uses, followed by edge of centre sites and then out of centre sites.

5.2.26 Proposals for around 10,500 sq m gross of primarily comparison retail floorspace (use class A1) outside the Primary Shopping Area will be supported at the Heritage Quarter Key Site where it can be demonstrated that the need cannot be met in the existing Primary Shopping Area.

5.2.27 Where a case has been made for large format retail/commercial leisure development and no suitable sites can be identified following the application of the sequential approach set out above, the Council will support development in the West of Town Centre sub-area (3.2) as its preferred out of centre location for such development.

New and Expansion of Existing Local Centres

5.2.28 Proposals for new local centres and the expansion of existing centres listed will be supported where they are of a scale and form designed to meet local needs arising from associated planned new development:

- Springhead Quarter Key Site, Ebbsfleet
- Northfleet Rise Quarter Key Site, Ebbsfleet
- Old Northfleet Residential Extension Key Site (as an extension to The Hive Local Centre)
- Northfleet Embankment East Regeneration Area Key Site
- Canal Basin Regeneration Area Key Site

Impact Testing

5.2.29 Retail proposals outside the Primary Shopping Area, exceeding 2,500 sq m floorspace, will be subject to an impact assessment in accordance with national policy.

5.2.30 Proposals for leisure, entertainment facilities and the more intensive sport and recreation uses outside the Town Centre, exceeding 2,500 sq m floorspace, will be subject to an impact assessment in accordance with national policy.

* The Gravesend Town Centre Plan (Figure 18) defines the Primary Shopping Area and the Town Centre boundary on the basis of the current uses and commercial activity. In applying this policy, the following definitions will apply:

Edge of Centre: For retail purposes, a location that is well connected and up to 300 metres walking distance of the Primary Shopping Area and, for leisure, entertainment facilities and the more intensive sport and recreation uses, a location within 300 metres walking distance of the Town Centre boundary.

Out of Centre: A location which is not in or on the edge of a centre but not outside the urban area.

5.3 Culture and Tourism



5.3.1 Cultural facilities provide for the pursuit of leisure, recreation, sport, arts and music activities and include a range of uses that add greater diversity to the cultural scene.

Tourism facilities fulfil a similar role and are intended to attract both day trippers and staying tourists to the Borough. Cultural and tourism facilities include museums, theatres, cinemas, restaurants, historic sites, parks and tourist accommodation (e.g. hotels, bed and breakfast accommodation). Such facilities are important to the health and well-being of the Borough's residents and visitors. They also make a significant contribution to the local economy.

5.3.2 Culture should therefore be seen as wide-ranging and cuts across a variety of other policies set out in this Local Plan. This policy focuses primarily on aspects relating to arts, cultural and tourism development. Leisure, entertainment and the more intensive sport and recreation uses are dealt with separately under Policy CS08 on Retail, Leisure and the Hierarchy of Centres. Green Infrastructure is dealt with under Policy CS12 and Greenspace, Sport and Recreation under Policy CS13. Heritage and the Historic Environment are dealt with under Policy CS20.

5.3.3 Whilst Gravesham has many cultural connections (including those relating to the iconic figures of Charles Dickens and Pocahontas), it is the multi-cultural nature of the local community that serves to distinguish it from many of the surrounding towns. Around 10% of the population has connections with India (predominantly the Punjab) and this is reflected throughout the life of the Borough and, in particular, by the construction of the new Siri Guru Nanak Darbar Gurdwara, one of the largest Sikh temples in Europe. However, these connections with India are far older as Gravesend was one of the centres of operation of the East India Company, with its ships sailing from here during the 18th and 19th centuries.

5.3.4 In terms of the physical environment, Gravesham has a number of cultural and tourism assets upon which activity in this area can be developed. These include:

- Heritage, e.g. Gads Hill Place (home of Charles Dickens and proposed location for a new visitor centre), the Chantry Heritage Centre, Cobham Hall and Park;
- Defence Heritage, e.g. Gravesend Blockhouse, New Tavern Fort, Shornemead Fort, and the Woodlands Park Cold War Bunker;
- River, e.g. Town Pier (oldest cast iron pleasure pier in the world) with its pontoon to allow visiting boats, including those providing for leisure trips, and operation of the Gravesend – Tilbury Passenger Ferry;

- Rural recreation, e.g. the Saxon Shore Way and Wealdway long distance paths, Thames and Medway Canal, Shorne Woods Country Park, Jeskyns Community Woodland, and Cyclopark;
- Entertainment, e.g. The Woodville, recently improved to allow the showing of films and live theatre broadcasts (The Paul Greengrass Cinema), thereby reintroducing cinema into Gravesend; and
- Tourism, e.g. the award winning Towncentric tourist and information centre, close to St George's Parish Church, Gravesend and the burial place of Princess Pocahontas.

5.3.5 The Borough further benefits from having a unique setting on the Thames Riverside as well as access to the scenic countryside and historic villages of the Kent Downs. This provides opportunities for small scale and sustainable tourism businesses, providing that these are consistent with protecting the Green Belt and landscape character. Easy access facilitated by high speed train services and the close proximity of Ebbsfleet International Station also has the potential to increase the number of visitors to the Borough.

5.3.6 The National Planning Policy Framework (NPPF) recognises the importance of cultural well-being to providing strong, vibrant and healthy communities. It also states that people's quality of life can be positively improved by improving the conditions in which people take leisure. The NPPF requires the planning system to deliver sufficient community and cultural facilities and services to meet local needs. It also seeks to support sustainable rural tourism that benefits rural businesses, communities and visitors, and which respects the character of the countryside. This includes support for the provision and expansion of tourist and visitor facilities in appropriate locations where needed.

5.3.7 The NPPF includes arts, culture and tourism development (including theatres, museums, galleries and concert halls, hotels and conference facilities) amongst main town centre uses. A sequential approach should be applied to such development, giving priority in the first instance to town centre locations before edge of centre and then out of centre sites.

5.3.8 The Council seeks to increase the contribution of tourism to the local economy, recognises the regeneration benefits that culture and tourism can bring and seeks to encourage a vibrant environment within which the arts, culture and the Borough's heritage can flourish¹¹. This is reflected in the Tourism Strategy for Gravesham. This Strategy recognises the need to promote the Borough's qualities, assets and visitor attractions. It also seeks to maximise opportunities for expanding the visitor economy as a result of regeneration and growth in the area. In addition, it indicates the potential for cruise liner provision to help bring visitors into the Borough and this is supported through Policy CS11 Transport. It further seeks an improvement in the quality and an expansion of visitor accommodation in the Borough through:

- new hotel development with proximity to the town centre and riverside or close to the A2;

¹¹ Gravesham Borough Council Corporate Business Plan 2011 - 2015

- encouraging new bed and breakfast start-ups; and
- investigating the expansion of other forms of visitor accommodation.

5.3.9 Furthermore, the Council's draft Cultural Strategy 2008 sets out to:

- ensure an appropriate range and distribution of high quality cultural and leisure facilities across the Borough; and
- make the area more attractive to incomers and also as a tourist destination.

5.3.10 The evidence suggests that there is scope for new branded/family restaurants and cafes and a new cinema, either a small multiplex or an arthouse/independent cinema, in Gravesend town centre and at Ebbsfleet¹². It also suggests that there is a case for providing a combined Gravesham Museum and Visitor Centre, ideally in the heart of Gravesend town centre¹³. Studies also indicate that Gravesham could experience a significant increase in demand for hotel accommodation. This could be met by new hotels at Ebbsfleet and in Gravesend, particularly in the town centre and close to the A2/arterial routes¹⁴.

5.3.11 Clearly there are opportunities to improve Gravesham's cultural and tourism offer but the lack of specific deliverable projects makes it difficult to be more definitive at the current time. The installation of new projection equipment at The Woodville and art house type cinema showings at the Old Town Hall assist in meeting demand for cinema in Gravesham whilst any need for branded/family restaurants is dealt with under Policy CS08. The value of a museum facility to the town is recognised but what form it might take, its focus, and how it might be delivered and run has not been determined.

5.3.12 Hotels are also a difficult issue in that whilst they are classified as a main town centre use, their location is often dictated by their function and the market they are designed to serve. The Ebbsfleet planning permission allows for hotel development as part of the mix whilst outline planning permission has also been granted for a 60 bed hotel adjacent to the A2 at Coldharbour Road, Northfleet. Notwithstanding this, the Council would still wish to see the town centre as a focus for new visitor accommodation in line with national policy and to support its role as an expanded business centre and tourist destination. The potential to include hotel accommodation as part of the Heritage Quarter development has been identified under Policy CS05 Gravesend Town Centre Opportunity Area.

5.3.13 The policy seeks to protect existing cultural and tourism facilities and to enable the provision of new and enhanced facilities to serve the needs of the Borough's residents and visitors and to maximise opportunities from an expanding visitor economy. It also recognises the value of multi-culturalism in the Gravesham context and the importance of supporting the cultural needs of different sections of the local community. Whilst Gravesend town centre and the local centres are the sequentially preferred location for arts, culture and tourism development, new smaller scale facilities will also be supported in other locations where they

¹² Retail and Commercial Leisure Study 2009

¹³A Museum for Gravesham - Feasibility Study 2010

¹⁴Gravesend Hotel Market Fact File 2011 and Kent Thameside Hotel Futures Study 2007

relate to the location or meet immediate local needs and will not have unacceptable impacts, for example in terms of residential amenity and traffic generation.

5.3.14 Other policies in the Core Strategy, in particular Policies CS12 Green Infrastructure, CS13 Green Space, Sport and Recreation and CS20 Heritage and the Historic Environment, seek to protect and enhance the Borough's important assets which make it attractive to residents and visitors.

Policy CS09: Culture and Tourism

5.3.15 The Council will seek to maximise opportunities for expansion in culture and tourism activity derived from its rich and diverse heritage and green infrastructure assets, its diversity as a multi-cultural community and from regeneration and growth in the area. This will include support for greater use of the river and will capitalise on the benefits of high speed train services; the appeal of Gravesend as a heritage riverside town; and the development of Ebbsfleet as a new business district and transport hub which will enhance and expand the market for visitors. In particular, the Council will:

- seek to protect and support improvements to existing cultural and tourist facilities;
- subject to the application of the sequential approach set out in paragraph 5.3.16, support the provision of new cultural and tourist facilities appropriate to their location and accessibility;
- support proposals that are designed to meet the diverse needs of Gravesham as a multi-cultural community; and
- support sustainable rural tourism and leisure developments that benefit rural businesses, communities and visitors where it is compatible with national policies for protecting the Green Belt and where it accords with policies in this plan, in particular relating to Green Infrastructure.

5.3.16 Unless otherwise justified on the basis of a locational connection, functional justification or a requirement to meet smaller scale local needs, proposals involving arts, culture and tourism development will be directed in the first instance to Gravesend Town Centre as the sequentially preferred location for such development in advance of edge of centre and then out of centre sites*.

* For the purposes of applying this policy, Gravesend Town Centre is identified as the Town Centre boundary on Figure 18: Gravesend Town Centre Plan and on the Policies Map. Edge of centre is defined as a location that is well connected and up to 300 metres walking distance of the Town Centre boundary. Out of Centre is defined as a location that is not in or on the edge of centre but not outside the urban area.

5.4 Physical and Social Infrastructure



5.4.1 It is important that sufficient infrastructure is provided to meet the needs of existing and new residents, employees and businesses within the Borough. Facilities such as GP surgeries, schools and libraries play an important role in providing for the health, welfare, social, educational and spiritual needs of the community. Such facilities can add vibrancy to communities, provide a focus for activities, foster community spirit and contribute to the quality of life for many residents. They can also provide an essential service to communities. The loss of such facilities can have adverse consequences in terms of accessibility to services locally, and can lead to unsustainable travel patterns. It is also important to address existing deficiencies in services. At the same time, planning for infrastructure is being carried out when there are uncertainties over future service delivery models and future funding decisions by national government.

5.4.2 This section specifically deals with physical and social infrastructure. The policy requirements in relation to Green Infrastructure and Green Space, Sport and Recreation are dealt with under Policies CS12 and CS13.

5.4.3 Gravesham Borough has benefited from significant investment in infrastructure in recent years. It has a relatively new police station and community hospital as well as a walk-in health centre. Four of its eight secondary schools received Building Schools for the Future funding which meant that their premises could be refurbished or rebuilt. North West Kent College was redeveloped to provide better facilities. Implementation of the Fastrack Bus Rapid Transport System has begun and aims to provide a high quality, attractive public transport system linking major existing and new developments. Residents, employees and businesses also now benefit from the introduction of High Speed 1 train services from Gravesend to London and from Ebbsfleet to London and the continent. This front-loading of infrastructure has provided capacity for growth in the area.

5.4.4 The provision of infrastructure is recognised as an important part of new development in the National Planning Policy Framework (NPPF). It requires local planning authorities to work with other authorities and providers to assess the quality and capacity of infrastructure for transport, water supply, wastewater and its treatment, energy (including heat), telecommunications, utilities, waste, health, social care, education, flood risk and coastal change management, and its ability to meet forecast demands. It states that Local Plans should identify priority areas for infrastructure provision and should plan positively for the infrastructure required.

This needs to be realistic, taking into account development costs and viability.

5.4.5 The Council has identified requirements for infrastructure over the plan period to support the delivery of the Core Strategy. This has been achieved by engaging with service providers and consulting their plans where relevant, e.g. Commissioning Plan for Education Provision in Kent 2013 – 2018. An Infrastructure Delivery Schedule has been produced which sets out these requirements (see Appendix 6). It shows how infrastructure will be funded, who will provide the infrastructure and when it will be provided. It is a living document which will be kept under review and updated when new information becomes available. Enhancing capacity at the A2 Ebbsfleet junction is essential to the delivery of development at Ebbsfleet and Eastern Quarry, developments which will take place within both Gravesham and Dartford Boroughs and not exclusively as a result of development in Gravesham. A range of other infrastructure such as primary schools and health facilities will also be required to ensure that new and existing developments are properly integrated and that new residents will have access to essential services.

5.4.6 The Council has previously identified the need for more burial space in the Borough, possibly through the provision of a new site¹⁵. The Core Strategy does not identify a site for this but the Council will work with service providers to find a suitable site for potential allocation in the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD, taking into account the policies in this Core Strategy.

5.4.7 Development viability modelling work has been carried out for the various housing markets in Gravesham¹⁶. This shows that there are development viability issues in the areas of the Borough proposed for development, particularly regeneration sites in the Gravesend/ Northfleet urban area. The viability of development largely depends on: the amount of remedial work which needs to be carried out; the density of development; and the amount of affordable housing sought. Development viability will be taken into account when setting out the infrastructure required to serve new developments.

5.4.8 Section 106 of the Town and Country Planning Act 1990 allows local authorities to enter into a legally binding agreement, or planning obligation, with a person with an interest in the land in order to make a development acceptable before planning permission is granted. These agreements are increasingly used to support the provision of services and infrastructure where developments create additional demands for infrastructure, such as transportation, education, health and affordable housing (see Policy CS16 on Affordable Housing). They must be:

- necessary to make the development acceptable in planning terms;
- directly related to the development; and
- fairly and reasonably related in scale and kind to the development.

¹⁵ Future Requirements in Relation to Cremation and Burial Facilities Draft Report December 2009

¹⁶ Affordable Housing Viability Study February 2010

5.4.9 The Government has introduced regulations which allow local planning authorities to charge developers a Community Infrastructure Levy (CIL). This is a standard, locally set charge which is intended to provide infrastructure to support the development of an area. Its purpose is to provide greater transparency and certainty to developers about the amount of money they will be expected to contribute. There will still be a role for planning obligations to be used for site specific mitigation measures.

5.4.10 The Council's strategy is to seek the retention of existing facilities wherever possible. It will also work in partnership with infrastructure providers to address existing deficits in provision. This may be achieved through making better use of existing facilities. To ensure that infrastructure is provided to meet the needs arising from new development, the Council will require developers to provide or make contributions towards the timely provision of infrastructure taking into account the viability of development. This will be achieved through consultation with service providers and negotiations with developers on a site by site basis. It will also be achieved through the introduction of CIL.

Policy CS10: Physical and Social Infrastructure

5.4.11 Support will be given to proposals and activities that protect, retain or enhance existing physical and social infrastructure, or lead to the provision of additional infrastructure that improves community well-being. Where there is the threat of loss of existing infrastructure, consideration will be given to viability and whether sufficient alternative provision is available.

5.4.12 Where new development leads to the need for new or improved physical or social infrastructure, developers will be required to provide or contribute towards this subject to viability considerations. Such infrastructure will be put in place in a timely manner to support new development. All new development should make the most efficient use of new and existing infrastructure.

5.5 Transport



5.5.1 Transport policy is a means of achieving the overall regeneration and development objectives set out in the Core Strategy and the delivery of a sustainable pattern and form of development that assists in combating climate change. The challenge is to meet the additional transport requirements as a result of new development in the Borough and to address existing transport issues whilst remaining an attractive and accessible place to live, work and visit and to do business. Despite this, it is recognised that congestion will increase as a result of natural growth in traffic and new development¹⁷.

5.5.2 The National Planning Policy Framework (NPPF) requires local planning authorities to support a pattern of development which facilitates the use of sustainable modes of transport, i.e. public transport, walking and cycling. Developments that generate significant movement should be located where the need to travel will be minimised and the use of sustainable transport modes can be maximised. Such proposals should be supported by a Transport Assessment and a Travel Plan. The NPPF further advises local planning authorities to identify and protect sites and routes which could be critical in developing infrastructure to widen transport choice.

5.5.3 Policy CS02 on the Distribution of Development sets out the broad location of future development in the Borough over the plan period. The Core Strategy seeks to:

- locate new mixed use development in areas with best access to services and facilities which minimise the need to travel, particularly by car;
- improve the local economy to reduce the need for out-commuting. This can also have an impact on air quality;
- support and where possible provide alternatives to help support a modal shift away from car based transport, e.g. improve public transport including bus, train, cycling and walking provision, and increase the use of water based transport; and
- ameliorate the implications of additional traffic for air quality.

5.5.4 Policy CS10 relating to Physical and Social Infrastructure sets out the general approach to infrastructure and outlines the requirement for development to provide or contribute towards infrastructure to meet the needs arising from new development. The Infrastructure Delivery Schedule sets out the requirements for infrastructure over the plan period to support the delivery of the Core Strategy including transport schemes where known.

¹⁷ Kent Thameside Development of the Transport Strategy - Technical Summary Report (Final Draft) October 2008

5.5.5 In Gravesham, Kent County Council is the transport authority and the Highways Agency is responsible for the A2/M2 trunk road. The Local Transport Plan for Kent 2011-16 sets out Kent County Council's Strategy and Implementation Plans for local transport investment. This document was informed by the draft Kent Thameside Transport Strategy Technical Summary Report 2008. It should be noted that it was produced at a time when Gravesham was planning to meet the South East Plan growth scenario rather than its own housing and employment needs.

5.5.6 The Urban Baseline Study prepared for the Council in 2010 evaluated opportunities and constraints at Gravesend and Northfleet riverside, Gravesend town centre, Ebbsfleet and Northfleet. In terms of access, it found that:

- Gravesend and Northfleet riverside is a major asset but the riverside walk is currently discontinuous and there is poor accessibility at some key access points;
- Ebbsfleet station surroundings have low legibility and poor spatial accessibility;
- Ebbsfleet and Gravesend are well connected by Fastrack and trains but the route has poor environmental quality for pedestrians and cyclists;
- Northfleet station has close proximity to Ebbsfleet station but is currently hidden from the main roads;
- the routes from Northfleet towards Ebbsfleet station are dominated by vehicular traffic and have poor legibility, environmental conditions and accessibility; and
- the routes towards the riverside are hindered by large industrial blocks with inactive frontages.

5.5.7 The above documents are referred to where relevant in the following sections.

Transport Hubs

5.5.8 The Council considers that Gravesend town centre provides an existing transport hub of Borough-wide significance. It is the main destination/origin for bus services operating in the Borough, has conventional and high speed train services to London, a taxi rank, and car parking for those wishing to access the shops and services in the town centre. Currently, bus services serve different locations in the town centre and some stops are poorly related to the railway station. There are plans for an integrated transport interchange at Garrick Street/ Barrack Row which would involve the provision of a bus interchange immediately adjoining the railway station. This is supported through Policy CS05 on Gravesend Town Centre.

5.5.9 The South East Plan identified Ebbsfleet as having the opportunity to create a new transport hub of regional significance based around the international rail station and its associated development. This hub could be developed by giving priority to measures that increase the level of accessibility by public transport, walking and cycling and to the development of high quality interchange facilities between all modes of transport.

Walking and Cycling

5.5.10 It is important to ensure that walking and cycling is the first choice of transport for people for short journeys in the Borough for functional (e.g. work, school) and leisure purposes as they are the most sustainable forms of transport. This helps to reduce congestion and improve air quality. It also makes a significant contribution to the health and well-being of the Borough's residents, workers and visitors.

5.5.11 Policy CS12 on Green Infrastructure seeks to create, protect and enhance a multifunctional linked network of green spaces, footpaths, cycle routes and wildlife stepping stones and corridors, i.e. a green grid. The network will seek to improve access within the urban area, between the urban area and the rural area and along the River Thames for leisure and sustainable travel purposes. This includes support for a Thames Estuary Path for walkers and cyclists.

5.5.12 There is an aspiration for a pedestrian link between Northfleet and Ebbsfleet stations to allow connections to be made between traditional rail services and high speed and international rail services¹⁸ as well as existing and proposed communities. The Urban Baseline Study recommends the provision of pedestrian-oriented and active urban connections between these stations. The Council supports this as it would have the additional benefit of providing improved links between existing communities at Northfleet and the new communities at Ebbsfleet. It would also enhance the Ebbsfleet transport hub.

5.5.13 Opportunities will be taken to improve walking and cycling facilities and networks throughout the Borough. These should aim to provide access to the Gravesend town centre and Ebbsfleet transport hubs and to other facilities such as local centres, parks and schools. Where appropriate, developments will be expected to make appropriate provision towards these.

Bus, Train and Coach Transport

5.5.14 There is a frequent and extensive bus network serving the urban area. The developing Fastrack Bus Rapid Transport System forms part of this. It provides high quality, attractive public transport linking Gravesend town centre with Ebbsfleet, Bluewater, Darent Valley Hospital and Dartford. The bus service in the rural area is less extensive though there are regular services along the A226 towards the Medway Towns and the A227 towards Borough Green and Sevenoaks. The limited scale of development in the rural area is unlikely to provide a catalyst for improved bus services serving this part of the Borough.

5.5.15 The Council seeks to facilitate and encourage further use of public transport. Therefore it will work with Kent County Council, other partners and transport operators to enhance the bus network. This will include maintaining and creating, where justified, segregation lanes and bus priority measures for Fastrack and other bus services. The Council will also require

¹⁸ Local Transport Plan for Kent 2011 - 16 and Kent Route Utilisation Strategy 2010

developers of the Key Sites to provide links to the bus network, including the provision of routes through the sites where appropriate. The requirements are outlined in the Opportunity Area and Key Site policies.

5.5.16 There are good train links to London from five stations on two traditional lines in the Borough. Services from Gravesend have been improved by the introduction of high speed train services which use the high speed line. There are also direct links to the continent from nearby Ebbsfleet International Station.

5.5.17 The Kent Route Utilisation Strategy (2010) produced by Network Rail sets out future plans for the railway network in the Borough. This indicates that there is heavy loading on peak hour trains to London as a result of commuter demand in Kent. Significant investment in 2013 – 2014 has remodelled Gravesend station with an additional platform and extended platforms at both Gravesend and Northfleet stations to accommodate 12 car trains.

5.5.18 Crossrail is a cross-London rail connection. In 2018, this will give access from Heathrow and Maidenhead in the west to Abbey Wood (which lies on the traditional railway line between Gravesend and London) in the east. There is the possibility of the future extension of Crossrail from Abbey Wood to Gravesend to help address future peak capacity issues. The Policies Map shows the land which is safeguarded for this, including facilities at Hoo Junction. The safeguarding to afford protection to High Speed 1 (HS1 - originally Channel Tunnel Rail Link) is also shown. The Council will support proposals to improve train services and facilities in the Borough, including the extension of Crossrail to Gravesend.

5.5.19 There is a significant level of commuting to London by coach from the Borough, although these services are vulnerable to traffic congestion particularly in London. The coaches currently use routes which go through the urban and rural areas and this coach network reduces the need for car journeys.

Freight and River Transport

5.5.20 The Freight Action Plan for Kent 2012 – 16 indicates that Kent County Council supports the expansion of the rail freight industry and particularly the transfer of freight from road to rail. It also supports the transfer of freight from road to waterways. Transportation of freight by water and rail has a number of advantages over transportation by road including reducing carbon, noise pollution and congestion. The reinstatement of the rail freight sidings at Northfleet and heavy rail connection from the North Kent line into the Northfleet Cement Works Regeneration Area (see paragraph 4.4.11) indicates that there are opportunities for providing multimodal alternatives to road transport for the movement of freight in the Borough. The Council supports the transfer of freight from roads to waterways and railways.

5.5.21 Gravesham's location on the River Thames means that river transport has historically been important and some riverside sites provide navigational sight lines and installations. There are a number of commercial wharves on the riverside at Gravesend and Northfleet.

The emerging Kent Minerals and Waste Local Plan proposes that a number of these are safeguarded, protecting them from development which could prejudice their future use for minerals importation. Subject to planning controls being applicable, the safeguarding of wharves is supported by the Council in general terms to enable river freight handling to reduce dependence on road freight transport. However, the Council considers that a more flexible approach is appropriate where wider regeneration initiatives are being sought and it is possible to rationalise assets in ways that, as a minimum, maintain necessary capacity for freight handling and provide equivalent or better facilities. This is the approach followed in Policy CS11 (Transport).

5.5.22 Gravesend's Town Pier has been restored and a pontoon has been installed. The regular passenger ferry service across the river from Gravesend to Tilbury now operates from the new pontoon. It is recognised that there may be opportunities to further develop river based transport to provide longer distance passenger services to the Docklands and central London and to provide greater opportunities for leisure trips. The Council will support such proposals.

5.5.23 The Council's Tourism Strategy (2009) indicates that there is potential for cruise liner provision on the Gravesham stretch of the Thames to help bring visitors into the area which would further improve the local economy. The Council will support provision for cruise liners in the Borough.

Road Transport

5.5.24 The Borough has benefitted from recent investment in a number of road schemes. These include the realignment and widening of the A2 to four lanes, the opening of the Ebbsfleet A2 junction and link road, and changes to the one way system in Gravesend Town Centre as the first phase of implementing the integrated transport interchange. Despite this, parts of the Borough experience traffic congestion particularly during the morning and evening peak periods as a result of commuter based traffic. This is especially the case in the urban area and along the A2. Gravesend town centre experiences congestion on weekdays and on Saturdays associated with retail and other business activities¹⁹. The resulting exhaust emissions have led to poor air quality in some areas which has led to the declaration of a number of Air Quality Management Areas, e.g. one way system in Gravesend town centre, A2, some of the junctions on Old Road East/West.

5.5.25 Kent County Council is planning to expand its Urban Traffic Management and Control system to cover Gravesend town centre. This will help to maximise the efficiency of the local highway network and create smoother traffic flows. It should reduce traffic pollution in the relevant Air Quality Management Areas but this may be balanced by traffic growth.

5.5.26 The Highways Agency has concerns about the impact of development in the Borough and Dartford on the strategic road network and how any impacts will be mitigated. The Council will work jointly with the Highways Agency, Kent County Council, Dartford Borough Council and

¹⁹Kent Thameside Development of the Transport Strategy - Technical Summary Report (Final Draft) October 2008

all other relevant parties to ensure that the transport needs arising from new development in the Borough are met (see Policy CS10 on Physical and Social Infrastructure) and that the most efficient use is made of the existing highway network, e.g. through management measures and the introduction of information systems.

5.5.27 The Dartford Crossing is one of the UK's most important strategic connections but its capacity is considerably overloaded for large periods for the day. The Department for Transport consulted in July 2013 on three alternative options to address capacity issues in the future: enhancement of the existing crossing at Dartford; a new crossing at Swanscombe Peninsula; and a new crossing East of Gravesend. The Swanscombe Peninsula option has since been ruled out by the Secretary of State. Gravesham Borough Council objects to the East of Gravesend Option. Until such time as there is a safeguarded route, it is not possible for the Core Strategy to take any account of the implications of additional capacity.

5.5.28 The Council recognises the constraints to the development of Gravesend Riverside East and North East Gravesend Opportunity Area and resulting impacts on air quality caused by the capacities of the junctions at the Ordnance Road/Milton Road and Dering Way/Lion Roundabout.

Impact of Development on the Transport Network

5.5.29 A Kent Thameside multimodal transport model has been used to assess the impact of development proposed in Dartford and Gravesham. The model runs have shown that, even when a number of committed and funded transport schemes are taken into account, and despite generally good public transport provision, the level of development planned in the Boroughs would significantly affect the operation of the highway network. In response, a package of strategic transport infrastructure improvements at key locations has been identified to enable the development to be realised whilst maintaining an acceptable level of performance across the transport network – the Strategic Transport Investment Programme (STIP). These are listed in the Local Transport Plan and are subject to regular review.

5.5.30 Additional technical work using the development quantities proposed in this plan and the adopted Dartford Core Strategy to 2028 have shown that trips on the highway network will increase significantly, as will use of the public transport network²⁰. The STIP schemes make a contribution towards reducing junction capacity issues but there are also a number of other junctions in the urban area that will potentially have problems. Some of these may be addressed as a result of development. Some will be so constrained by built development that a major scheme will not be possible. Other junctions will require schemes to be developed. Traffic management measures, including Urban Traffic Management and Control, will help maximise the use of the highway network.

²⁰ Kent Thameside Development of the Transport Strategy - Technical Summary Report (Final Draft) October 2008

5.5.31 The following have been identified:

- Improvements may be required at the Tollgate A2 junction (A227 including the junction with Coldharbour Road);
- Public transport provision will be enhanced by the planned integrated transport interchange at Garrick Street/Barrack Row and works to Northfleet and Gravesend railway stations (see paragraphs 4.6.14 and 5.5.8);
- So far as possible, Fastrack and other bus services will need bus priority measures to ensure they can offer a fast and reliable service despite traffic congestion;
- There may need to be changes to existing bus routes or new ones may need to be developed to serve the Key Sites and existing urban area to encourage residents and employees to change from using the private car to using public transport, e.g. A227 Wrotham Road corridor in Gravesend;
- Walking and cycling networks need to be expanded and made more coherent; and
- The location and amount of car parking in Gravesend Town Centre, taking account of proposed developed, will be examined and optimised. Policy CS05 sets out the overall objectives for Town Centre parking.

5.5.32 The Infrastructure Delivery Schedule contains the current list of and status of identified schemes (see Appendix 6). Flows on the transport network will need to be monitored and schemes modified or developed as circumstances evolve as development occurs. The Policy Delivery and Monitoring Schedule (Appendix 3) recognises that a revalidation or replacement of the Kent Thameside multimodal transport model will be required to provide a basis for future scheme evaluation and policy development.

Transport Assessments, Travel Plans and Car Parking

5.5.33 Transport Assessments describe the overall impact of developments on the local transport network, and consider their accessibility by all modes of transport, taking into account any highway or sustainable access improvements that developers propose to implement. The contents of a Transport Assessment will depend on the size, nature and location of a development and the requirements of the Highways Agency (A2 trunk road) and Kent County Council (Transport Authority).

5.5.34 Travel Plans are aimed at promoting sustainable transport options for sites and reducing car dependence and single car occupancy. They can reduce reliance on the private car by promoting the opportunities for travelling to and from sites by public transport, walking or cycling and by offering new opportunities to reduce car use, for example through the establishment of car sharing services or car clubs.

5.5.35 The Council will require applicable new developments to prepare and adopt Transport Assessments and Travel Plans using Kent County Council's guidance "Transport Assessments and Travel Plans, October 2008." It will also require developments to take into account current car parking standards. These will be refined taking into account the availability of alternative

means of transport and accessibility to services and facilities.

5.5.36 Currently, the Council uses the Kent Vehicle Parking Standards which it adopted in July 2006 as Supplementary Guidance. This recognises that the control of parking at new developments is one way of promoting more sustainable forms of transport. It also recognises that parking takes up a large amount of space and has a direct influence on the efficiency of land use, the density of development achieved and its cost. The Parking Standards document states that the parking provision determined for a development should follow an assessment of the travel options by all types of transport that are already available or that can be provided.

5.5.37 Increased traffic as a result of new development can have a significant impact on air quality and on amenity. There is guidance on how developers should assess air quality and mitigate air quality impacts arising as a result of their development proposals²¹. The Council will use this guidance to consider when planning applications will require an air quality assessment.

Policy CS11: Transport

5.5.38 New developments should mitigate their impact on the highway and public transport networks as required. As appropriate, transport assessments and travel plans should be provided and implemented to ensure the delivery of travel choice and sustainable opportunities for travel. Transport assessment work is required to be undertaken in accordance with national and local policy guidance, and to identify detailed highway and public transport network requirements and management arising from the development.

5.5.39 Sufficient parking in new development will be provided in accordance with adopted parking standards which will reflect the availability of alternative means of transport and accessibility to services and facilities.

5.5.40 The Council will support proposals which improve public transport provision and facilities in the Borough. In particular, it will:

- seek to maintain and expand, where justified, segregation lanes for Fastrack and existing bus priority measures elsewhere;
- require Key Sites to include provision for buses;
- support the development of transport hubs at Gravesend Town Centre and Ebbsfleet (in Dartford Borough Council area) to provide high quality interchange facilities between bus, rail, walking and cycling; and
- Ensure an adequate supply of public car parking.

²¹ Kent and Medway Air Quality Partnership Air Quality and Planning Technical Guidance July 2011

5.5.41 The Council will seek improvements to walking and cycling facilities and networks in the Borough including provision in new development as appropriate. These should provide improved access to Gravesend Town Centre and Ebbsfleet and to other services and facilities in the Borough. In particular, the Council will seek the provision of pedestrian and cycle links between Northfleet and Ebbsfleet stations and along the River Thames, as part of the proposed Thames Estuary Path.

5.5.42 Land required for the possible future extension of Crossrail and to protect the High Speed 1 (HS1) railway is safeguarded on the Policies Map and proposals that would prejudice these will be refused.

5.5.43 The Council will support proposals which improve the efficiency of freight transport and provide opportunities for alternatives to road transport where possible. The Council will safeguard wharves, as shown on the Policies Map, subject to the provisions of paragraph 5.1.36 of Policy CS07 (Economy, Employment and Skills).

5.5.44 The Council will support proposals which facilitate the use of the River Thames for passenger transport and enable cruise liners to visit the Borough.

5.6 Green Infrastructure, Sport and Recreation



5.6.1 Green infrastructure is defined by the National Planning Policy Framework as a network of multi-functional green space, urban and rural, which is capable of delivering a wide range of environmental and quality of life benefits for local communities. Green infrastructure, sport and recreation facilities enrich the quality of life for residents and visitors in the Borough. They have a vital role to play in encouraging and enabling active and healthy lifestyles. Green infrastructure is also important for protecting and increasing biodiversity, protecting the landscape and providing improved access for leisure and sustainable travel purposes.

5.6.2 The NPPF seeks to:

- protect existing open space, sport and recreational land and buildings and ensure that developments include green space;
- protect and enhance public rights of way and access;
- conserve and achieve a net gain in biodiversity, including planning for biodiversity at a landscape-scale and identifying local ecological networks;
- protect and enhance public rights of way and access; and
- conserve the landscape and scenic beauty of Areas of Outstanding Natural Beauty as well as protect and enhance valued landscapes.

5.6.3 It states that Local Plans should contain a clear strategy for enhancing the natural environment and supporting Nature Improvement Areas. It further outlines that policies should distinguish between the hierarchy of sites so that protection reflects their status and importance.

5.7 Green Infrastructure



5.7.1 This section addresses Gravesham's multi-functional green space network and its Green Grid, together with wider biodiversity and landscape resources which are considered to form the green infrastructure network of the Borough.

Green Spaces

5.7.2 Gravesham Borough has a number of strategic green spaces and some of these have come about as a result of previous major investments in the Borough, e.g. Jeskyns Community Woodland, and the Cyclopark. The Borough also has a number of more local green spaces such as Windmill Hill and Northfleet Urban Country Park. All green spaces contribute towards the green infrastructure network. Further information on levels of provision and our approach towards them is given in the Green Space, Sport and Recreation section below.

Green Grid

5.7.3 There has been a long term aspiration to develop a linked network of open spaces and routes across the Borough, joining with a wider network beyond the Borough's boundaries. This is known as the Green Grid. The focus of the Green Grid in Gravesham is on building a network that:

- Links green spaces to create green continuity, including ecological continuity, wherever possible;
- Improves access within the urban area, between the urban area and the rural area and along the River Thames for leisure and sustainable travel purposes; and
- Creates safe and attractive routes for walkers, cyclists and mobility-impaired people.

5.7.4 The network includes: public highways, public rights of way and cycle routes, with their associated verges and planting; waterways with their associated bank-sides and verges; railway and road embankments; and green roofs and walls. Ultimately, the Council's aim for the Green Grid is for it to become a well-used, safe and attractive network of green links carrying a variety of non-vehicular paths and ecological corridors through the urban area, and connecting up with local and long distance riverside and countryside trails.

5.7.5 There is a long standing desire to develop a Thames Estuary Path to provide a continuous route for walkers and cyclists from the Thames Barrier in London to the Isle of Sheppey in Kent²² which the Council supports. Natural England is also implementing a Coastal Access Scheme which seeks to create and improve pedestrian access along the coast. Work has started on this scheme in Kent. The Urban Baseline Study recognises the importance of providing open access to the riverside in new developments and creating a continuous riverwalk from Canal Basin to Swanscombe Peninsula. This is supported through both the Green Infrastructure and Transport policies.

5.7.6 There is also an aspiration for a pedestrian link between Northfleet and Ebbsfleet stations. If implemented, such a link would provide part of the Green Infrastructure network but is considered in more detail under Policy CS11 Transport.

Biodiversity

5.7.7 Gravesham Borough has a significant biodiversity resource. This includes:

- Sites of international and national significance for wildlife, e.g. Thames Estuary and Marshes Special Protection Area (SPA) and Ramsar Site, North Downs Woodlands Special Area of Conservation (SAC), and Cobham Woods Site of Special Scientific Interest (SSSI). Internationally significant sites are all designated as Sites of Special Scientific Interest and so are protected by national legislation;
- Species protected by European and/or national legislation, e.g. bats, great crested newts;
- Local wildlife sites which are important for the conservation of wildlife at the county level, e.g. Ebbsfleet Marshes, Court Wood Shorne;
- Roadside nature reserves, e.g. A226 Gravesend Road, Chalk; and
- Priority habitats and species identified in the UK Biodiversity Action Plan, e.g. native woodland including ancient woodland, lowland calcareous (chalk) grassland.

5.7.8 Some previously developed sites in the urban area have high biodiversity value. The green space and green grid networks together with other areas such as school grounds and private gardens also have a role in providing and connecting habitats.

5.7.9 Recent evidence suggests that there has been a decline in bird populations in the internationally significant Special Protection Areas (SPA) and Ramsar sites that make up the North Kent marshes (Thames Estuary and Marshes SPA/Ramsar Site, Medway Estuary and Marshes SPA/Ramsar Site, and The Swale SPA/Ramsar Site). There is currently insufficient evidence to adequately assess the cause of this decline although interim findings indicate that recreational activity causes disturbance to birds and that more development will lead to an increase in disturbance. Further work is being carried out by the North Kent Environmental Planning Group (NKEPG) in relation to this matter. In the meantime, a precautionary approach to development will be applied. This means that developers may need to provide or contribute

²² Thames Estuary Path Survey 2008

to mitigation measures for the recreation needs arising from their developments, which may include provision of alternative greenspace, contributions to visitor control mechanisms and/or management of the SPAs, to ensure that detrimental impacts on the integrity of the SPAs/ Ramsar sites are avoided.

5.7.10 As part of its commitment to ensuring the ongoing protection of SACs, SPAs and Ramsar sites, the Council will: implement the findings of the bird population and visitor studies commissioned by the NKEPG; ensure that any proposed strategic avoidance and/or mitigation measures are adopted as appropriate in all planning documents and in the assessment of planning applications; and adopt a flexible approach that enables development on a case by case basis, which also takes into consideration the potential for in-combination effects based on best available evidence until the full results of the NKEPG studies are available, using a precautionary approach to require Habitats Regulations Assessment (HRA) where effects are uncertain. The Council will consider the need for HRA to be undertaken for sites with outline planning permission at the reserved matters stage.

5.7.11 The Greater Thames Marshes has been declared a Nature Improvement Area (NIA). This recognises that it has a unique yet fractured landscape and significant biodiversity importance but that the biodiversity is in decline and struggling to compete with increasing pressures. The NIA seeks to protect and enhance this valuable habitat, increase numbers of endangered species and protect existing flora and fauna. In Gravesham, the NIA includes the River Thames and much of the marshland to the east of Gravesend.

5.7.12 Local Nature Partnerships have been set up to help local areas to manage the natural environment as a system and to embed its value in local decisions for the benefit of nature, people and the economy. Local Nature Partnerships have been approved for Kent and Thames Gateway.

5.7.13 The strategy is to ensure that there is no net loss of biodiversity in the Borough and to take every opportunity to improve biodiversity. Existing sites of biodiversity value will be protected according to their importance. Where development is proposed, ecological surveys must be conducted and mitigation strategies produced, where applicable, prior to seeking planning permission. Development will then be expected to be designed, laid out and constructed in a manner which protects habitats and important species and also includes features to enhance biodiversity. Biodiversity Opportunity Areas have been identified across Kent and the wider South East which incorporate areas of the greatest biodiversity value. In Gravesham, these comprise: North Kent Marshes; Thames-side Green Corridors; and Medway Gap and North Kent Downs. These areas give opportunities for the restoration or creation of new priority habitats and will be the focus for improvement where opportunities arise, for example through the Local Nature Partnerships and the Nature Improvement Area.

Landscape

5.7.14 Gravesham has a diverse rural landscape, from the marshes around the Thames in the north, arable farmlands to the south and east of Gravesend, and downs and woodland in the south. Part of the nationally important landscape of the Kent Downs Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty (AONB) is located on the eastern side of the Borough and it extends from Shorne south to Vigo. It is designated because of its scarp slope and dry valleys which often retain a downland character and its woodlands are also highly valued. The views from the escarpment are also important. Great weight should be given to protecting the landscape and natural beauty of the AONB. The Kent Downs AONB Management Plan has been adopted by the Council. It sets out a clear vision, aims and policies for the conservation, management and enhancement of the AONB and its setting up to 2019.

5.7.15 The Council can only make informed and responsible decisions on the management and planning of landscapes if it pays proper regard to their existing character. A Landscape Character Assessment for the urban fringes and rural area of Gravesham has been produced. This sets out 11 local landscape character areas. For each area, there is an assessment of condition and sensitivity and guidelines for appropriate actions to protect and enhance the landscape. In addition, it contains generic guidelines for different types of landscape and development. This will be used to inform future decisions on proposals affecting the urban fringes and rural area.

5.7.16 A number of Cluster Studies have been produced which assess the landscape to identify areas that could be enhanced for the benefit of communities in North Kent. As a result of these, funding was received for the creation of the Cyclopark, the restoration of part of the Thames and Medway Canal and the enhancement of the Riverside Leisure Area. The Shorne to Shore Cluster Study is more recent and covers the countryside to the east of Gravesend as far as the built up area of Medway. It seeks to protect vulnerable areas and enhance biodiversity, while also offering opportunities to increase access to the countryside, boost the local economy and raise the profile of the area.

5.7.17 In addition significant investment has been made in terms of accessible green infrastructure in and around Cobham via the Cobham Ashenbank Management Scheme, a new visitor centre at Shorne Woods Country Park; Jeskyns Community Woodland and Ranscombe Farm, which is primarily in Medway.

5.7.18 Landscape features such as trees and hedgerows within the urban area are also important as they help to raise the quality of the environment and the quality of people's lives, as well as providing stepping stones and habitats for wildlife. Therefore, it is important that such landscape features within the urban area are retained and enhanced.

5.7.19 The Council's strategy is to conserve and enhance the landscape character and valued landscapes of the Borough, giving greatest weight to conserving and enhancing the Kent Downs Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty and its setting. Proposals affecting the urban fringe

and rural area will be expected to take into account landscape character. All developments will be expected to protect and enhance landscape features as part of Gravesham's green infrastructure network.

Green Infrastructure Network

5.7.20 The strategic green infrastructure network for the Borough is identified on Figure 19. This shows: existing and proposed long distance walking and cycling routes; movement corridors; and Biodiversity Opportunity Areas. The latter includes: major green spaces, e.g. Shorne Wood Country Park, Jeskyns; strategic green grid corridors, e.g. Cyclopark; and most of the Kent Downs AONB nationally important landscape falling within Gravesham Borough.

5.7.21 It should be noted that all green spaces, the Green Grid, biodiversity resources, and landscape features contribute towards the Borough's green infrastructure network. The strategy is to protect and enhance this network.

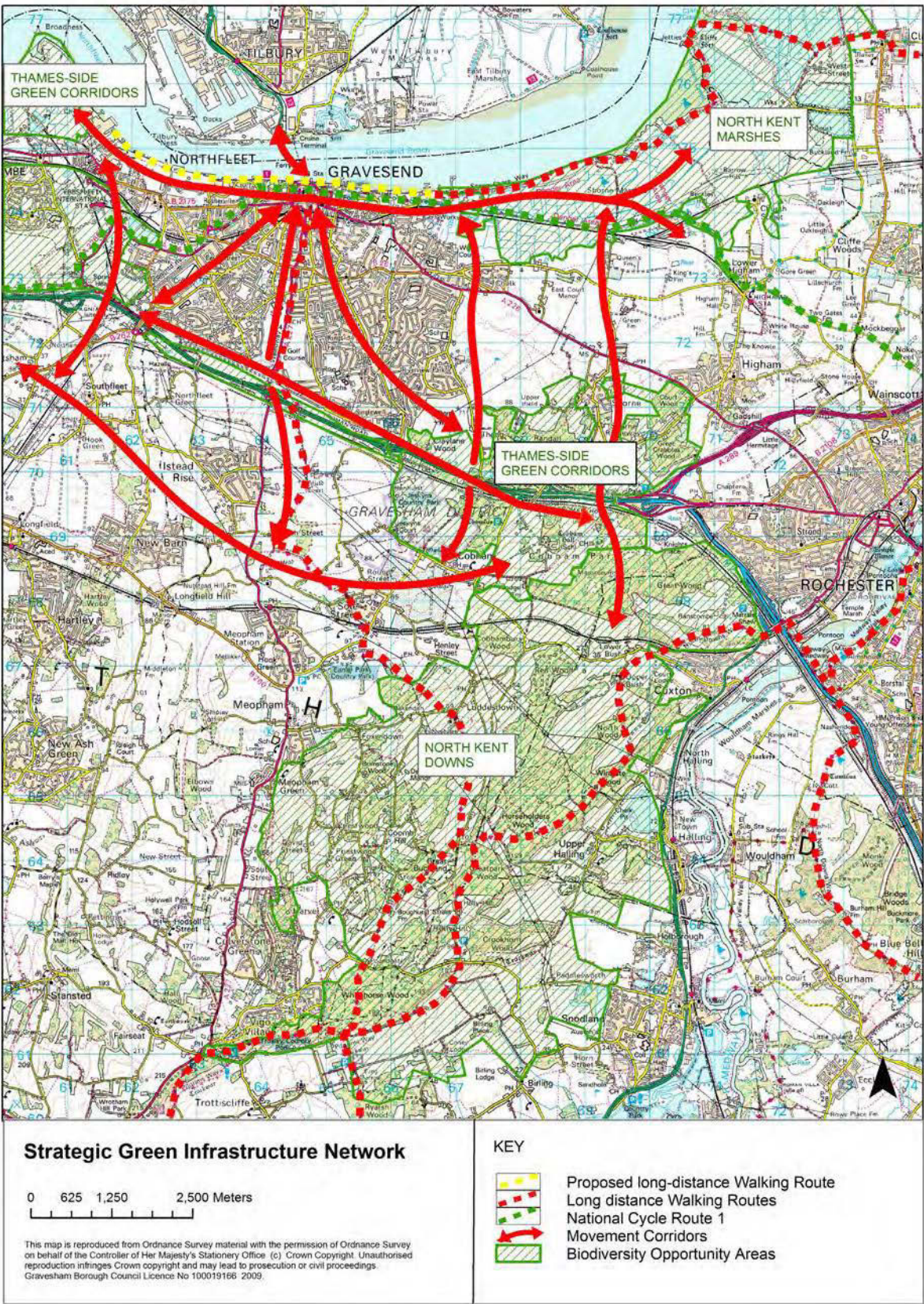


Figure 19: Strategic Green Infrastructure Network

Policy CS12: Green Infrastructure

5.7.22 A multifunctional linked network of green spaces, footpaths, cycle routes and wildlife stepping stones and corridors will be created, protected, enhanced and maintained. The network will improve access within the urban area, from the urban area to the rural area and along the River Thames. The key parts of the network are identified on Figure 19: Strategic Green Infrastructure Network.

5.7.23 Sites designated for their biodiversity value will be protected, with the highest level of protection given to internationally designated Special Protection Areas, Special Areas of Conservation and Ramsar sites, followed by nationally designated Sites of Special Scientific Interest, followed by Local Wildlife Sites and then by other areas of more local importance for biodiversity.

5.7.24 There will be no net loss of biodiversity in the Borough, and opportunities to enhance, restore, re-create and maintain habitats will be sought, in particular within the Biodiversity Opportunity Areas shown on the Strategic Green Infrastructure Network map and within new development.

5.7.25 Where a negative impact on protected or priority habitats/species cannot be avoided on development sites and where the importance of the development is considered to outweigh the biodiversity impact, compensatory provision will be required either elsewhere on the site or off-site, including measures for ongoing maintenance.

5.7.26 The overall landscape character and valued landscapes will be conserved, restored and enhanced. The greatest weight will be given to the conservation and enhancement of the landscape and natural beauty of the Kent Downs Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty and its setting. Proposals will take account of the Kent Downs Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty Management Plan, the Gravesham Landscape Character Assessment, and the Cluster Studies where relevant.

5.8 Green Space, Sport and Recreation



5.8.1 This section addresses provision and standards for green space, indoor and outdoor sport and recreation provision in the Borough.

5.8.2 In Gravesham, green spaces include parks, green corridors, natural greenspace and children's play areas. Facilities such Woodlands Park and Camer Country Park provide opportunities for informal recreation. Gravesham also has a range of formal indoor and outdoor sports facilities. Cascades Leisure Centre in Gravesend and Cygnet Leisure Centre in Northfleet provide a range of facilities including swimming pools, sports halls and health and fitness facilities. Meopham has a fitness and tennis centre. There are also sports pitches, golf courses, bowling greens and a number of other public and private sports facilities which provide the Borough's residents and workers with the opportunity to take part in sport. These are also available to visitors and residents from neighbouring areas. Some playing pitches have a dual function and also provide green space, e.g. Culverstone Recreation Ground.

5.8.3 A study of Gravesham's Open Space, Sport and Recreation facilities has been completed²³. The Council recognises that further work on this is required and will work with Sport England to update it. This work will enable further guidance to be provided in later Local Plan documents and updates to the Infrastructure Delivery Schedule relating to open space, sport and recreation provision, to meet the needs of existing and future residents. The study found that the overall amount of all types of green space in the Borough is sufficient for the needs of the existing population. However, the provision of green space and access to it varies across the Borough. For example, there are issues with the provision of children's play areas, natural greenspace and allotments in much of the urban area and with access to parks in East Gravesend. It found that improvements to the quality of all types of green space are required.

5.8.4 The study found that the overall amount of land for playing pitches in the Borough is sufficient to meet the needs of the existing population. However, whilst there is an overall surplus of adult football pitches, there are shortfalls of junior football pitches and mini-soccer pitches (significant shortfall). Qualitative improvements are needed, particularly in terms of changing room facilities and disabled access at various sites. There are issues of access to and/or capacity of playing pitches. This is particularly an issue for mini-soccer pitches in Northfleet, East Gravesend and the rural area and for cricket, junior football and rugby pitches in much of the urban area.

²³ Gravesham PPG17 - Open Space, Sport and Recreation Study 2010

5.8.5 The study found that there are sufficient quantities of some sports facilities to meet the needs of the current population, e.g. swimming pools, sports halls. However, more health and fitness facilities are needed to meet the needs of the existing population. There is a need for some qualitative improvements to some facilities, e.g. multi-use games areas, indoor tennis courts. There are issues of access to and/or capacity of sports facilities in some locations, for example health and fitness facilities in Central and South Gravesend and outdoor tennis courts in much of Gravesend and Northfleet.

5.8.6 There is a clear need to address existing deficiencies identified in the Gravesham Open Space, Sport and Recreation Study as well as needs arising from new development. The natural growth in the Borough's population over the plan period, the Council's priority to encourage people to increase their level of physical activity and the ageing population will affect the amounts and types of playing pitches and sports facilities needed in the Borough in the future. The Council will work to address these needs by setting standards and considering site allocations in the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies Development Plan Document. The Council's strategy is to: protect existing green space, playing pitch and other sports facilities; address existing deficiencies; and make provision to meet future demands.

Policy CS13: Green Space, Sport and Recreation

5.8.7 The Council will seek to make adequate provision for and to protect and enhance the quantity, quality and accessibility of green space, playing pitches and other sports facilities, in accordance with an adequate, up to date and relevant evidence base.

5.8.8 A set of consistent green space, playing pitch and sports provision standards will be established which will apply to all new development. Provision should be made on-site. However, where this is not possible because of the site size, location or other specified circumstances, alternative provision or the enhancement of existing facilities will be required off-site. In all cases, provision will include arrangements for the ongoing maintenance of the space.

5.9 Residential Development



5.9.1 Housing is about much more than ensuring everyone has a roof over their head. A safe and secure place to call home gives people a strong foundation for every aspect of their lives. Historically, the vast majority of people have aspired to owning their own home and rising prosperity and easily available finance in the previous decade helped many people onto the housing ladder.

5.9.2 In recent years the housing market has experienced significant challenges as a result of turbulence in financial markets. This has resulted in house prices falling, fewer mortgage products, people having financial difficulties and a difficult business environment with a reduction in the number of houses being built. Despite this, the underlying long term trends remain, with clear housing demands from potential first time buyers, growing families and the elderly.

5.9.3 The National Planning Policy Framework (NPPF) requires local planning authorities to ensure that their Local Plan meets the full needs for market and affordable housing in their area, including identifying Key Sites which are critical to the delivery of the housing strategy over the plan period. This includes a mix of housing based on current and future demographic trends, market trends and the needs of different groups in the community such as families with children, older people and people with a disability. It also includes identifying the size, type, tenure and range of housing that is required in particular locations and setting policies for meeting affordable housing need.

5.9.4 In rural areas, the NPPF requires planning authorities to plan housing development to reflect local needs, particularly for affordable housing. The NPPF states that whilst the construction of new buildings in the Green Belt is not appropriate, it does make an exception for limited affordable housing for local community needs under policies in the Local Plan.

5.10 Housing Type and Size



5.10.1 Different households require different types and sizes of housing. It is important that the Core Strategy plans for the provision of an appropriate choice and mix of housing across the Borough in order to create balanced and sustainable communities. Widening housing choice broadens the appeal of an area and assists in meeting the needs of existing residents as well as attracting new residents to the Borough. Ensuring that new housing takes account of local need and existing provision is essential.

5.10.2 The Strategic Housing Market Assessment (SHMA) found that in both affordable and market housing, there is both overcrowding and under-occupation. It states that many households will be unable to move to more suitable housing either because of affordability or lack of supply. The Core Strategy seeks to ensure that an adequate amount of new housing to meet local housing needs (Policy CS02) and affordable housing (Policy CS16) is provided to cater for future needs. However, the size and type of housing provided is also important.

5.10.3 The SHMA Update indicates that there is a need for a mix of house sizes for both market and affordable housing. For market housing, it shows a significant need for three bedroom (47%) and two bedroom (31%) properties. For affordable housing, which comprises social and intermediate housing, it shows that the greatest need is for one bedroom properties (37%) but it also shows significant needs for two bedroom (32%) and three bedroom (28%) properties. When considering the type and size of affordable housing, the dwelling needs of households on the Council's housing register and particularly those in greatest need should also be taken into account.

5.10.4 Whilst new housing can provide different sizes of units, the existing housing stock also has a significant role to play in ensuring that a mix of housing is provided. The SHMA recommends that the conversion of family homes (taken to be homes with two or more bedrooms) into smaller units should be restricted so that new families have more choice within the market and, by doing so, will improve the flow of smaller homes onto the market that they vacate.

5.10.5 There will be a growth in the older population in the Borough over the plan period. This will be associated with an increase in the numbers of those who have difficulties completing household tasks and self-care activities. There will also be an increase in those with a limiting long term illness. As a result, the SHMA recommends that the building of market housing particularly suited to the needs of older households and other special needs groups should be

encouraged. This includes encouraging the provision of specialist and extra care housing. It is important that housing to meet the needs of older people is provided in accessible locations close to services. It could also help to meet the future requirement for family homes as a result of older households downsizing.

5.10.6 As a result of the above, the Council's strategy is to plan for a mix of house sizes and types that will be appropriate to the differing needs of the community. It will protect existing family sized housing (two and three bedroom homes) to ensure that a sufficient number of larger units are maintained. The Council will also seek to ensure that more homes are built which are designed to meet the longer term needs of older and disabled people as well as supporting the provision of specialist housing to meet such needs.

5.10.7 The Council supports the provision of housing to meet the requirements of people in special need of help or supervision, where conventional housing may not be suitable. However, it is important that the concentration of residential institutional accommodation is controlled. This will ensure that the properties themselves are suitable and that the intensification of use in residential areas will not change the character of the area, nor involve a loss of amenity to residents because of the potential noise and disturbance it could create (including the impacts from service traffic) outside normal working hours. The Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD will include policies relating to residential institutional accommodation.

Policy CS14: Housing Type and Size

5.10.8 The Council will protect the mix of housing in the existing housing stock and will resist the conversion of family sized residential units to smaller properties.

5.10.9 The Council will expect new housing development to provide a range of dwelling types and sizes taking into account the existing character of the area and evidence of local need to create sustainable and balanced communities.

5.10.10 Sheltered housing and extra care housing for people with special needs will be supported on suitable sites in areas with access to a range of services that provide for the needs of future occupants.

5.11 Housing Density



5.11.1 The demand for additional homes by 2028, the finite amount of previously developed land and the competing demand for uses put increasing pressure on land and require innovative approaches to help deliver high quality housing. Density can affect the development value and the Affordable Housing Viability Study (2010) considered a range of densities.

5.11.2 The density of housing can have an impact on local character and distinctiveness. The Council wishes to ensure that land is used efficiently but this needs to be balanced with delivering the right type of housing to meet the needs of the whole community in the right location.

5.11.3 It is important that the densities sought do not adversely affect the quality and character of an area and the general well-being of residents. The appropriate density will be design led and will have regard to the accessibility of each site. Therefore appropriate densities will vary across the Borough. A minimum density of 40 dwellings per hectare will be sought in the urban area. Higher densities will be sought in the Gravesend Town Centre and Ebbsfleet Opportunity Areas as they are transport hubs with good access to public transport. Lower density housing may be more appropriate in the rural area. Density is measured by the number of dwellings per hectare.

5.11.4 High density does not always mean high rise development, and high density schemes can provide good quality attractive housing, including family provision through a range of built forms.

Policy CS15: Housing Density

5.11.5 Sites will be developed at a variety of densities, depending on their location and accessibility to public transport. The form and density of housing will vary across the larger sites, in response to accessibility and other characteristics of each part of the site. Variations in density across a site should be used to develop different character areas.

5.11.6 All new housing will be developed at a density that is consistent with achieving good design and does not compromise the distinctive character of the area in which it is situated. Subject to this overriding consideration:

- Within the urban area, new residential development will be expected to achieve a minimum density of 40 dwellings per hectare. In suitable locations close to the transport hubs of Gravesend Town Centre and Ebbsfleet, higher densities will be sought;
- In the rural area, new residential development will be expected to achieve a minimum density of 30 dwellings per hectare.

5.11.7 Development proposals that fail to make efficient use of land for housing, having regard to the character and location of the area, may be refused planning permission.

5.12 Affordable Housing



5.12.1 Affordable housing is defined as housing with sale prices or rent levels which are set substantially lower than the prevailing market price or rent, so that it will be accessible to local people in priority housing need, whose incomes are insufficient to enable them to afford housing on the open market. It includes social rented, affordable rented and intermediate housing (see glossary for definitions). Affordable housing should remain at an affordable price for future eligible households.

5.12.2 The SHMA Update indicates that Gravesham has a significant need for affordable housing (52%). The Council needs to be realistic about what can be delivered when setting its targets. Given this, different affordable housing targets for the different Gravesham sub-markets were tested in the Affordable Housing Viability Study. This recommended that the Council should introduce separate targets for the proportion of affordable housing to be included in housing developments, based on the differing residual land values of urban and rural sites. It considered a 30% target for the urban area and a 35% target for the rural area to be appropriate for achieving the maximum delivery of affordable housing.

5.12.3 The Study also concluded that a smaller threshold for the delivery of affordable housing in the rural area would be justified as a substantial majority of all new dwellings would be developed on sites of less than five dwellings. Consequently, the Council has decided to retain what was then the national threshold of 15 dwellings or more or on sites of 0.5 hectares or more in the urban area and a locally derived threshold of 3 dwellings or more or on sites of 0.1 hectare or more within the rural area. The Council will seek an affordable housing mix of 70% affordable and social rented and 30% intermediate. It represents a balance between the desire to maximise the provision of affordable and social rented accommodation for those in greatest need, with the desire for balanced communities and recognition of viability considerations. The NPPF requires careful attention to be paid to viability and costs in plan making and decision taking to ensure that development is deliverable. If, at the planning application stage, the applicant considers the proportion of affordable housing to be unviable, an open book viability assessment will be required to justify a lower provision.

5.12.4 Affordable housing will be provided on-site unless both the Council and the applicant agree and can robustly justify why it would be preferable for provision to be made on an alternative site or a financial contribution made for development to take place elsewhere.

5.12.5 The SHMA indicates that whilst rural areas are typically wealthier than urban areas, they will still contain many households who face acute housing needs. This is best addressed through local housing needs surveys. Rural Housing Needs Surveys are being undertaken in the Borough on an ongoing basis to identify the specific affordable housing needs of the rural parishes and settlements. It is recognised that it might not be possible to fully deliver the scale of affordable housing identified in these surveys in the rural settlements which are inset from the Green Belt. Consequently, some of the local need for affordable housing might need to be met within the Green Belt. The NPPF states that limited affordable housing for local community needs under policies set out in the Local Plan is not inappropriate in the Green Belt. Cross subsidy or other mechanisms to deliver market housing in the Green Belt will not be acceptable under this policy.

5.12.6 It is not appropriate to quantify a particular number of dwellings that will be considered to be “limited” for affordable housing in the Green Belt as this will primarily depend on the level of local community need identified together with the following:

- The size and character of the built up area of the individual settlement concerned, and its position in the settlement hierarchy;
- As a solely affordable housing site, this may also limit the size of the site to ensure mixed communities and could mean that the development of two or more sites might be preferable to one large site; and
- The type of affordable housing being proposed, such as extra care, where the viability of a scheme may depend on its scale.

5.12.7 It is considered that affordable housing in the Green Belt should be provided in a sustainable location. The accessibility of the site to services and facilities and the position of the settlement in the settlement hierarchy will be used to assess this, whilst recognising that the level of local community need is normally considered at a parish level. Consideration will also be given to the impact of proposals on the built and natural environment under Policies CS19 Development and Design Principles and CS12 Green Infrastructure.

5.12.8 Proposals for affordable housing development in the Green Belt will need to ensure that they are restricted to households who are either current residents of the parish or have an existing family or employment connection.

Policy CS16: Affordable Housing

5.12.9 The provision of affordable housing will be required on all new housing developments of: 15 dwellings or more or on sites of 0.5 hectares or more in the urban area; and 3 units or more or on sites of 0.1 hectares or more in the rural area.

5.12.10 The amount of affordable housing to be provided by private housing development sites above the threshold will be 30% in the urban area and 35% in the rural area.

5.12.11 The Council will seek an affordable housing mix of 70% affordable rented and social rented accommodation and 30% intermediate housing.

5.12.12 Development will be subject to site viability and a tenure mix necessary to meet local needs and achieve a successful sustainable and socially inclusive development.

5.12.13 In the Green Belt, limited affordable housing in a sustainable location for a proven and justified local community need will be supported. Such units once constructed will be occupied by people with a proven local community connection. This includes affordable rural workers dwellings. In all cases, permissions granted under this policy will be restricted to those uses in perpetuity.

5.13 Provision of Traveller Sites



5.13.1 The Council is responsible for assessing the housing needs and allocating land to meet the needs of all sections of the local community including Gypsies, Travellers and Travelling Showpeople. This policy sets out a fair and effective approach to addressing the accommodation needs of this section of the community and provides a basis for determining planning applications on unallocated sites.

5.13.2 For the purposes of this policy, Gypsies, Travellers and Travelling Showpeople will be referred to as Travellers. It is recognised that the needs of Travellers vary. The policy will apply to those members of the Travelling community who meet the definitions set out in Annex A of the Planning Policy for Traveller Sites (March 2012).

5.13.3 National policy recognises that Travellers have the same rights and responsibilities as other citizens and supports their traditional travelling way of life. It requires needs assessments to be carried out to establish unmet need and requires sites to be provided to address this. In addressing site provision, sites should be sustainably located. The location should be appropriate for residential use and provide access to local services and facilities to promote social inclusion. New sites are inappropriate in the Green Belt and will be restricted in other protected areas (see Policy CS01 on Sustainable Development and paragraph 4.1.3 of its supporting text). Where unmet need is being addressed, proposals that do not accord with planning policies can be refused.

5.13.4 In January 2013 there were eight Gypsy and Traveller sites in the Borough providing pitches for 25 households. There is a publicly owned site at Denton, Gravesend, which has eight pitches. The remaining seven sites are a mix of pitches with permanent and temporary planning permission. There are currently no transit sites or plots for Travelling Showpeople in the Borough. There are an unknown number of Travellers accommodated in permanent dwellings.

5.13.5 The Council has published a Traveller Accommodation Assessment (TAA)²⁴ to provide up to date evidence of Traveller pitch need in the Borough up to 2028. The TAA has been carried out as part of a series of assessments involving neighbouring authorities in the North Kent Housing Market Area (Dartford, Medway and Swale) along with Tonbridge & Malling and Ashford. This has been undertaken using a common methodology to ensure consistency of approach and to enable any cross boundary trends to be identified.

²⁴ Gravesham Traveller Accommodation Assessment April 2013

5.13.6 The findings of the TAA identify a need for 16 new pitches over the plan period. This is broken down into five year periods, starting from January 2013, as follows:

2013 – 2017	8 pitches
2018 – 2022	3 pitches
2023 – 2027	4 pitches
2028	1 pitch

5.13.7 The TAA found a lack of evidence of any need for Travelling Showpeople plots or the provision of a transit site in the Borough. However, it did support joint working with other local authorities, either on a North Kent or Kent-wide basis, to create a network of transit facilities across Kent, whether in the form of a hard site or a series of stopping places.

5.13.8 Since the survey work underpinning the TAA was completed in December 2012, permanent planning permission has been granted for four pitches that were previously unauthorised (due to lapsed temporary permissions). These are not taken into account in the final figure of pitch need in the TAA and will make a significant contribution towards meeting some of the identified need in the first five years of the plan period. The TAA will be reviewed on a regular basis to inform the five year supply of deliverable sites over the plan period.

5.13.9 The Council will safeguard the supply of permanent Traveller sites. Opportunities to expand and/or increase the density of existing permanent sites within the urban area will be investigated. If necessary, the Council will seek to make provision for new sites within the urban area and rural settlements inset from the Green Belt.

5.13.10 Site allocations and a criteria-based policy will be included within the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies Development Plan Document (DPD). In advance of producing the DPD, planning applications for windfall sites will be considered against the provisions of the National Planning Policy Framework and the Planning Policy for Traveller Sites.

Policy CS17: Provision of Traveller Sites

5.13.11 The Council will seek to meet the housing needs of Travellers in the Borough by:

- **Safeguarding traveller sites with permanent planning permission for their current use unless it can be demonstrated that they are no longer needed to meet identified need;**
- **Investigating opportunities to extend existing permanent sites within the urban area; and**
- **Supporting new sites within the urban area and rural settlements inset from the Green Belt which accord with policies in this plan, in particular those relating to Development and Design Principles, Climate Change, Green Infrastructure, and Heritage and the Historic Environment.**

5.14 Climate Change



5.14.1 Climate change is expected to lead to hotter, drier summers and warmer, wetter winters with increased storm and flood events. Human activity has the potential to have a profound impact on both the scale and rate of that change. The NPPF recognises the role that planning can have in supporting the transition to a low carbon future in a changing climate, taking full account of flood risk and coastal change, and by encouraging the reuse of existing resources and the use of renewable resources. As a result, it requires Local Plans to take account of climate change over the longer term, including factors such as flood risk, coastal change and water supply.

5.14.2 The Council has signed up to Climate Local Kent which is a voluntary local agreement by the Kent local authorities to collectively recognise and address climate change issues as a key priority. It is a public commitment to lead and encourage others at a local level, recognising the social, economic and environmental benefits of action against climate change. It provides a framework within which the Council can continue to refine its detailed local response to the effects of climate change whilst participating in a suite of programmes and initiatives developed at the county level. The policies that follow also contribute towards this broader approach.

5.14.3 Climate Local Kent accords with the Council's Corporate Plan which includes a pledge to work with partners to mitigate and adapt to the effects of climate change on the Borough and proactively reduce the impact the council and its operations, its residents and its businesses have on climate change.

5.14.4 The following sections address the climate change issues of: flood risk; the Water Framework Directive and Thames River Basin Management Plan; sustainable drainage and surface water run-off; water demand management; carbon reduction; and coastal zone management. These are areas of expected change because of technological advances and further research. Changes to national standards are also occurring in some cases. The Council is seeking to achieve an effective and deliverable approach to these issues in light of these changes.

Flood Risk

5.14.5 Parts of the Borough are at risk from flooding. The main concern is the risk of tidal flooding from North Sea storm surges which would affect the River Thames. Most of the areas alongside the river have a high standard of protection by defences. However, a risk of flooding

still exists in these areas because of the possibility of defence failure or over-topping during extreme events. The risk posed by flooding from other sources (fluvial, pluvial, surface water and groundwater) also needs to be taken into account.

5.14.6 The NPPF states that inappropriate development in areas at risk of flooding should be avoided by directing development away from areas at highest risk, but where development is necessary, making it safe without increasing flood risk elsewhere. It advises that Local Plans should be supported by a Strategic Flood Risk Assessment and should take account of advice from the Environment Agency.

5.14.7 In light of the above, the NPPF requires the application of a sequential test which steers new development to areas with the lowest probability of flooding. It recognises that it may not be possible for development to be located in zones with a lower probability of flooding if it is to meet wider sustainability objectives. In such cases, it allows an exception test to be applied. For the exception test to be passed, it must be demonstrated that:

- the development provides wider sustainability benefits to the community that outweigh flood risk; and
- the development will be safe for its lifetime taking account of the vulnerability of its users, without increasing flood risk elsewhere, and, where possible, will reduce flood risk overall.

5.14.8 The NPPF further states that land that is required for current and future flood management should be safeguarded from development. It also advises Local Plans to use opportunities offered by new development to reduce the causes and impacts of flooding.

5.14.9 The Thames Estuary 2100 (TE2100) project aims to develop a long term tidal flood risk management plan for London and the Thames Estuary. The TE2100 Flood Risk Management Plan shows that there are unlikely to be major changes to the existing system of defences over the plan period. However, it is likely that there will be changes in the longer term. All the options include a new flood defence to the north east of Gravesend and some of the options include a new Thames flood barrier, either at Long Reach, Dartford, or between Gravesend and Tilbury. This needs to be taken into account in the Council's approach.

5.14.10 A Strategic Flood Risk Assessment (SFRA) was carried out for Kent Thameside (Dartford and Gravesham Boroughs) in 2005 and updated in 2009. This showed the different zones of flood risk in the Borough, particularly for potential development sites, to inform the application of the sequential and exceptions tests. It also made a series of recommendations including:

- New developments should ensure that flood damage is limited in order to remove the risk of loss of life through appropriate mitigation measures;
- New developments should be "future proofed" against uncertainty and local flood risk assessments will help address this;

- When the opportunity arises, flood gates should be replaced with solid defences and the provision of new gates to enable access to the foreshore should be discouraged; and
- New developments should provide and maintain flood management infrastructure.

5.14.11 Most of the Borough's Opportunity Areas, and the Key Sites within them, are in areas at risk of tidal flooding along the River Thames. These areas have been identified for development required in order to achieve the long-standing strategy of regenerating Gravesham by the concentration of development on previously developed land. As a result, some sites identified along the Thames Riverside do not comply with the sequential approach. Therefore, these will need to meet the exceptions test set out in the NPPF which means that they will need design solutions that provide a safe environment for those living and working there. Other sites which come forward in the Borough will need to meet the sequential test. In order to assess whether the sequential and exceptions tests are met, proposals for development in flood risk areas will need to be accompanied by a Flood Risk Assessment and a Flood Risk Management Plan, where this is deemed necessary, to ensure the safety of the occupants and/or users of a development during a flood event.

5.14.12 Given the risk of tidal flooding in Gravesham, the future changes which may come about as a result of the TE2100 project and the recommendations of the SFRA, the Council will seek to prioritise the maintenance, improvement or replacement of flood defence infrastructure over other land uses. In addition to meeting their own flood defence and flood management needs, new developments will be expected to take advantage of opportunities to reduce the causes and impacts of flooding from all sources where it is technically and financially feasible to do so.

Water Framework Directive and Thames River Basin Management Plan

5.14.13 The Water Framework Directive seeks to improve the quality of the local water environment for people and wildlife, and promote the sustainable use of water. It applies to all surface water bodies, including lakes, streams and rivers as well as groundwater. The overall aim is for all water bodies to reach "good" status by 2027. In Gravesham, this would mean improving their physical state and preventing deterioration in water quality and ecology. The Directive also introduced the concept of integrated river basin management plans and these should influence Local Plans. Gravesham lies within the Thames River Basin District and the Environment Agency published the Thames River Basin Management Plan in December 2009. The Core Strategy policies seek to support the objective of the Water Framework Directive and actions of the Thames River Basin Management Plan.

Sustainable Drainage and Surface Water Run-Off

5.14.14 Whilst waste water capacity is primarily an infrastructure issue, climate change will have an impact on the waste water system due to increased winter rainfall and storm events. This means that combined sewers and other surface water drainage will have to deal

with increased flows. Therefore, it is important that such impacts are mitigated through the introduction of Sustainable Drainage Systems (SUDS). These are solutions that manage surface water and groundwater sustainably; they seek to mimic natural drainage systems and retain water on or near to the site. In addition to reducing flood risk, SUDS have a number of other benefits such as enhancing water quality, providing a sympathetic environmental setting for development and providing a wildlife habitat.

5.14.15 The Kent Thameside Water Cycle Study recommends that for larger sites, or where there will be several developments in one area, a SUDS “management train” (a series of progressively larger-scale practices to manage run-off) approach should be adopted. Subsequent to the above study being undertaken, a new system was introduced under the Flood and Water Management Act 2010. This effectively prioritises SUDS over conventional drainage designs.

5.14.16 The practical application of the new system under the 2010 Act has yet to be determined. Therefore, the Council’s approach is to ensure that surface water run-off from new development has, as a minimum, no greater adverse impact than the existing use and to support SUDS as the preferred drainage solution where it is feasible to do so.

Water Demand Management

5.14.17 Gravesham is one of the driest areas in the South East, a region which has very low levels of rainfall overall. Evidence was produced to support the planned levels of housing and employment growth required by the South East Plan²⁵. This showed that water supply was not a constraint on that level of development. This position has since been confirmed through Southern Water’s and Thames Water’s Water Resource Management Plans which cover the period to 2034 and the findings of the Kent Thameside Water Cycle Study. In view of this, it is assumed that the lower rates of growth now intended in Gravesham are also manageable.

5.14.18 There is still a need to manage demand for water in an area which is water-stressed. As a result, the Water Cycle Study recommended that:

- All new homes should be built to level 3/4 of the Code for Sustainable Homes in terms of water use (105 litres per person per day consumption);
- A small percentage of new homes, e.g. 5%, should be built to level 5/6 of the Code for Sustainable Homes in terms of water use, possibly as exemplars (80 litres per person per day consumption);
- Retrofitting be promoted, where it is cost effective, to offset a proportion of the demand
- from new development; and
- New non-household developments should meet the Building Research Establishment Environmental Assessment Method (BREEAM) “excellent” rating for water efficiency, and the collection of rainwater should be implemented.

²⁵ South East Plan Technical Note 4 Water and Growth in the South East March 2006

5.14.19 The Council's strategy is to minimise water use by requiring the suggested standards for water efficiency to be met in new developments. Within existing housing stock and where it is not possible to meet the above standards on development sites, the Council will support retrofitting of water efficiency measures within existing residential properties.

Carbon Reduction

5.14.20 The Core Strategy seeks to reduce greenhouse gas emissions through the appropriate location and design of future development in the Borough. The NPPF requires local planning authorities to support energy efficiency improvements to existing buildings and to take into account the Government's zero carbon buildings policy and national standards when setting local requirements for building sustainability. The aim is to move towards zero carbon development and to reduce the overall carbon footprint of the Borough.

5.14.21 To help increase the use and supply of renewable and low carbon energy, the NPPF states that local planning authorities should:

- Have a positive strategy to promote energy from renewable and low carbon sources;
- Design their policies to maximise renewable and low carbon energy development while ensuring that adverse impacts are addressed satisfactorily;
- Consider identifying suitable areas for renewable and low carbon energy sources; and
- Identify opportunities where development can draw its energy supply from decentralised, renewable or low carbon energy supply systems and for co-locating potential heat customers and suppliers.

5.14.22 The Code for Sustainable Homes is the national standard for the sustainable design and construction of new homes. It aims to reduce carbon emissions and is intended to help promote higher standards of sustainable design above current minimum Building Regulations. It uses a one to six star rating system, with six being the most sustainable. The Code is not mandatory and there is no plan to make it mandatory but it can be required where local authorities stipulate this in their Local Plans.

5.14.23 The Building Research Establishment Environmental Assessment Method (BREEAM) sets the standard for best practice in sustainable building design, construction and operation. It is more commonly used for assessing non-domestic buildings.

5.14.24 The Government is moving towards introducing zero carbon standards from 2016 for all new homes and from 2019 for all new non-domestic buildings through changes to Part L of the Building Regulations. Zero carbon will be achieved through a combination of: fabric energy efficiency which will require that new homes are sufficiently well insulated and adequately air tight; carbon compliance (the overall on-site contribution to zero carbon) which includes on-site low and zero carbon heat and power, e.g. solar panel electricity systems; and allowable solutions which are methods to deal with the remaining regulated emissions to meet zero carbon standards, e.g. investment in off-site renewable electricity or combined heat and power

(CHP) systems. Beyond setting minimum standards for fabric energy efficiency and carbon compliance, the emerging system is likely to follow the Zero Carbon Hierarchy model set out in Figure 20 and be designed to allow for flexible solutions that encourage technical innovation and cost reduction.

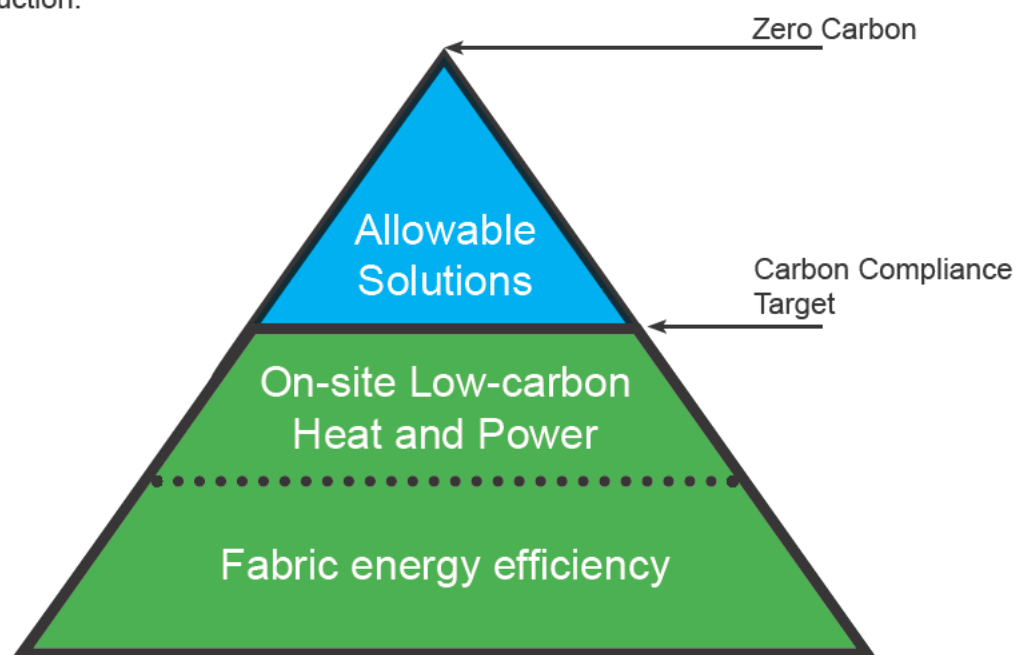


Figure 20: Zero Carbon Hierarchy

5.14.25 An Eco-Assessment for Kent Thameside was completed in 2010 to understand the potential for renewable and low carbon energy in the area and to identify how this could be realised. This made the following key points:

- Consideration should be given to the renewable and low carbon heat potential of the Key Sites and the town centre;
- It highlights the opportunities where stand-alone low carbon and renewable energy technologies might be exploited, e.g. wind energy;
- There is the opportunity for a Kent Thameside microgeneration initiative to promote the installation of small scale renewable energy technology. Particular reference is made to the opportunity to create a biomass hub at Northfleet Embankment East as part of development proposals; and
- It recommends that local standards exceeding or introduced in advance of changes to the Building Regulations would not be appropriate and a Supplementary Planning Document on sustainable design and construction to facilitate the transition to zero carbon homes/buildings should be produced instead.

5.14.26 In relation to the final point, the Sustainability Appraisal recommended that the policy should include BREEAM and Code for Sustainable Homes targets, as well as water demand management.

5.14.27 The evidence shows that the Key Sites and the town centre have potential for incorporating renewable and low carbon technology. Whilst Policy CS18 follows the advice of the Eco-Assessment for Kent Thameside in not seeking to impose a higher carbon standard in advance of proposed changes to Building Regulations, it is considered appropriate that Key Sites throughout the Borough and other major development elsewhere in the Gravesend Town Centre Opportunity Area consider the potential to include proposals for low carbon and renewable energy generation, including combined heat and power. As explained in paragraph 5.14.24, this would form part of the consideration of measures needed to meet requirements in terms of carbon compliance of allowable solutions. The final design solution adopted to achieve zero carbon on such sites should be justified by the submission of evidence.

5.14.28 The Council also supports proposals for stand-alone decentralised, renewable or low carbon energy development. It is recognised that such development may employ a range of different technologies where the impact of proposals will depend on location and will need to be evaluated on a case by case basis. Small scale proposals for renewable or low carbon energy production (particularly at a domestic scale) may not always require planning permission. Proposals for larger scale development such as wind turbines or solar farms may also arise in the rural area of the Borough. These developments can have an impact on landscape character, particularly in the nationally important Kent Downs Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty. As a result, proposals will need to take into account other policies in this plan, in particular those relating to protecting the Green Belt from inappropriate development, Green Infrastructure, Development and Design Principles, and Transport. Opportunities may exist to combine carbon reduction with green infrastructure objectives through the use of locally produced biomass fuels which may also improve the sustainability and biodiversity of the Borough's woodlands.

5.14.29 The Eco-Assessment has identified the potential for a biomass hub at Northfleet Embankment East. It is considered that the scale and mix of development proposed elsewhere may also provide opportunities for Combined Heat and Power installations. This is particularly the case where the development sites adjoin those in Dartford Borough or where development sites are close to existing residential or commercial areas that can be integrated into a wider network. The Council also intends to roll out the national "Green Deal" initiative as an appropriate alternative to the microgeneration initiative. This can be targeted towards areas and groups where wider carbon reduction and fuel poverty objectives can be achieved in a cost effective way. This will be taken forward through the Council's corporate approach to climate change under Climate Local Kent.

5.14.30 The introduction of local standards for reducing the carbon footprint of new buildings in advance of changes to the Building Regulations is not recommended in the Eco-Assessment but the Sustainability Appraisal contradicts this advice. Whilst there remain uncertainties about the forthcoming regulatory framework to achieve zero carbon standards, the evidence currently available does not support a policy that would effectively only apply for a very short time. In view of this, the Council is not seeking to introduce local standards.

5.14.31 The Council recognises that there may be other opportunities to reduce the carbon footprint of the Borough. It also includes potential initiatives whereby contributions from developers towards allowable solutions could be used for carbon reducing initiatives elsewhere in the Borough. Such initiatives could include retrofitting existing homes and properties. The Council will encourage and support such initiatives where appropriate to do so.

5.14.32 The section above deals with operational carbon rather than embodied carbon. Embodied carbon refers to the carbon emissions created by the production of the building up to the point it comes into use. Operational carbon refers to carbon emissions resulting from the use of the building. Embodied carbon is not currently included in the national definition of zero carbon. As such, it is inappropriate for this Core Strategy to include policy requirements for embodied carbon but this may be revisited through the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD.

Coastal Zone Management

5.14.33 In coastal areas, the NPPF requires local planning authorities to take account of the UK Marine Policy Statement and marine plans and apply integrated Coastal Zone Management to ensure the integration of terrestrial and planning regimes. It further states that risks arising from coastal change should be reduced by avoiding inappropriate development in vulnerable areas or adding to impacts of physical changes to the coast. Areas likely to be affected by such changes should be identified as Coastal Change Management Areas and policies applied as appropriate.

5.14.34 Marine planning, including the preparation of Marine Plans, will be carried out by the Marine Management Organisation (MMO). Marine Plans must be consistent with the Marine Policy Statement and they will make a significant contribution towards coastal integration. They will guide developers about where they are likely to be able to carry out activities or where restrictions may be placed on what they do.

5.14.35 The Thames Estuary falls within a proposed Marine Planning Zone but the MMO has not yet started work on a Marine Plan for this area. Until the implications of this work are fully understood, it is premature for the Council to pre-empt the outcome of the marine planning process. In the interim, the MMO is consulted under the Duty to Co-operate. Policy CS12 on Green Infrastructure seeks to ensure that there is no net loss of biodiversity in the Borough and that opportunities to enhance it are sought which should ensure that the Council's policies are compatible with Natural England's proposed Thames Estuary Marine Conservation Zone. Also of relevance in this respect is the Environment Agency's work on: the Greater Thames Coastal Habitat Management Plan; the Thames River Basin Management Plan; and the TE2100 Plan.

Policy CS18: Climate Change

Flood Risk

5.14.36 With the exception of the previously developed sites along the Thames Riverside (see Policies CS03, CS04 and CS05) and those other regeneration sites which have already been evaluated in accordance with the sequential and exception tests at the application stage, development will be directed sequentially to those areas at least risk of flooding.

5.14.37 Proposals in areas at risk of flooding must be accompanied by a Flood Risk Assessment (in accordance with national policy and Environment Agency standing guidance as appropriate) and a Flood Risk Management Plan (if required) to demonstrate that they are adequately defended and safe over their lifetime. Planning permission will be refused for schemes which do not pass the sequential and exception tests.

5.14.38 The Council will prioritise the maintenance, improvement or replacement of flood defence infrastructure over other land uses where relevant. In addition to meeting their own flood defence and management needs, the Council will expect new development to take advantage of opportunities to reduce the causes and impacts of flooding from all sources where it is technically and financially feasible.

Water Quality

5.14.39 As part of its approach to climate change and environmental improvement, the Council will have regard to the delivery of the Water Framework Directive and associated Thames River Basin Management Plan objectives to support water bodies being progressively improved to “good” status over the plan period.

Sustainable Drainage and Surface Water Run-Off

5.14.40 The Council will seek to minimise the impact of drainage from new development on waste water systems. In particular, the Council will:

- Require that surface water run-off from all new development has, as a minimum, no greater adverse impact than the existing use; and
- Require the use of Sustainable Drainage Systems on all developments where technically and financially feasible.

Water Demand Management

5.14.41 The Council will seek to manage the supply of water in the Borough and reduce the impact of new development on the supply of potable water as much as possible. In particular, the Council will:

- Require all new homes to be built to at least level 3/4 of the Code for Sustainable Homes in terms of water use (105 litres per person per day consumption). Where it can be demonstrated that a development is unable to meet these standards, or the additional standards set out below, permission will only be granted if provision is made for compensatory water savings elsewhere in the Borough;
- Seek 5% of homes on Key Sites to act as exemplars by meeting level 5/6 of the Code for Sustainable Homes in terms of water use (80 litres per person per day consumption);
- Require all non-residential developments of 1,000 sq m and above to meet the BREEAM "excellent" standards of water efficiency and include provision for the collection of rainwater; and
- Support proposals to retrofit existing residential properties in ways which reduce water consumption.

Carbon Reduction

5.14.42 The Council will seek to reduce the overall carbon footprint of the Borough. In particular, the Council will:

- In the context of national policy on the transition to zero carbon development via amendments to Part L of the Building Regulations, require proposals for development of the Key Sites throughout the Borough and other major development elsewhere in the Gravesend Town Centre Opportunity Area to consider the potential and include proposals for low carbon and renewable energy generation, including combined heat and power. Where choosing not to do so, applicants must submit evidence which demonstrates that compliance is not technically or financially feasible or that improved fabric energy efficiency or an allowable solution results in improved carbon saving benefits;
- Support stand-alone decentralised, renewable or low carbon energy development where it is compatible with national policies for protecting the Green Belt and where it accords with policies in this plan, in particular those relating to Development and Design Principles, Transport, Green Infrastructure, and Heritage and the Historic Environment; and
- Support other proposals which lead to a reduction in carbon footprint including the retrofitting of existing homes and businesses, including local initiatives based on carbon off-setting via allowable solution

5.15 Development and Design Principles



5.15.1 Gravesham has a distinct and diverse character, with its unique heritage as an historic riverside town, surrounded by distinct rural settlements set in an attractive rural landscape, which is highly valued by residents and visitors alike. Over the plan period, the Council proposes to prioritise development in the urban area as the most sustainable location for development. To deliver this strategy, the Council will seek to achieve the most efficient use of land. This in turn will lead to increases in the density of the built environment, particularly in the urban area and the rural settlements inset from the Green Belt. The challenge is to ensure that new development is well designed so that it strengthens the character and distinctiveness of the area, safeguards local amenity and makes a positive contribution to the environment.

5.15.2 This policy gathers together the design requirements from a range of policies in the Core Strategy. Developers should refer to all relevant policies in the plan to inform their submission.

5.15.3 The Council will seek to manage new development in a way that makes a positive contribution to the built, historic and natural environment. Ensuring new development is attractive and fit for purpose, reinforces local character and safeguards people's amenity is the key to achieving successful neighbourhoods and gaining community acceptance of changes to their local area. However, this does not mean that only traditional design solutions will be supported. The Council recognises the positive impact that contemporary, innovative design solutions can have in appropriate locations, particularly where they embrace sustainability and enhance local distinctiveness.

5.15.4 General design principles underpinning good design are set out in national policy and other locally adopted documents, including the Kent Design Guide (Supplementary Guidance) and the Kent Downs AONB Management Plan. For residential development, "Building for Life 12" (BFL12) is the national standard for residential design quality. It comprises 12 design assessment criteria which are used to assess the elements that determine the quality of housing developments. The Council recommends that collaborative dialogue takes place so that everyone who has an interest in new homes and neighbourhoods works together and uses the BFL12 questions to help build more homes and better homes that result in the creation of better places to live. These principles underpin the Council's approach to design.

5.15.5 The Council recognises that different parts of the Borough present different contexts for new development and therefore require different design responses if they are to be successfully integrated into the surrounding area. To help understand the character of the

Borough, a range of studies have been carried out which include a Landscape Character Assessment, a Townscape Appraisal and an Urban Baseline Study. Appraisals of most of the Borough's conservation areas have been undertaken and a range of Management Plans produced to inform decisions and guide investment decisions in these areas. Furthermore, some communities, such as Meopham, have prepared their own Parish Plan and this includes a consideration of the settlement's character.

5.15.6 In line with national policy, the Council recognises that safety and security are essential in creating successful places where people wish to live and work. In considering the design and layout of proposals, applicants will have regard to the principles contained in current guidance such as "Secured by Design", "Crime Prevention through Environmental Design" and "Park Mark" (for car parks).

5.15.7 National policy recognises the contribution that a high quality public realm makes in creating successful places. Public art is a component of the public realm and can contribute to the creation of a strong sense of place and local distinctiveness in a scheme. It can take many forms from physical pieces to creative lighting, street furniture and street paving. The Council will expect applicants to consider opportunities to provide public art as an integral part of their approach to the public realm.

5.15.8 There is a strong case for seeking improvements to achieve more sustainable new development. The degree to which new development incorporates sustainable construction and makes efficient use of resources, including land, are important components of good design. In line with national policy, the Council will support new development that uses land efficiently and incorporates innovative designs and measures to address the causes and effects of climate change, as set out in Policy CS18.

5.15.9 In support of their proposals, applicants will be required to submit Design and Access Statements. These will explain the design principles that have informed the approach underlying the planning application and demonstrate how the applicant has taken account of the design criteria and guidance adopted by the Council and other relevant planning policies and studies set out in the Core Strategy. Statements will also demonstrate how the design ensures that everyone, including disabled, older people and very young children, will be able to use the buildings and spaces being created and how crime prevention measures have been incorporated within the proposal. Current best practice guidance on Design and Access Statements can be found in the Commission for the Built Environment (CABE) document "Design and Access Statements: How to write, read and use them".

5.15.10 To support the delivery of well designed, successful developments, the Council will encourage pre-application discussions with developers, particularly for major development proposals, sensitive development or proposals that affect a wide area. For larger and more complex proposals, developers may also be required to submit additional information to support their application, such as a spatial masterplan, development brief, concept statement or design codes.

5.15.11 A proportionate amount of stakeholder and community engagement should also be undertaken to ensure that the design approach responds to expert advice and the needs and wishes of those who will use the places or buildings created or be impacted by them. Where proposals are likely to have a significant impact on the appearance and functioning of an area, developers will be encouraged to seek independent advice from the South East Design Review Panel (currently delivered through Design South East), to inform their design approach.

5.15.12 The space within and around individual dwellings is an important factor in the quality and adaptability of accommodation, the well-being of occupants and the impact of a proposed development on the character and amenity of the surrounding area. Currently the Council uses its Residential Layout Guidelines, which were adopted in 1996 as Supplementary Planning Guidance, to ensure that housing layouts, room sizes, internal arrangements and amenity space meet a minimum standard. All new residential accommodation, including conversions, will normally be required to conform to the space standards set out in the current Supplementary Planning Guidance. It is expected that the minimum internal floorspace standards will be exceeded to create good quality accommodation and to ensure future adaptability of the dwelling.

5.15.13 The Council will provide further guidance on these design principles in the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD and through Supplementary Planning Documents.

Policy CS19: Development and Design Principles

5.15.14 New development will be visually attractive, fit for purpose and locally distinctive. It will conserve and enhance the character of the local built, historic and natural environment, integrate well with the surrounding local area and meet anti-crime standards. The design and construction of new development will incorporate sustainable construction standards and techniques, be adaptable to reflect changing lifestyles, and be resilient to the effects of climate change. This will be achieved through the criteria set out below:

- Using the collaborative approach advocated in Building for Life 12 and in line with the guidance set out in Kent Design, the design, layout and form of new development will be derived from a robust analysis of local context and character and will make a positive contribution to the street scene, the quality of the public realm and the character of the area. Account will be taken of the scale, height, building lines, layout, materials and other architectural features of adjoining buildings. Account will also be taken of the wider site context, including strategic views, site topography, the significance of heritage assets and features of townscape and landscape value which contribute to local character and sense of place;
- New development will encourage sustainable living and choice through a mix of compatible uses which are well connected to places that people want to use,

including the public transport network, local services and community facilities; encourage sustainable travel; enhance Green Grid links and encourage healthier lifestyles;

- New development will be located, designed and constructed to:
 - safeguard the amenity, including privacy, daylight and sunlight, of its occupants and those of neighbouring properties and land;
 - avoid adverse environmental impacts from pollution, including noise, air, odour and light pollution, and land contamination; and
 - not pose an unacceptable risk or harm to the water environment, including the quality and/or quantity of ground waters, surface waters, wetlands and coastal water systems;
- The design and layout of new residential development, including conversions, will accord with the adopted Residential Layout Guidelines;
- New development will be designed in an inclusive way to be accessible to all members of the community;
- New development will provide appropriate levels of private and public amenity space;
- New development will include details of appropriate hard and soft landscaping, public art, street furniture, lighting and signage and will ensure that public realm and open spaces are well planned, appropriately detailed and maintained so they endure;
- Car parking will be well related to the development it serves;
- New development will protect and, where opportunities arise, enhance biodiversity and the Borough's Green Infrastructure network. Support will be given to environmental enhancements where opportunities arise;
- New development will be fit for purpose and adaptable to allow changes to be made to meet the needs of users;
- The design and layout of new development will take advantage of opportunities to build in resilience to the effects of climate change. This will include protection against flood risk, where relevant, delivering carbon reduction, provision for low carbon and renewable energy, and minimising energy consumption and water use;
- New development will incorporate appropriate facilities for the storage and recycling of waste; and
- The layout of new development will create a safe and secure environment and provide surveillance to minimise opportunities for crime and vandalism.

5.16 Heritage and the Historic Environment



5.16.1 Our heritage is a valuable but fragile asset, so easily destroyed but so important in how we define or make sense of the world within which we live. As our heritage comprises remnants of the past, such assets that have been passed down to us must be treated as a non-renewable resource. The principle of sustainable development therefore dictates that we should act as custodians of our heritage, meeting the Borough's current needs and aspirations whilst enabling future generations to benefit from, interpret and enjoy this irreplaceable legacy. The richness and diversity of local heritage assets sets much of Gravesham apart from other areas and provides a strategic advantage upon which to build its future role and identity.

5.16.2 In addition to their cultural, architectural and historic importance, these assets have the potential to act as a significant draw for inward investment and heritage led regeneration. This is both through the enhancement of their settings and the creation of a more interesting and attractive place to live, work and visit.

5.16.3 Of particular importance in defining the heritage interest of Gravesham are:

- The historic town centre of Gravesend in its riverside setting, together with the Borough's urban conservation areas and their settings;
- The Borough's historic villages, many of which include conservation areas at their core, and their countryside settings; and
- The Borough's extensive maritime, military, industrial and transport history that is revealed in surviving built form and archaeological remains.

5.16.4 The Borough also benefits from having many literary connections with Charles Dickens and from the presence of historic Cobham Hall and its surrounding landscape.

5.16.5 National planning policy clearly establishes that conservation and enhancement of the historic environment should be afforded considerable importance within the planning process and that decisions should be made on the basis of an informed evaluation of the significance of designated and non-designated assets. The weight accorded the heritage interest in any decision will depend on the significance of the asset and the degree of harm caused to it or its setting compared to the public benefit that may derive from the development proposed. It also allows local authorities to consider the benefits of enabling development to secure the future conservation of a heritage asset.

5.16.6 The nature and form of heritage assets within the Borough are extremely diverse and extend beyond those which may be subject to statutory designation. Further information on the Borough's heritage assets can be found in the Heritage and Character Baseline Report December 2009. Depending on their heritage significance, and the value placed upon them by the local and wider communities, these assets contribute towards what makes the Borough distinctive and how people relate to it.

5.16.7 The Borough's key heritage assets include:

- Listed Buildings (approximately 300 statutorily listed buildings) such as Gads Hill, Higham, the former home of Charles Dickens;
- Conservation Areas (23 in total) such as The Hill Northfleet;
- Scheduled Monuments (9 in total) such as Gravesend Blockhouse;
- Historic landscapes, landscape features, parks and gardens such as Cobham Park;
- Known archaeological sites and areas of archaeological significance; and
- A significant number of un-listed buildings and features of local historic and/or architectural value.

5.16.8 The Council has undertaken appraisals of some of its conservation areas and has developed a range of management plans to inform proposals and decisions and to guide investment in the built environment. In addition, the Council can prepare lists of locally important buildings. Such buildings are not of national importance but still make a significant contribution to the character and quality of an area because of their local architectural or historic interest. Whilst the Council has maintained a list of locally important buildings for some years, it is intended that this will be updated and included in a Supplementary Planning Document on heritage and the historic environment in due course. This work will set out and consult on clear criteria (including architectural, historic and townscape significance) and the process to be followed for identifying locally important buildings.

5.16.9 The Council will expect any proposals for development to demonstrate a thorough understanding of the heritage significance of any affected assets, their context and setting. Proposals should have regard to any relevant conservation area appraisals and associated management plans, lists of buildings of national and local architectural or heritage interest and guidance relating to areas of archaeological interest adopted by the Council.

Policy CS20: Heritage and the Historic Environment

5.16.10 The Council will accord a high priority towards the preservation, protection and enhancement of its heritage and historic environment as a non-renewable resource, central to the regeneration of the area and the reinforcement of sense of place.

Particular attention in this regard will be focused on those heritage assets most at risk through neglect, decay or other threats. Securing viable, sustainable and appropriate futures for such assets at risk will need to be reconciled with the sensitivity to change that many present.

5.16.11 Proposals and initiatives will be supported which preserve and, where appropriate, enhance the significance of the Borough's heritage assets, their setting where it contributes to the significance of the asset and their interpretation and enjoyment, especially where these contribute to the distinct identity of the Borough. These include:

- Gravesend Town Centre, its development as a heritage riverside town, and its setting;
- The Borough's urban and rural conservation areas; and
- Surviving built features and archaeology relating to the Borough's maritime, military, industrial and transport history.

5.16.12 When considering the impact of a proposed development on a designated heritage asset, the weight that will be given to the asset's conservation value will be commensurate with the importance and significance of the asset. For non-designated assets, decisions will have regard to the scale of any harm or loss and the significance of the heritage asset.

Appendices

Appendix 1 – Saved Policies of the adopted Gravesham Local Plan First Review 1994 (wholly or partially) superseded by the Gravesham Local Plan Core Strategy

1.1 The Gravesham Local Plan First Review was adopted in 1994. Many of its policies have been saved by the Secretary of State in a Direction letter issued in September 2007. Some of these saved policies have been replaced in whole or in part by policies in the Gravesham Local Plan Core Strategy.

1.2 Saved policies which are wholly replaced or deleted as they are no longer relevant are now cancelled and will no longer form part of the Development Plan.

1.3 Saved policies which are replaced in part remain part of the Development Plan. In these cases, both old and new policies remain part of the Development Plan. Where there is a difference, greater weight should be given to the Core Strategy policy.

1.4 The remaining saved policies from the Local Plan First Review will continue to apply.

Gravesham Local Plan First Review Saved Policies	Action: a) Replaced by the Local Plan Core Strategy; or b) Continue to save; or c) Deleted
Housing	
H0 - General Housing	Replaced by: CS02 - Scale and Distribution of Development CS14 - Housing Type and Size CS16 - Affordable Housing
H2 - Residential Layout Guidelines	Replaced by: CS19 - Development and Design Principles
H3 - Character of Housing Areas	Replaced by: CS14 - Housing Type and Size CS15 - Housing Density CS19 - Development and Design Principles
H5 - Increasing the Housing Stock by Conversion	Continue to save. Review as part of the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD

H6 - Provision to Meet Special Housing Needs	Continue to save H6 (iii). Remainder of the Policy is replaced by: CS14 - Housing Type and Size CS16 - Affordable Housing
Employment	
E0 - General Employment	Replaced by: CS07 - Employment, Economy and Skills
E1 - Existing Industrial Areas	Replaced by: CS07 - Employment, Economy and Skills
E3 - Non-conforming Users	Deleted
E5 - Change of Use to Offices	Continue to save. Review as part of the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD
Shopping	
S0 - General Shopping Policy	Replaced by: CS08 - Retail, Leisure and the Hierarchy of Centres
S1 - Location of New Shopping Development	Replaced by: CS08 - Retail, Leisure and the Hierarchy of Centres
S2 - Change of Use to Shopping	Replaced by: CS08 - Retail, Leisure and the Hierarchy of Centres
S3 - Maintenance of Shopping Frontages	Continue to save. Review as part of the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD
S4 - Non-shopping Uses in the Shopping Areas	Continue to save. Review as part of the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD
S5 - Upper Floors in Shopping Streets	Replaced by: CS05 - Gravesend Town Centre Opportunity Area

S6 - Local Centres	Replaced by: CS08 - Retail, Leisure and the Hierarchy of Centres
S7 - Hot Food Shops and Restaurants and other A3 Uses	Continue to save. Review as part of the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DP
Townscape, Conservation and Design	
TC0 - General Townscape, Conservation and Design	Replaced by: CS12 - Green Infrastructure CS19 - Development and Design Principles CS20 - Heritage and the Historic Environment
TC1 - Design of New Developments	Replaced by: CS19 - Development and Design Principles
TC2 - Listed Buildings	Continue to save. Review as part of the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD
TC3 - Development Affecting Conservation Areas	Continue to save. Review as part of the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD
TC4 - Improvements to Listed Buildings and Conservation Areas	Deleted
TC5 - Archaeological Sites	Replaced by: CS09 - Culture and Tourism CS20 - Heritage and the Historic Environment
TC6 - Scheduled Ancient Monuments	Replaced by: CS20 - Heritage and the Historic Environment
TC7 - Other Archaeological Sites	Continue to save. Review as part of the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD
TC8 - Advertisement Control	Continue to save. Review as part of the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD

TC9 - Shopfronts	Continue to save. Review as part of the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD
TC10 - Landscaping	Replaced by: CS12 - Green Infrastructure CS19 - Development and Design Principles
TC11 - Forecourt Parking	Deleted
The Green Belt	
GB1 - Green Belt Definition	Replaced by: CS02 - Scale and Distribution of Development
GB2 - Development in the Green Belt	Replaced by: CS02 - Scale and Distribution of Development
Villages	
V1 - Definition of Villages	Replaced by: CS02 - Scale and Distribution of Development
V2 - Development in Villages	Replaced by: CS02 - Scale and Distribution of Development CS13 - Green Spaces, Sport and Recreation CS15 - Housing Density CS19 - Development and Design Principles
V3 - Villages of Exceptional Conservation Importance	Replaced by: CS20 - Heritage and the Historic Environment
The Countryside	
C1 - Areas of Special Significance for Agriculture	Deleted
C2 - Other Agricultural Land	Deleted
C3 - Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty	Replaced by: CS12 - Green Infrastructure
C4 - Special Landscape Areas	Deleted
C6 - Areas of High Nature Conservation Value	Deleted

C7 - Sites of Special Scientific Interest and Nature Reserves	Replaced by: CS12 - Green Infrastructure
C8 - Sites of Nature Conservation Interest	Replaced by: CS12 - Green Infrastructure
C10 - Agricultural Dwellings	Continue to save. Review as part of the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD
C11 - Change of Use of Redundant Buildings in the Countryside	Continue to save. Review as part of the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD
C12 - Replacement Dwellings	Continue to save. Review as part of the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD
C13 - Extensions to Dwellings	Continue to save. Review as part of the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD
C14 - Culverstone Valley Area	Deleted
C16 - Leisure Plots	Replaced by: CS02 - Scale and Distribution of Development CS12 - Green Infrastructure
C17 - Horse-riding and Stables	Continue to save. Review as part of the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD
C18 - Incorporation of Additional Land into Residential Gardens	Continue to save. Review as part of the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD
C19 - Non-agricultural Open Uses in the Countryside	Replaced by: CS02 - Scale and Distribution of Development CS12 - Green Infrastructure
Leisure and Tourism	
LT1 - General Leisure Provision	Replaced by: CS02 - Scale and Distribution of development CS10 - Physical and Social Infrastructure CS12 - Green Infrastructure CS13 - Green Space, Sport and Recreation

LT2 - Existing Open Space	Replaced by: CS13 - Green Space, Sport and Recreation
LT3 - Existing Playing Fields	Replaced by: CS13 - Green Space, Sport and Recreation
LT4 - Dual Use of Existing Playing Fields and Sports Facilities	Deleted
LT5 - Additional Open Space and Playing Fields	Replaced by: CS13 - Green Space, Sport and Recreation
LT6 - Additional Open Space in New Housing Development	Continue to save. Review as part of the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD
LT7 - Golf Courses	Replaced by: CS02 - Scale and Distribution of Development CS12 - Green Infrastructure
LT8 - Recreational Use of Public Rights of Way	Replaced by: CS11 - Transport CS12 - Green Infrastructure
PLT1 - Additional Open Space including Public Open Space and/or Playing Fields	Deleted
PLT2 - Recreational Use of Part of Former Gravesend West Railway Line	Deleted
PLT3 - Thames and Medway Canal	Deleted
Minerals, Waste Disposal and Derelict Land	
M1 - Restoration of Derelict land	Deleted
Transport	
T0 - General Transport	Replaced by: CS11 - Transport
T1 - Impact of Development on the Highway Network	Continue to save. Review as part of the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD

T2 - Channelling of Traffic onto the Primary and District Distributor Network	Continue to save. Review as part of the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD
T3 - Development not well related to the Primary and District Distributor Network	Continue to save. Review as part of the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD
T4 - Development outside the Built-Up Area	Continue to save. Review as part of the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD
T5 - New Accesses onto Highway Network	Continue to save. Review as part of the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD
T6 - Safeguarding of Thameside Development Route	Continue to save. Review as part of the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD
T7 - Access to Eastern Industrial Areas of Gravesend	Replaced by: CSO4 - Gravesend Riverside East and North East Gravesend Opportunity Area
T8 - Traffic Management	Replaced by: CS11 - Transport
T9 - Housing Estate Layout	Continue to save. Review as part of the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD
T10 - Public Transport	Replaced by: CS11 - Transport
T11 - Cycling	Replaced by: CS11 - Transport
T12 - Facilities Relating to the A2 Trunk Road	Deleted
T13 - M2 Widening and A2 Improvements	Deleted

T14 - Channel Tunnel Rail Link	Deleted
PT2 - Gravesend Town Centre Road Network	Deleted
Parking	
P1 - Public Car Parking in Central Gravesend	Replaced by: CS11 - Transport
P2 - Car Parking Pricing Policy	Deleted
P3 - Vehicle Parking Standards	Continue to save. Review as part of the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD
P5 - Change of Use of Buildings and Vehicle Parking Standards	Continue to save. Review as part of the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD
PP1 - Public Car Parking in Central Gravesend	Replaced by: CS11 - Transport
The Riverside	
R1 - Commercial Riverside - Use of the River for Transport	Replaced by: CS03 - Northfleet Embankment and Swanscombe Peninsula East opportunity Area CS04 - Gravesend Riverside East and North East Gravesend Opportunity Area CS07 - Economy, Employment and Skills CS11 - Transport
R2 - Commercial Riverside – Wharves	Replaced by: CS04 - Gravesend Riverside East and North East Gravesend Opportunity Area CS07 - Economy, Employment and Skills CS11 - Transport
R3 - Town Centre Riverside	Replaced by: CS05 - Gravesend Town Centre Opportunity Area CS12 - Green Infrastructure CS19 - Development and Design Principles

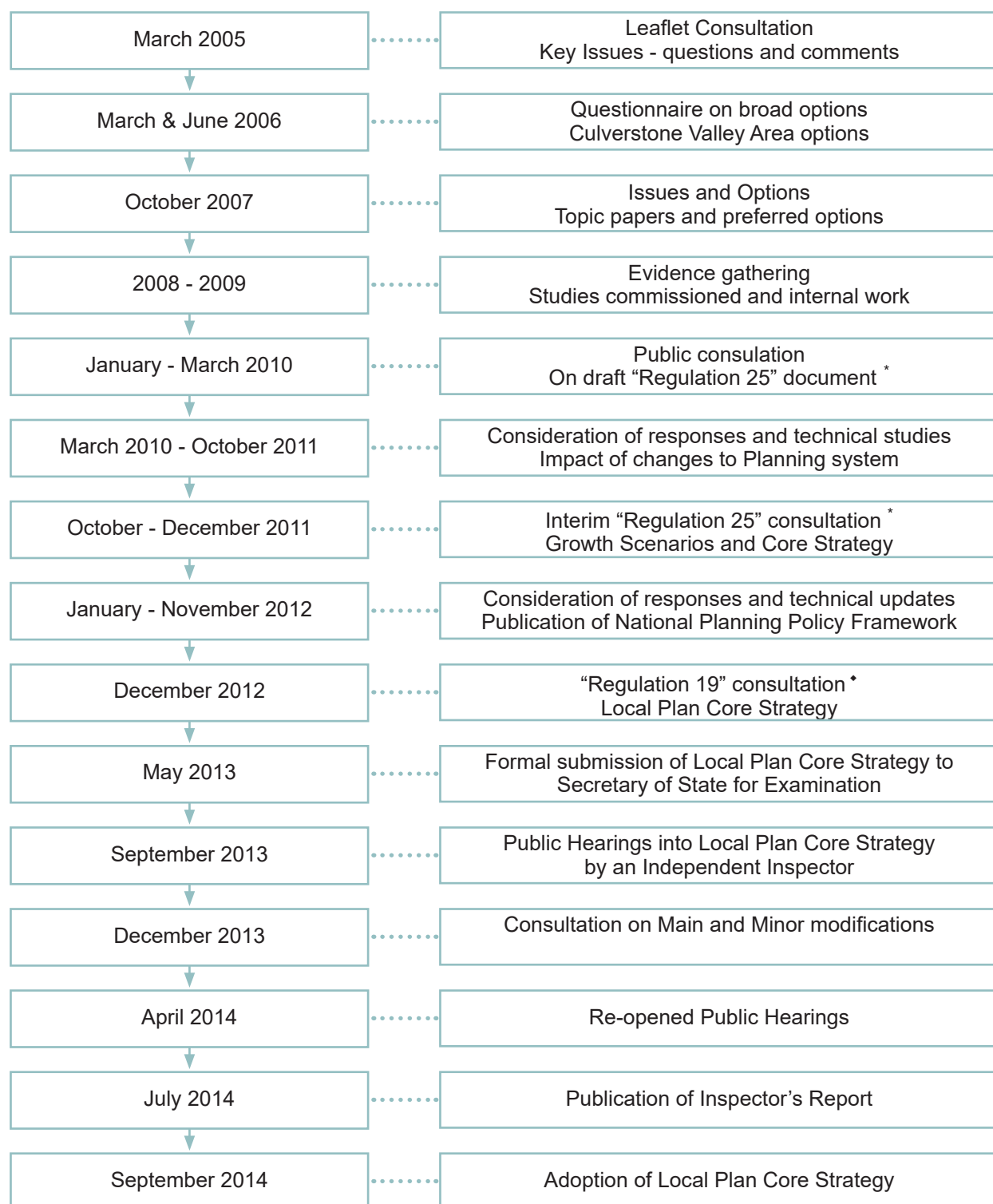
R4 - Rural Riverside	Replaced by: CS02 - Scale and Distribution of Development CS04 - Gravesend Riverside East and North East Gravesend Opportunity Area CS12 - Green Infrastructure
Major Sites	
PM1 - Horn Yard, Bull Yard and the Open Market, Gravesend	Replaced by: CS05 - Gravesend Town Centre Opportunity Area CS08 - Retail, Leisure and the Hierarchy of Centres CS19 - Development and Design Principles CS20 - Heritage and the Historic Environment
PM2 - Land between Church Street and West Street, Gravesend	Replaced by: CS05 - Gravesend Town Centre Opportunity Area CS08 - Retail, Leisure and the Hierarchy of Centres CS19 - Development and Design Principles CS20 - Heritage and the Historic Environment
PM3 - Barrack Row, Gravesend	Replaced by: CS05 - Gravesend Town Centre Opportunity Area CS11 - Transport
PM5 - The Canal Basin, Gordon Promenade and Gardens, Gravesend	Replaced by: CS04 - Gravesend Riverside East and North East Gravesend Opportunity Area CS05 - Gravesend Town Centre Opportunity Area CS12 - Green Infrastructure CS13 - Green Space, Sport and Recreation
PM6 - Imperial Business Estate, Gravesend	Replaced by: CS03 - Northfleet Embankment and Swanscombe Peninsula East Opportunity Area CS05 - Gravesend Town Centre Opportunity Area CS07 - Economy , Employment and Skills CS08 - Retail, Leisure and the Hierarchy of Centres
PM7 - Springhead Enterprise Park, Northfleet	Replaced by: CS06 - Ebbsfleet (Gravesham) Opportunity Area CS07 - Economy , Employment and Skills

PM9 - North East Gravesend	Replaced by: CS04 - Gravesend Riverside East and North East Gravesend Opportunity Area
PM10 - Vale Road and Springhead Road, Northfleet	Deleted
PM11 - East of the Canal Basin, Gravesend	Replaced by: CS04 - Gravesend Riverside East and North East Gravesend Opportunity Area CS07 - Economy Employment and Skills CS12 - Green Infrastructure
PM13 - Ferry Motors, Gravesend	Replaced by: CS05 - Gravesend Town Centre Opportunity Area CS08 - Retail, Leisure and the Hierarchy of Centres CS19 - Development and Design Principles CS20 - Heritage and the Historic Environment
PM14 - Wingfield Bank, Northfleet	Deleted
Area Policies	
AP1 - Wrotham Road, Gravesend	Continue to save. Review as part of the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD
AP2 - Parrock Street, Gravesend	Continue to save. Review as part of the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD
AP3 - Northern end of High Street, Gravesend	Replaced by: CS05 - Gravesend Town Centre Opportunity Area CS08 - Retail, Leisure and the Hierarchy of Centres CS20 - Heritage and the Historic Environment
AP4 - Queen Street, Gravesend	Replaced by: CS05 - Gravesend Town Centre Opportunity Area CS08 - Retail, Leisure and the Hierarchy of Centres CS20 - Heritage and the Historic Environment
AP5 - Overcliffe, Gravesend	Deleted

AP6 - Windmill Street, Gravesend	Replaced by: CS05 - Gravesend Town Centre Opportunity Area CS08 - Retail, Leisure and the Hierarchy of Centres CS20 - Heritage and the Historic Environment
AP7 - Milton Road, Gravesend	Continue to save. Review as part of the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD
AP8 - Western end of New Road, Gravesend	Replaced by: CS05 - Gravesend Town Centre Opportunity Area CS08 - Retail, Leisure and the Hierarchy of Centres
AP9 - Manor Road, Gravesend	Replaced by: CS05 - Gravesend Town Centre Opportunity Area CS08 - Retail, Leisure and the Hierarchy of Centres
AP10 - Harmer Street, Gravesend	Continue to save. Review as part of the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD
AP11 - Pelham Road, Gravesend	Deleted
AP12 - West of Stuart Road (northern end), Gravesend	Replaced by: CS05 - Gravesend Town Centre Opportunity Area
AP13 - Grove Road and College Road, Northfleet	Replaced by: CS03 - Northfleet Embankment and Swanscombe Peninsula East Opportunity Area
AP14(a) - Land West of Springhead Road – Ebbsfleet	Replaced by: CS06 - Ebbsfleet (Gravesham) Opportunity Area
AP14(b) - Land West of Springhead Road – Springhead	Replaced by: CS06 - Ebbsfleet (Gravesham) Opportunity Area
AP15 - Botany and Broadness Marshes, Northfleet	Replaced by: CS03 - Northfleet Embankment and Swanscombe Peninsula East Opportunity Area
AP17 - South of Hever Court Road, Gravesend	Deleted

AP18 - Land adjoining Medway Towns Northern Relief Road, Higham	Deleted
AP19 - Great Clane Lane Marshes, Gravesend	Replaced by: CS04 - Gravesend Riverside East and North East Gravesend Opportunity Area CS12 - Green Infrastructure
Utilities	
U1 - Southern Water Services	Replaced by: CS10 - Physical and Social Infrastructure
U2 - New Telecommunications Development	Deleted

Appendix 2 - Key Milestones



* Under old Local Plan regulations

♦ Under new Local Plan Regulations

Appendix 3 - Policy Delivery and Monitoring

1.1 This appendix contains the detail of how the Core Strategy will be measured and implemented. It also sets out how the policies provide flexibility, and what remedial action may be appropriate if targets are not met.

Policy Implementation

1.2 Core Strategy policies will be implemented primarily through the determination of planning applications, based on the Local Plan Core Strategy and other documents (including the Policies Map) whilst having regard to other Council and partner plans and strategies. However, the Core Strategy also provides a framework for making wider decisions, such as where to target investment in new infrastructure and to inform the development of softer measures, such as promoting skills, which will be key to improving the borough's economy.

1.3 The new planning system places particular importance on the need to monitor and review Local Plans to ensure that Local Planning Authorities and other interested parties are able to see what has happened in the past, at present and what may happen in the future. Such evidence can be used for developing future planning documents and is also vital to continually assess and, if necessary, revise the plan in part or in whole.

1.4 The principal mechanism for monitoring the Core Strategy will be the Authority Monitoring Report which is published each year in December and needs to cover the following:

- The implementation of the Local Development Scheme
- The extent to which policies set out in the local development documents are being implemented
- Other relevant required information²⁶

1.5 This framework sets out how policies in this Local Plan Core Strategy will be delivered and monitored during the plan period in order to measure their success. This framework sets out SMART (smart, measurable, attainable, realistic, time-bound) targets where appropriate. Progress towards meeting the targets will generally be monitored for the Borough as a whole but this may include consideration of sub-areas in line with the spatial policies in section 4 of this Core Strategy.

1.6 As well as targets for 2028, interim targets will also be identified for shorter periods, wherever possible, so that progress towards meeting the overall target can be more easily monitored. Where monitoring shows that progress towards targets is unsatisfactory the Council will review the situation and, where necessary, take remedial action. This may include actions for the forthcoming Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD; new or revised technical work; pro-active measures to bring forward sites for development; action to secure the timely provision of infrastructure; and a review of relevant parts of the Local Plan. A review is likely to be triggered when there is a consistent pattern of failure to uphold one or more policies, a major external event or change in national policy.

²⁶ Section 35 of the Planning and Compulsory Purchase Act 2004 (as amended by the Localism Act 2011)

1.7 The rationale for this is:

- It would be impractical to formally review individual policies
- The policies will be reviewed as part of a comprehensive review of the whole of the Core Strategy.
- Such a review would encompass a review of the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies document thus forming a comprehensive Local Plan.
- A review would not simply be triggered by a threshold in a policy but by a combination of 3 elements.
 - A failure of a policy or policies to achieve the aims and objectives of the core strategy;
 - A persistent failure of a policy or policies on appeal, such as to render them unviable; and
 - An accumulation of external factors which render a policy or policies out of date. These could include an updated Strategic Land Availability Assessment (SLAA), a revised Strategic Housing Market Assessment (SHMA), new household and population projections leading to new housing and employment requirements, a review of the NPPF or other Government policy initiatives, any strategic outcomes from the duty to cooperate, a review of the community strategy or its equivalent, and a review of other Council strategies.
- Where the monitoring of individual policies leads to a need for action, there are two approaches which can be taken to bring the core strategy back onto course in advance of a comprehensive review:
 - The first is a change in the application of Development Management decisions, informed by new or revised studies, as justified by the application of material considerations.
 - The second is direct action by the Council in conjunction with its partners to implement its policies.

Review of this Framework

1.8 The starting point for consideration of the delivery and monitoring framework for the Core Strategy has been the desire to align it with the monitoring and performance frameworks already in place for the Corporate Business Plan and other corporate documents.

1.9 Regard will also be had to the statutory monitoring undertaken by other organisations, for example by Kent County Council for its Local Transport Plan and the Kent Environment Strategy.

1.10 The single data list sets out the current information requirements that national government has for local government. The national need for data varies and this is one of the reasons that this framework will be subject to periodic review.

Policy CS01: Sustainable Development

Policy Delivery

This policy will be delivered through development management decisions.

Performance Monitoring and Remedial Actions

Policy CS01 will be monitored using the whole suite of indicators presented for this Plan.

As this “presumption in favour of sustainable development” repeats national policy with a local aspect, this policy will only need to be reviewed should national policy on the presumption in favour of sustainable development materially change.

Policy CS01 allows for material considerations which could lead to a refusal of planning permission for a proposal even if it accords with policies in the Core Strategy.

Indicator	Target
Percentage of planning application appeals that were dismissed	100% (if below 80% over a two year period, the Council would be put into special measures)

Appeal decisions will need to be analysed where appeals are allowed by the Planning Inspectorate to determine if there are any patterns which suggest that remedial action is required.

Policy CS02:	Scale and Distribution of Development
Policy CS03:	Northfleet Embankment and Swanscombe Peninsula East Opportunity Area
Policy CS04:	Gravesend Riverside East and North East Gravesend Opportunity Area
Policy CS05:	Gravesend Town Centre Opportunity Area
Policy CS06:	Ebbfleet (Gravesham) Opportunity Area
Policy CS21:	Land at Coldharbour Road Key Site

Policy Delivery

These policies will be delivered through development management decisions and the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies Development Plan Document, which may include a review of Policy CS02.

Additional detail (where applicable)

- The delivery of homes and jobs will primarily be by the private sector. For homes, a proportion will be developed by Registered Providers and potentially the Council itself. The council will also facilitate delivery of homes working with its partner organisations and where appropriate will support other mechanisms, such as custom-built homes.
- Additional developable sites for housing and employment (including mixed use developments) will be allocated in the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD. This DPD will be informed by a revised SLAA, a new SHMA, a review of development opportunities in the existing urban area and the rural settlements inset from the Green Belt and a strategic Green Belt boundary review.
- The extent of the Green Belt as shown on the Policies Map is the same as that previously shown on the Gravesham Local Plan First Review proposals map for Policy GB1 (Policy GB1 is not being saved). The Council will undertake a strategic Green Belt boundary review to identify additional land to meet the housing requirements of the Core Strategy up to 2028 and to safeguard areas of land to meet development needs beyond the plan period. Any boundary changes will be included in the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD and shown on the Policies Map. The Green Belt Boundary Review Technical Paper 2009 highlighted some minor boundary changes worthy of consideration. This work will be taken into consideration in the strategic Green Belt boundary review.
- If the evidence from the new SHMA results in a higher objectively assessed housing requirement and/or should a revised SLAA show that the Borough's housing needs cannot be met in the existing urban area and rural settlements inset from the Green Belt, a review of policy CS02 (Scale and Distribution of Development) will be undertaken.

Performance Monitoring and Remedial Actions

Indicator	Target
Number of new dwellings given planning permission	Maintain a 5 year supply of developable housing sites throughout the plan period against the development plan requirement Post adoption, at least 325 dwellings per annum for years 2014/2015 – 2018/2019 / 5yr supply post adoption (2014/15 – 2018/19) = 1,625 dwellings At least 363 dwellings per annum for years 2019/2020 – 2023/2024 = 1,815 dwellings At least 438 dwellings per annum for years 2024/2025 – 2027/2028 = 1,752 dwellings
Net housing completions and projected net additional dwellings (housing trajectory)	Maintain the delivery of new housing against the development plan requirement Post adoption, at least 325 dwellings per annum for years 2014/2015 – 2018/2019 / 5yr supply (2014/15 – 2018/19) = 1,625 dwellings
Net housing completions by Opportunity Area	The target for each Opportunity Area is set out in table 5
The percentage of new residential development completed on previously developed land	60%
Amount of B class floorspace completed (gross)	The overall target is set out in Table 6
Amount of B class floorspace completed (gross) by Opportunity Area	The target for each Opportunity Area is set out in table 6
Periodic Gravesend Town Centre health checks to be carried out	Details shown under Policy CS08
Number of applications in the Green Belt refused planning permission and subsequently granted on appeal	0
Floorspace and Percentage of completed retail and leisure development by Opportunity Area	The guideline distribution of retail development is set out in Table 8
Changes in the Indices of Deprivation	Improved ranking scores for Gravesham Super Output Areas

The policy will be monitored and reviewed through annual Housing Information Audits and Commercial Information Audits, Authority Monitoring Reports, regularly updated Strategic Land Availability Assessments and 5 year land supply statements.

If monitoring shows that planned provision of employment floorspace and homes will not be delivered at the levels expected, whilst allowing a degree of variation around the predicted level because of the way developments deliver and normal market fluctuations, the Strategic Land Availability Assessment will be comprehensively reviewed rather than just annually refreshed and the underpinning assumptions reconsidered.

Policy CS07: Economy, Employment and Skills

Policy Delivery

This policy will be delivered through development management decisions, supported by the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies Development Plan Document.

The policy is supported by the inclusion of marketing guidance as set out in Appendix 5 of this Core Strategy

The Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD will:

- Contain criteria-based policies which will be used to judge individual planning applications affecting employment land.
- Identify and allocate sites for employment (including mixed use developments) as informed by the Strategic Land Availability Assessment and latest Employment Land Review. This will include sites within the opportunity areas in addition to the key sites allocated within this Core Strategy.

Performance Monitoring and Remedial Actions

Indicator	Target
Amount of completed office development (use class B1a)	B1a targets for Ebbsfleet and Gravesend Town Centre are set out in Table 6
Amount of B class employment floorspace lost to non-employment development (excluding that identified in Policies CS03-CS06 or lost due to prior notifications) or lost on appeal	0
Amount of B class floorspace completed (gross)	See policies CS02 to CS06 and CS21
Amount of B class floorspace completed (gross) by Opportunity Area	See policies CS02 to CS06 and CS21
Age of Employment Land Review	Less than 7 years old
Number of people economically active and in employment as a proportion of the Borough's working age population	Increase (Directional target)
Gravesham Job Density	Increase (Directional target)
Qualification (NVQ4 and above)	Increase (Directional target)

Policy CS08: Retail, Leisure and the Hierarchy of Centres

Policy Delivery

This policy will be delivered through development management decisions, supported by the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies Development Plan Document.

Additional detail (where applicable)

- The local centres as shown on the Policies Map are the same as that previously shown on the Gravesham Local Plan First Review proposals map for Policies S2 and S6 (which are not being saved)
- In the Local, Neighbourhood and Village Centre Hierarchy Technical Paper 2009, the Council highlighted that each centre has its own characteristics and it is not possible to be prescriptive. Therefore it is intended that additional work on the identification of local centres and their boundaries will be undertaken to inform the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD. This will include:
 - the new local centres in policy CS08 which have been identified on key sites
 - Milton Road local centre (which is located in the Town Centre Opportunity Area but is not key site)
- In addition, the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD will include criteria-based policies to guide decisions regarding the appropriate balance of uses within primary and secondary frontages in the Primary Shopping Area and the other centres in the hierarchy

Performance Monitoring and Remedial Actions

Indicator	Target
Age of Retail and Commercial Study	Less than 7 years old
Total amount of additional space for A1 convenience and A1 comparison - permitted	The overall target is set out in Table 8
Total amount of additional space for A1 convenience and A1 comparison - completed	The overall target is set out in Table 8
Unit Vacancy Rates by use class within the Primary Shopping Area	Remain the same or reduce (Directional target)
Gravesend Town Centre Quarterly Footfall surveys	Footfall to remain the same or increase (Directional target)

Policy CS09: Culture and Tourism

Policy Delivery

This policy will be delivered through development management decisions, supported by the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies Development Plan Document.

Performance Monitoring and Review

Indicator	Target
Volume and value of tourist activity for Gravesham (through participation in the next Kent-wide Cambridge Model, or its equivalent)	As set out in the Gravesham Tourism Strategy
Accommodation occupancy rates	Increase (Directional target)

Policy CS10: Physical and Social Infrastructure

Policy CS11: Transport

Policy Delivery

- To facilitate delivery of these policies, the Council will work with infrastructure and transport providers, the Highways Agency, Kent Highways Service, the Gravesham Locality Board and developers to ensure the delivery of infrastructure improvements required to support the delivery of the Core Strategy or resolve existing deficiencies.
- The Council will collect and use contributions from developers to support improvements in services and infrastructure that are required as a result of development. This will be via planning obligations and the planned introduction of a Community Infrastructure Levy.
- Current Planning Guidance on Vehicle Parking Standards is likely to be reviewed

Performance Monitoring and Review

- The Council will maintain the Infrastructure Delivery Schedule (Appendix 6) as a “live” document to be updated as required.
- Progress in implementing infrastructure projects identified in the most up-to-date Infrastructure Delivery Plan Schedule.
- Where schemes are not delivered within the timescales set out, the Council will consult with the relevant lead bodies to identify new arrangements or alternative schemes.
- The Council's Air Quality Progress Report 2012 highlights that reducing emissions from HGV and car traffic remains the key challenge to improve air quality for the Borough. The Council will consider the expansion air quality monitoring in the Borough to facilitate the assessment of baseline conditions, in particular the monitoring of nitrogen dioxide as well as for implementing measures to improve air quality.
- Seek with our Kent Thameside partners a revalidation of, or replacement for, the Kent Thameside Transport Model to provide a basis for future scheme evaluation and policy development.

Indicator	Target
Pollutant concentrations at monitoring sites within the borough	Reduction in levels of relevant pollutants from transport sources
Progress on scheme delivery	As set out in Infrastructure Delivery Schedule

Policy CS12: Green Infrastructure

Policy CS13: Green Space, Sport and Recreation

Policy Delivery

These policies will be delivered through development management decisions and the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies Development Plan Document. The Council will work with the Thames Gateway and Kent Local Nature Partnerships (which include neighbouring authorities), AONB Management Unit, Natural England, Environment Agency, RSPB and Kent Wildlife Trust to ensure that the value of the natural environment is embedded in decision making.

Additional detail (where applicable)

- National and local wildlife sites will be managed through agreements between Natural England, Kent Wildlife Trust and landowners to maintain and improve their biodiversity.
- The Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD will set out the detailed Green Infrastructure Network for the Borough which will include:
 - existing and proposed areas of green space, playing pitches and other sports facilities
 - Green space, playing pitch and sports provision standards
 - detailed boundaries of the Biodiversity Opportunity Areas where there are opportunities for enhancement
 - opportunities for enhancing the Green Grid network
- Natural England is working to create the England Coast Path, the Gravesham part of which is expected to be considered in 2016 – 2017.
- Working with partners, the Management Plan and subsequent Action Plan proposals for the Kent Downs AONB will be implemented.

Performance Monitoring and Review

Indicator	Target
Proportion of the Borough's Local Wildlife Sites where positive conservation management has been or is being implemented.	Remain the same or increase (Directional target)
Percentage of the Borough's Sites of Special Scientific Interest which are in a "favourable" or "recovering" condition.	100%
Additions and losses to the Green Infrastructure Network, measured by area (N.B. Baseline to be established through the definition of the Green Infrastructure Network in the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD)	No net loss in area
Participation rates in sports	Remain the same or increase

Policy CS14: Housing Type and Size

Policy Delivery

This policy will be delivered through development management decisions.

Performance Monitoring and Review

Indicator	Target
Number of market and affordable dwellings completed by: • Dwelling type • Dwelling size (number of bedrooms)	To be measured against needs set out in the Development Plan

This Core Strategy has been informed by a borough specific update of the North Kent Strategic Housing Market Assessment

Periodic updating of the North Kent Strategic Housing Market Assessments will be undertaken in partnership with other Local Authorities in the sub-region to an agreed methodology. A comprehensive update is not expected until all the 2011 Census data has been released to ensure that the relevant forecasting model uses the most up-to-date data available.

Policy CS15: Housing Density

Policy Delivery

This policy will be delivered through development management decisions.

- The delivery of homes and jobs will be by the private sector, Registered Providers and potentially the Council itself.
- As the form and density of housing will vary in response to accessibility and the character of the site within its context, this links to the production of landscape and townscape character studies and Conservation Area Appraisals.

Performance Monitoring and Review

Indicator	Target
Density of new housing development on sites providing 5 or more dwellings in the urban / rural areas	Urban area – 40 dwellings per hectare or more Rural area – 30 dwellings per hectare or more

The policy will be monitored and reviewed through annual Housing Information Audits, Authority Monitoring Reports, and regularly updated Strategic Land Availability Assessments.

Policy CS16: Affordable Housing

Policy Delivery

This policy will be delivered through development management decisions and the Council's Housing Strategy.

The delivery of new affordable homes will primarily be via Registered Providers, either on their own sites or on mixed-tenure with the private sector, and potentially the Council. The council will also facilitate the delivery of homes by working with its partner organisations and other agencies to identify new means of funding the provision of affordable housing.

The quantity, tenure balance and type/size mix of the affordable housing will be agreed with the Council's Housing Strategy and Development Manager through the development management process. Where the developer has demonstrated the scheme to be unviable and this has been independently validated, the council may consider the use of alternative mechanisms to achieve the full affordable housing requirement.

Performance Monitoring and Review

Indicator	Target
Affordable housing completions as a percentage of total new units	30% of dwellings in the urban area and 35% in the rural area for sites which meet or exceed the size threshold

Policy CS17: Provision of Traveller Sites

Policy Delivery

This policy will be delivered through development management decisions, supported by the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies Development Plan Document.

The Council proposes to meet the identified local need as set out in the Gravesham Traveller Accommodation Assessment 2013 by allocating sites and setting out a criteria based policy within the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies DPD.

The accommodation needs of Travellers will be reviewed on a regular basis to inform the five year supply of deliverable sites over the plan period.

Performance Monitoring and Review

Indicator	Target								
Number of additional Traveller pitches delivered against the need set out in the most up to date accommodation assessment	The Gravesham Traveller Accommodation Assessment 2013 breaks down the need for new pitches over the plan period as follows, using January 2013 as the start date for monitoring: <table> <tr> <td>2013 – 2017</td><td>8 pitches</td></tr> <tr> <td>2018 – 2022</td><td>3 pitches</td></tr> <tr> <td>2023 – 2027</td><td>4 pitches</td></tr> <tr> <td>2028</td><td>1 pitch</td></tr> </table> Maintain a five year supply of deliverable sites throughout the plan period.	2013 – 2017	8 pitches	2018 – 2022	3 pitches	2023 – 2027	4 pitches	2028	1 pitch
2013 – 2017	8 pitches								
2018 – 2022	3 pitches								
2023 – 2027	4 pitches								
2028	1 pitch								
Number of unauthorised encampments or unauthorised developments and enforcement action taken.	Decrease (Directional target)								
Age of Traveller Accommodation Assessment	Less than 7 years old								

Policy CS18: Climate Change

Policy Delivery

This policy will be delivered through development management decisions and the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies Development Plan Document.

The role of national government in revising building regulations to raise the quality of new homes, reduce their environmental impact and facilitate future adaptation is also key to the delivery of this policy.

The production of a Supplementary Planning Document on sustainable design and construction will be considered.

The Council will work with the Environment Agency and Developers to implement this policy. It is also worth noting that the Flood and Water Management Act 2010 gives Kent County Council new responsibilities in this area.

Performance Monitoring and Review

Indicator	Target
Number of planning permissions granted contrary to the advice of the Environment Agency on flood defence grounds.	0
Number of new developments with Sustainable Drainage Systems installed, guidance being prepared by Kent County Council	Increase (Directional target)
Percentage of new homes to be built to at least level 3 / 4 of the Code for Sustainable Homes in terms of water use	100%
Percentage of new homes on key sites built to at least level 5 / 6 of the Code for Sustainable Homes in terms of water use	5%
Percentage of non-residential developments of 1,000 sq m and above meeting BREEAM 'excellent' standards of water efficiency	100%
Number of planning permissions granted contrary to Environment Agency objections on Water Framework Directive, including water quality, geomorphology and ecology grounds	0

To be reviewed once the regulations to support the Flood and Water Management Act 2010 are in place.

Policy CS19: Development and Design Principles

Policy Delivery

This policy will be delivered through development management decisions and the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies Development Plan Document.

There is an expectation that the Kent Design Guide will be reviewed and updated, to continue to promote excellence in design across Kent and Medway and raise the profile and encourage wider use of tools such as Building for Life.

The production of the following Supplementary Planning Documents will be considered:

- Sustainable design and construction
- A revision of the minimum space standards as currently set out in the Council's Residential Layout Guidelines Supplementary Planning Guidance
- Design principles including information needed to fill the gap left by the deletion of Planning Policy Statement 23: Planning and Pollution Control

Performance Monitoring and Review

Indicator	Target
Percentage of applications which require Design and Access statements that conform to CABE guidance	100%
Number of planning applications refused on design grounds and granted on appeal	0

Policy CS20: Heritage and the Historic Environment

Policy Delivery

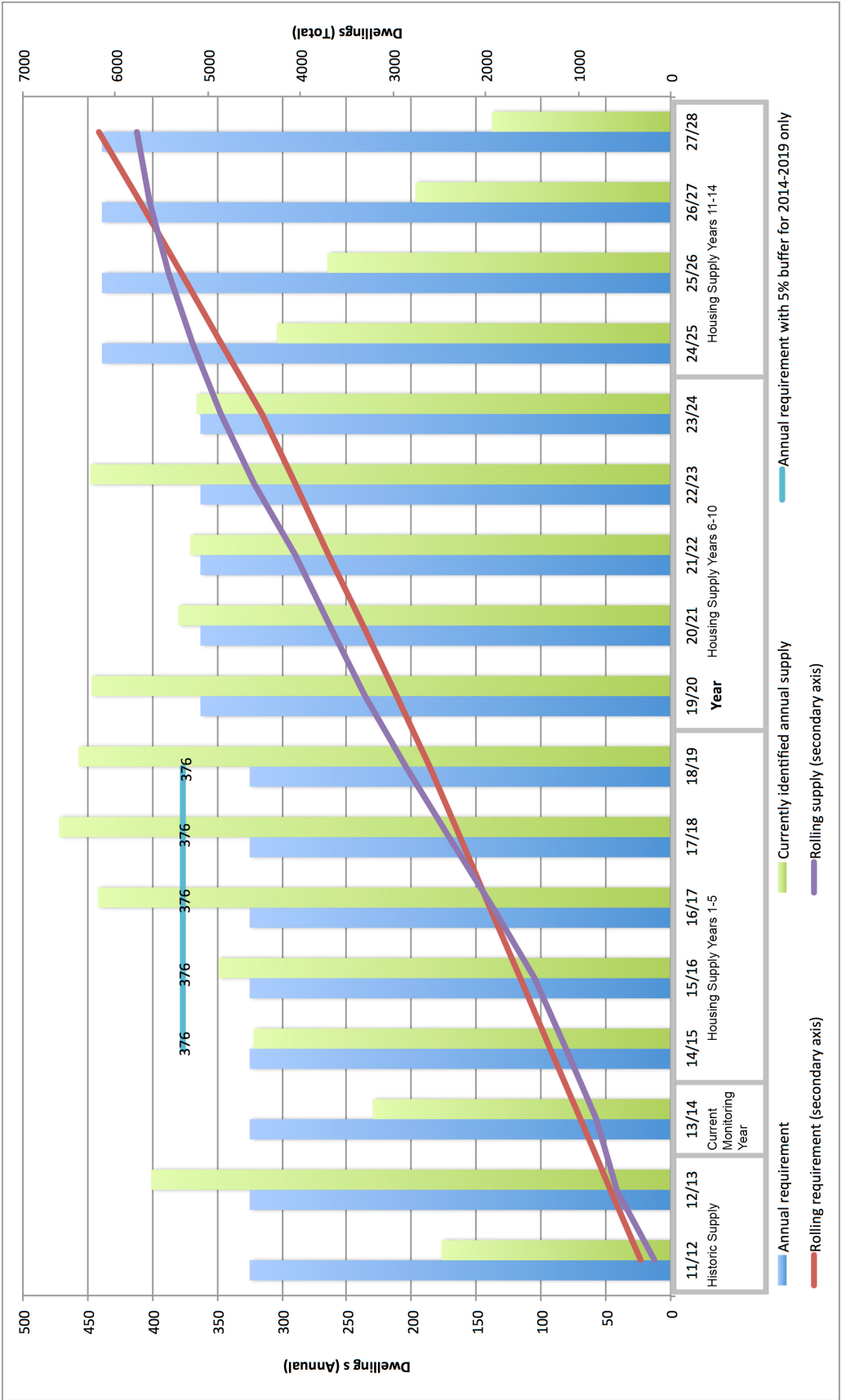
This policy will be delivered through development management decisions and the Site Allocations and Development Management Policies Development Plan Document.

Whilst the Council has maintained a list of locally important buildings for some years, it is intended that this will be updated and included in a Supplementary Planning Document on heritage and the historic environment.

Performance Monitoring and Review

Indicator	Target
Number of Buildings and other heritage assets “at Risk” on English Heritage Register	Remain the same or decrease
Number of Conservation Area Appraisals which were last reviewed more than 10 years ago	0
The number of statutorily listed buildings in the Borough.	Remain the same or increase
Loss of statutorily listed buildings	0

Appendix 4 - Housing Trajectory



Appendix 5 - Guidance Note: Marketing Requirements in relation to loss of existing B Class employment premises, sites or commercial wharves

Introduction

1.1 This Guidance Note provides guidance to applicants seeking to address the requirements of Core Strategy Policy CS07: Economy, Employment and Skills in relation to the marketing evidence that will be needed to demonstrate that there is no reasonable prospect of an existing premises or site being used for its permitted or lawful B Use Class purpose or as a commercial wharf.

1.2 This requirement will only be waived where the applicant can demonstrate to the satisfaction of the Council that exceptional circumstances apply and that there is no reasonable prospect of the site, premises or wharf being successfully marketed irrespective of this process being followed.

1.3 This guidance does not form part of the Local Plan or the policy itself. However, any marketing report undertaken in compliance with it will be treated as a material consideration in the determination of an application.

1.4 It is important to note that whilst any marketing campaign undertaken in accordance with this guidance will assist in demonstrating that there is no reasonable prospect of a premises, site or wharf being used for its permitted or lawful purpose, the Council will still need to take into account all relevant material planning considerations in determining individual applications.

1.5 These material considerations will vary over time (for example, in relation to the prevailing economic climate) and by geographic area or case (for example, in relation to the particular characteristics of a premises or wharf).

Marketing Requirements

1.6 Where possible, the particulars to be used to market a site or property should be approved by the Council, through pre-applications discussions and, in the case of commercial wharves, following consultations with the Port of London Authority.

1.7 A marketing report should be submitted with any planning application involving the re-use or redevelopment of a B Use Class premises, site or wharf for an alternative use. This should set out the details of the marketing campaign, and take account of the following:

- Applicants and the Council will need to take into account the impact of the then current economic climate on the general marketability of the B Class Use premises, site or wharf. Advice should therefore be sought from the Council at an early stage as to the duration of marketing to be used in each case. As a general guide, the Council will expect any vacant premises, site or wharf to be continuously marketed as follows:
 - In the case of a premises with a floor area of less than 1,000 sq m or a site less than 1 hectare in extent – a minimum of 6 months
 - In the case of a premises with a floor area greater than 1,000 sq m or a site larger

than 1 hectare in extent or any commercial wharf – a minimum of 12 months.

- Whilst the Council will not normally accept marketing evidence obtained whilst premises, sites or wharves are occupied, it may accept such evidence, where for example it can be clearly demonstrated (through the marketing report) that the property was being occupied at a substantial loss to avoid payment of empty rates.
- Any marketing exercise should be proportional to the size and characteristics of the premises, site or wharf and the scale of the proposed alternative use.
- The marketing campaign should target potential occupiers through a variety of means. As a minimum, the following measures should be used:
 - Property details should be made available and actively provided to a wide range of potential clients through a local commercial or estate letting agent. A copy of the dated letter of instruction to the agent and dated copies of the agent's property details should be included in the marketing report, together with information as to whom (and when) the property details have been provided.
 - On-site/premises marketing boards should be displayed throughout the period in which the property is being marketed. Dated photographs of marketing boards should be included in the marketing report.
 - Web-based marketing through relevant search engines, including in the case of commercial wharves those likely to be accessed by companies trading in the marine environment. The property should also be posted on both the Locate in Kent and Council's free on-line commercial property registers. Dated evidence should be included in the marketing report.
 - Advertising within target publications, the local press and any publications produced by local business networks and support agencies (as a minimum on a quarterly basis). Dated copies of these advertisements should be included in the marketing report.
- The premises, site or wharf should be marketed at a price and associated terms. Where a property, site or wharf has been on the market for some time and no offers have come forward, the vendor will need to demonstrate that they had reduced the price in an attempt to attract a tenant or purchaser.
- Where premises, sites or wharves are marketed for lease, the length of lease offered. The marketing agent should keep a log of enquiries throughout the period of the marketing campaign. This should record the date and nature of the enquiry (e.g. the type of business or individual enquiring), how the enquirer found out about the premises/site/wharf, whether the enquiry resulted in a site visit, and the reasons given for not pursuing the property. The log should also record any offers made for premises/site/wharf; the reason for the offer (or offers) being rejected; and any comments from any prospective tenants or purchasers as to why the property was not fit for current use. This log should be submitted as part of the marketing report.
- Where the flow of enquiries has been limited or is decreasing, the marketing report should explain any measures taken to refresh the marketing campaign.

1.8 The marketing report should detail why, in the opinion of the agent (or other specialist), the premises/site/wharf has not been taken up for the use for which it was marketed.

1.9 In circumstances where proposals do not fully meet the above guidance, it will be for applicants to demonstrate through their marketing report that their marketing/advertising campaign was sufficiently wide-ranging; of adequate length; that the asking price and terms were realistic; and that specialists appropriate to the type of use were engaged.

Appendix 6 - Infrastructure Delivery Schedule

1.1 The Infrastructure Delivery Schedule (IDS) below sets out all known infrastructure required to support development proposed in this Plan as well as other known infrastructure coming forward in the plan period to 2028. It is based on information available to the Council in November 2012, except the section on Land at Coldharbour Road Key Site which is based on information available to the Council in December 2013. Where schemes have since been completed, these have been deleted from the schedule. As infrastructure requirements are likely to change over time, the IDS is a living document which will be periodically reviewed and updated. The most up-to-date version will be available on the Planning Policy page on the website.

1.2 The IDS sets out the requirements for each opportunity area, Land at Coldharbour Road Key Site, the rest of Gravesend/Northfleet and Borough-wide. Where all sites (including key sites within the opportunity areas) are expected to make provision for certain types of infrastructure, this is included in the Borough-wide section rather than being repeated for each opportunity area. The projects are grouped by themes under each area section. Information shown in the table is based upon:

- the strategic plans produced by partners and service providers and/or information provided by them;
- current planning permissions (including legal agreements signed under section 106 of the Town and Country Planning Act 1990 and planning conditions);
- resolutions to grant planning permission, i.e. applications reported to and approved in principle by the Council's Regulatory Board but where negotiations on legal agreements are continuing; and
- live planning applications on the basis of currently available information.

1.3 The IDS refers to Kent County Council's Integrated Infrastructure Finance Model (IIFM) and the Kent Thameside Strategic Transport Investment Programme (STIP). Further details on these are given below.

1.4 The Integrated Infrastructure and Finance Model (IIFM) is a strategic modeling tool developed by Kent County Council. It enables early identification of the implications of district-specific population and housing growth over a 20-25 year time horizon. In summary, the IIFM provides a framework for service providers to assess for each district on a development site(s) basis:

- the demand for school places, social care and community facilities (community learning, libraries and archives and youth) that will be needed by the existing population living in current housing stock allocating any existing capacity to these people first;
- the additional need arising from the likely population make up of new housing incorporating any remaining surplus capacity in existing facilities for use by these people;
- an assessment of the existing capacity of those facilities; and
- if a new facility or service enhancement is needed, accountability for provision, an estimate of when this is required, its cost and available funding to meet costs.

1.5 It covers only the services provided by Kent County Council. Early in 2012, the County applied the model using Gravesham Borough's proposed scale and distribution of growth, i.e. 4,385 dwellings to 2026. Whilst it is now proposed to provide 6,170 dwellings to 2028, the results are still relevant and have been incorporated into the above table.

1.6 The Kent Thameside Strategic Transport Investment Programme (STIP) is a financial pooling and scheme management arrangement to deliver a range of major transport schemes across Dartford and Gravesham Boroughs north of the A2. The most up to date information can be found in a report to Kent County Council's Cabinet on 15 October 2012. The scheme includes input from the Highways Agency, Department for Transport, Homes and Communities Agency as well as the local authorities.

Abbreviations:

DBC	Dartford Borough Council
DCMS	Department for Culture, Media and Sport
DEFRA	Department for Food and Rural Affairs
DFT	Department for Transport
EU	European Union
GBC	Gravesham Borough Council
HCA	Homes and Communities Agency
IIFM	Integrated Investment and Finance Model
KCC	Kent County Council
LEP	Local Enterprise Partnership
STIP	Strategic Transport Investment Programme
TFL	Transport for London
UTMC	Urban Transport Management and Control

What	Specific Requirements	*Need for Scheme	When	Cost	Lead Body	Funding Sources	Source
Northfleet Embankment and Swanscombe Peninsula East							
Community	Community Centre at Old Northfleet Residential Extension	Required for forecast population subject to future review at reserved matters stage	Unknown	Unknown	Developer / Third Party Provider	Developer	Resolution to grant planning permission GR/2009/0238
Education	Additional primary school places to be provided through school extensions	Required for forecast population	2012 onwards	£1.9m (IIFM)	KCC	Developers	Kent Draft Commissioning Plan for Education Provision
Health	Primary care (GP) practice at Old Northfleet Residential Extension	Required for forecast population subject to future review at reserved matters stage	Depends on grant and implementation of planning permission	Unknown	NHS West Kent	Developer	Resolution to grant planning permission GR/2009/0238
Transport	Northfleet Riverside bus, walking and cycle route to link Grove Road to Lansdowne Square	Through routes to serve key sites and provide link in Thames Path	Depends on grant and implementation of planning permission	Unknown	Developers	Developers	Resolution to grant planning permission GR/2009/0238 and wider objectives
Waste Water	Sewerage capacity infrastructure improvements at Land East of Grove Road and Robins Creek, Old Northfleet Residential Extension and Northfleet Embankment East	Required for forecast population	Depends on implementation of developments	Unknown	Southern Water	Developers	Southern Water

*The references to "Required for forecast population" may not always solely relate to the population of the new development.

What	Specific Requirements	*Need for Scheme	When	Cost	Lead Body	Funding Sources	Source
Water	Water supply capacity improvements at Land East of Grove Road and Robins Creek and Old Northfleet Residential Extension ²⁷	Required for forecast population	Depends on implementation of developments	Unknown	Southern Water	Developers	Southern Water
Gravesend Riverside East and North East Gravesend							
Community	Community hub at Canal Basin	Required for forecast population. Part of negotiations on planning application	2012-2016	£218,615 (IIFM)	KCC	Developer	Resolution to grant planning permission GR/2011/0713, Kent Integrated Infrastructure and Finance Model
Education	Additional primary school places to be provided through school extensions	Required for forecast population	2012 onwards	£1.9m (IIFM)	KCC	Developers	Kent Draft Commissioning Plan for Education Provision
Health	Possible primary care (GP) practice as part of D1 (non-residential institutions) floorspace at Canal Basin	Required for forecast population. Part of negotiations on planning application	Depends on grant and implementation of planning permission	Unknown	NHS West Kent	Developer	Resolution to grant planning permission GR/2011/0713

²⁷ Assumed that this will not be an issue at Northfleet Embankment East based on Southern Water's response to the October 2011 Core Strategy consultation which proposed 150 dwellings for this site. This could change subject to a detailed assessment.

What	Specific Requirements	*Need for Scheme	When	Cost	Lead Body	Funding Sources	Source
Transport	Off-site highway improvement works: Dering Way widening and Lion Roundabout junction plus walking and cycling links	Required to mitigate the traffic impacts of new employment and residential development at North East Gravesend	Depends on grant and implementation of planning permissions	Unknown	Developer	Developer	Resolutions to grant planning permission GR/2010/0436 and GR/2011/0197
Transport	Provision of a bus service to serve Canal Basin	Required to mitigate the traffic impacts of new development at Canal Basin	Depends on grant and implementation of planning permission	Unknown	Developer	Developer	Resolution to grant planning permission GR/2011/0713
Transport	Bus shelter on Dering Way	Make new bus service more attractive	Depends on grant and implementation of planning permission	£5k	Gravesham Borough Council	Developer	Resolution to grant planning permission GR/2011/0197
Waste Water	Sewerage capacity infrastructure improvements	Required for forecast population	Depends on implementation of developments	Unknown	Southern Water	Developers	Southern Water
Water	Water supply capacity infrastructure improvements at Canal Basin ²⁸	Required for forecast population	Depends on implementation of development	Unknown	Southern Water	Developer	Southern Water
Gravesend Town Centre							
Education	Additional primary school places to be provided through school extensions	Required for forecast population	2012 onwards	£1.9m (IIFM)	KCC	Developers	Kent Draft Commissioning Plan for Education Provision

²⁸ Assumed that this will not be an issue at North East Gravesend based on Southern Water's response to the planning application for residential development. This could change subject to a detailed assessment.

What	Specific Requirements	*Need for Scheme	When	Cost	Lead Body	Funding Sources	Source
Health	Possible primary care (GP) practice	Required for forecast population	Unknown	Unknown	NHS West Kent	Developers	NHS West Kent Estates Strategy and Strategic Service Development Plan
Transport	Integrated public transport interchange at Garrick Street / Barrack Row (including new Rathmore Road Link)	Provision of a public transport interchange at Barrack Row with long stay multi-storey car park. Diversion of the one-way system south of the railway via a new Rathmore Road to make the space available	Phase 1 complete 2011 Phase 2 Unknown Phase 3 2015	Phase 1 £2m Phase 2 £10m Phase 3 £8m	GBC / Network Rail / KCC	Phase 1 HCA / Phase 2 Network Rail & developer contributions / Phase 3 STIP	Planning permission GR/2010/0098 Planning application GR/2012/0441 Report to KCC Council Cabinet 15 October 2012
Transport	Crossrail extension of services from Abbey Wood to Gravesend	New through rail route to Central London and Thames corridor	Post 2018	Unknown	TFL	Not identified	DFT Safeguarding Direction October 2009 Network Rail CP4 Delivery Plan 2009-14: September 2012 Update
Transport	West Street / Bath Street junction and West Street to Crooked Lane improvements	Required to mitigate the traffic impacts of new development at Heritage Quarter	Depends on grant and implementation of planning permission	Unknown	Developer	Developer	Requirement of previous application
Transport	Off-site highway improvement works: Ordnance Road widening and Ordnance Road / Milton Road junction	Required to mitigate the traffic impacts of new development at Canal Basin	Depends on grant and implementation of planning permission	Unknown	Developers	Developers	Resolution to grant planning permission GR/2011/0713 and requirement of previous application

What	Specific Requirements	*Need for Scheme	When	Cost	Lead Body	Funding Sources	Source
Transport	Public car parking provision	Provision of sufficient public car parking to serve Gravesend Town Centre in the future	2011-2028	Unknown	GBC	GBC	The overall provision of public car parking is currently being reviewed and the results will inform the future provision and distribution strategy to ensure an appropriate level of long and short stay parking is maintained.
Transport	Urban Traffic Management and Control (UTMC)	Efficient management of existing highway network	2017-2022	£4.5m for Gravesend and Dartford	KCC	Local Transport Plan / STIP / Developers	Report to Kent County Council Cabinet 15 October 2012
Waste Water	Sewerage capacity infrastructure improvements	Required for forecast population	Depends on implementation of developments	Unknown	Southern Water	Developers	Southern Water
Water	Water supply capacity infrastructure improvements	Required for forecast population	Depends on implementation of development	Unknown	Southern Water	Developers	Southern Water

What	Specific Requirements	*Need for Scheme	When	Cost	Lead Body	Funding Sources	Source
Ebsfleet – Both Springhead Quarter and Northfleet Rise Quarter Key Sites							
Community	Adult education centre	Required for forecast population	Trigger set against number of homes completed. Depends on development phasing	Unknown	KCC	Developer	Planning permission GR1996/0035
Community	Community centres	Required for forecast population	Trigger set against number of homes completed. Depends on development phasing	Unknown	Developer / Third Party Providers	Developer	Planning permissions GR1996/0035 and GR/2010/0828
Community	Day care facilities for the elderly / Community hub	Required for forecast population	2012 onwards	£397,397 (IIFM)	KCC / Third Party Providers	Developer	Planning permission GR1996/0035
Community	Family centre	Required for forecast population	Trigger set against number of homes completed. Depends on development phasing	Unknown	KCC / Third Party Providers	Developer	Planning permissions GR1996/0035 and GR/2010/0828

What	Specific Requirements	*Need for Scheme	When	Cost	Lead Body	Funding Sources	Source
Community	Library	Required for forecast population	Trigger set against number of homes completed. Depends on development phasing	Unknown	KCC	Developer	Planning permission GR1996/0035
Community	Places of worship	Required for forecast population	Trigger set against number of homes completed. Depends on development phasing	Unknown	Developer / Third Party Providers	Developer / Third Party Providers	Planning permissions GR1996/0035 and GR/2010/0828
Education	Pre-school nurseries	Required for forecast population	Trigger set against number of homes completed. Depends on development phasing	Unknown	KCC / Third Party Providers	Developer	Planning permissions GR1996/0035 and GR/2010/0828
Education	2 form entry primary school at Springhead	Required for forecast population and to enable relocation of Rosherville Primary School	2015 onwards	Cost being shared between Kent County Council and Developer, likely to be £5.2m	KCC	Developer / KCC	Kent Draft Commissioning Plan for Education Provision, Planning permissions GR1996/0035 and GR/2010/0828

What	Specific Requirements	*Need for Scheme	When	Cost	Lead Body	Funding Sources	Source
Health	Primary care (GP) practices	Required for forecast population	Trigger set against number of homes completed. Depends on development phasing	Unknown	NHS West Kent	Developer	Planning permissions GR1996/0035 and GR/2010/0828
Sport and Recreation	Multipurpose sports centre	Required for forecast population	Trigger set against number of homes completed. Depends on development phasing	Unknown	Developer / Third Party Provider	Developer / Third Party Provider	Planning permissions GR1996/0035 and GR/2010/0828
Transport	Bridge over the Ebbsfleet stream to provide a pedestrian, cycle and road link between Springhead Quarter and Ebbsfleet Station	Required to provide new residents with easy access to Ebbsfleet transport hub	Trigger set against number of homes completed. Depends on development phasing	Unknown	Developer	Developer	Planning permissions GR/1996/0035 and GR/2003/0441 and resolution to grant planning permission GR/2012/0187
Transport	Aspiration to provide a pedestrian and cycle link between Ebbsfleet and Northfleet Stations	Required to provide connections between traditional and high speed / international rail services and improved links between new and existing communities	2016 – 2021	£8.5m estimate for Northfleet to Thames Way section but further costs to be assessed	GBC and DBC / KCC / Network Rail	To be explored. Possible mix – Network Rail / Developers / KCC / Other	Local Transport Plan for Kent, Kent Route Utilisation Strategy 2010

What	Specific Requirements	*Need for Scheme	When	Cost	Lead Body	Funding Sources	Source
Transport	Thames Way dual carriageway – section Springhead Road to Stonebridge Road	Ebbsfleet development if sufficient volume of traffic generated	Depends on development phasing and amounts.	Unknown	KCC / Developer	STIP / Developer	Planning permissions GR/1996/0035 and GR/2008/0414
	Junction improvements	Thames Way junction improvements for Northfleet Embankment West	Depends on grant and implementation of development	Unknown	Developer	Developer	Resolution to grant planning permission GR/2009/0238
Transport	Ebbsfleet Gateway / Thames Way junction as part of dualling Ebbsfleet Gateway	Ebbsfleet development	Development dependent	Unknown	Developer	Developer	Planning permissions GR/1996/0035, DA/1996/0047 Resolution to grant planning permission GR/2009/0238
Transport	A2 Ebbsfleet junction improvements (Dartford Borough)	Development in Ebbsfleet, Northfleet, Eastern Quarry and Swanscombe Peninsula as required for DBC & GBC sites	2021/22	£30m	KCC (with Highways Agency)	Developers / STIP	Planning permissions GR/1996/0035 and DA/1996/0047 Report to KCC Cabinet 15 October 2012
Waste Water	Sewerage capacity infrastructure improvements	Required for forecast population in accordance with a Water Management Strategy	In accordance with the Water Management Strategy	Unknown	Thames Water / GBC	Developer	Planning permissions GR/1996/0035 and GR/2003/0660
Water	Water supply capacity infrastructure improvements	Required for forecast population in accordance with a Utilities Strategy	In accordance with the Utilities Strategy	Unknown	Thames Water / GBC	Developer	Planning permissions GR/1996/0035 and GR/2003/0660

What	Specific Requirements	*Need for Scheme	When	Cost	Lead Body	Funding Sources	Source
Land at Coldharbour Road Key Site							
Transport	Provision of an off road cycle and pedestrian links running from north to south	Required to provide and improve connections to public transport, local services and facilities	Depends on grant and implementation of planning permission	Unknown	Developer	Developer	Local Transport Plan for Kent
Transport	Tollgate A2 junction (A227 including Coldharbour Road Junction) Scheme yet to be defined in detail but options for testing identified	Existing junction safety issues plus impact of new development	2016 – 2021	Unknown	Developers / Highways Agency / KCC	To be explored – possible mix Developers / Highways Agency / Others	Tollgate Junction – Forecasting Report May 2013
Education	Additional primary school places to be provided	Required for forecast population	2015 onwards	Unknown	KCC	Developer	Kent Draft Commissioning Plan for Education Provision (N.B. as new proposal site not considered)
Waste Water	Sewerage capacity infrastructure improvement	Required for forecast population	Depends on implementation of development	Unknown	Southern Water	Developer	Southern Water
Water	Water supply capacity infrastructure improvements	Required for forecast population	Depends on implementation of development	Unknown	Southern Water	Developer	Southern Water

What	Specific Requirements	*Need for Scheme	When	Cost	Lead Body	Funding Sources	Source
Rest of Gravesend / Northfleet Urban Area							
Education	Additional primary school places to be provided through school extensions	Required for forecast population	2012 onwards	£1.9m (IIFM)	KCC	Developers	Kent Draft Commissioning Plan for Education Provision
Health	Relocation of the Gateway Medical Practice (Main), Granby Place (Branch) and The Forge primary care (GP) practices to new premises	Change to service for existing population	Complete 2012	Unknown	NHS West Kent	Unknown	NHS West Kent Estates Strategy and Strategic Service Development Plan, planning permission
Borough-wide							
Air Quality	Air quality impact assessment including monitoring, implementation of agreed mitigation measures and contribution towards the implementation of the Air Quality Action Plans on all key sites	To ensure that development does not unacceptably impact on air quality and/or is not unacceptably impacted upon by local air quality	Depends on implementation of developments	Depends on the scale and nature of the development and its potential impact on air quality	GBC	Developers	GBC, various planning permissions

What	Specific Requirements	*Need for Scheme	When	Cost	Lead Body	Funding Sources	Source
Communications	Provide super-fast broadband on all key sites	To ensure that new residents and businesses have access to the latest technology; to improve competitiveness; to improve access to telecare/health, education and other public services; and to facilitate more flexible working practices	Depends on implementation of developments	Unknown	Developers / GBC	Third Party Providers	Thames Gateway Kent Growth Plan, South East LEP Vision, Vision for Kent, Unlocking Kent's Potential KCC's Framework for Regeneration, DCMS Broadband Delivery UK Plan
Community	Assistive technology (telecare) to enable older people and adults with disabilities to live independently in their homes	Required for forecast population	2012 onwards	£16,462 (IIFM)	KCC	Developers	Kent Integrated Infrastructure and Finance Model
Community	Burial land	Required for existing and forecast population	2011 onwards	Unknown	GBC / Third Party Provider	Third Party Provider	Future Requirements in Relation to Cremation and Burial Facilities Draft Report
Community	Additional library stock, network resources and community learning resources. Borough-wide plus specific provision at Gravesend, Coldharbour, Riverview, Vigo and mobile libraries	Required for forecast population	2012 onwards	£782,268 (IIFM)	KCC	Developers	Kent Integrated Infrastructure and Finance Model

What	Specific Requirements	*Need for Scheme	When	Cost	Lead Body	Funding Sources	Source
Community	Additional youth service resources	Required for forecast population	2017 onwards	£185,252 (IIFM)	KCC / Third Party Providers	Developers	Kent Integrated Infrastructure and Finance Model
Education	Additional secondary school places to be provided through school extensions	Required for forecast population	Required for forecast population	£5.2m (IIFM)	KCC	Developers / Other	Kent Draft Commissioning Plan for Education Provision
Employment and Training	Provide skill training brokerage schemes, local employment and training initiatives and employ local contractors on all key sites	To enable workforce development to capitalise on the planned housing and job growth or to enhance the prospects of local people to take advantage of new job opportunities in the Borough	Depends on implementation of developments	Depends on the scale and nature of the development	GBC	Developers	Economy and Employment Space Study, Thames Gateway Kent Growth Plan

What	Specific Requirements	*Need for Scheme	When	Cost	Lead Body	Funding Sources	Source
Flood Risk	Thames Estuary 2100 project, a long term flood risk management plan	To ensure that future tidal flood risk from the Thames is managed	Depends on DEFRA approval of the plan	Unknown	Environment Agency	Environment Agency / DEFRA / Developers	Thames Estuary 2100
Green Infrastructure	On site public open space provision, including play areas, local parks, allotment sites and playing fields where justified by the scale and mix of development	Required for forecast population	Depends on implementation of developments	Unknown	GBC	Developer	Various planning permissions, various resolutions to grant planning permission, PPG17 Open Space Sport and Recreation Study
Green Infrastructure	Thames Estuary Path for walkers and cyclists / England Coast Path along the River Thames	Benefits for the existing and forecast population	2012 onwards	Unknown	GBC / Natural England	Developers / Natural England	Thames Estuary Path Survey, Coastal Access Scheme
Health	Extensions and improvements to existing primary care (GP) practices	Required for forecast population	Unknown	Unknown	NHS West Kent	Developers	NHS West Kent
Sport and Recreation	On site and off site indoor and outdoor sports and recreation provision where justified by the scale and mix of development	Required for forecast population	Depends on implementation of developments	Unknown	GBC	Developers	Planning permissions, resolutions to grant planning permission, PPG17 Open Space, Sport and Recreation Study

What	Specific Requirements	*Need for Scheme	When	Cost	Lead Body	Funding Sources	Source
Transport	Small scale improvements to walking network	Delivery of comprehensive network	2011-28	Unknown	KCC	Local Transport Plan / Developers etc.	Walking strategy to be developed
Transport	Small scale improvements to cycling network	Delivery of comprehensive cycle network including: • Links east of Gravesend Town Centre • Links to Cyclopark • Key sites	2011-28	Unknown	KCC	Local Transport Plan / Developers etc.	Cycling strategy to be developed
Transport	Small scale highway improvements	Congestion and safety	2011-28	Unknown	KCC	Local Transport Plan and STIP	Local Transport Plan
Transport	Smartcards	Ease of use of public transport system	2012-17	Unknown	DFT / KCC	Local Transport Plan / Rail	Local Transport Plan / Rail franchise
Waste facilities	Waste recycling / waste transfer facilities on all key sites	Required for forecast population	Depends on implementation of developments	Unknown	GBC	Developers	Planning permissions, resolutions to grant planning permissions, Kent Joint Municipal Waste Management Strategy

What	Specific Requirements	*Need for Scheme	When	Cost	Lead Body	Funding Sources	Source
Water	Universal metering in the Southern Water area	To reduce the demand for water	By 2015	Unknown	Southern Water	Southern Water	Water Resources Management Plan

Word or term	Explanation
A1	Shops – Use Classes Order Classification
A2	Financial and Professional Services – Use Classes Order Classification
A3	Restaurants and Cafes – Use Classes Order Classification
A4	Drinking Establishments – Use Classes Order Classification
A5	Hot Food Takeaways – Use Classes Order Classification
Affordable rented housing	Housing let by local authorities or private registered providers of social housing to households who are eligible for social rented housing. Affordable rent is subject to rent controls that require a rent of no more than 80% of the local market rent (including service charges, where applicable)
AONB	Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty
Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty	A nationally important landscape designated under the National Parks and Access to the Countryside Act 1949
B Class	Uses falling within B1, B1a, B1b, B1c, B2 and B8 of the Use Classes Order Classification
B1	Business – Use Classes Order Classification
B1a	Offices, other than those in use class A2 – Use Classes Order Classification
B1b	Research and Development – Use Classes Order Classification
B1c	Light Industry – Use Classes Order Classification
B2	General Industrial – Use Classes Order Classification
B8	Storage and Distribution – Use Classes Order Classification

Word or term	Explanation
BFL	Building for Life
BREEAM	Building Research Establishment Environmental Assessment Method
C1	Hotels – Use Classes Order Classification
Carbon Footprint	The amount of carbon dioxide that enters the atmosphere because of electricity and fuel used. It is measured in tonnes of carbon dioxide
CIL	Community Infrastructure Levy
Community Infrastructure Levy	A levy allowing local authorities to raise funds from owners or developers of land undertaking new building projects in their area.
Comparison goods	Items not obtained on a frequent basis. These include clothing, footwear, household and recreational goods.
Conservation area	An area of special architectural or historic interest the character or appearance of which it is desirable to preserve or enhance designated by local authorities under the Planning (Listed Buildings and Conservation Areas) Act 1990
Convenience goods	Everyday essential items, including food, drinks, newspapers/magazines and confectionery.
D1	Non Residential Institutions – Use Classes Order Classification
D2	Assembly and Leisure – Use Classes Order Classification
DPD	Development Plan Document
EU	European Union
FTE	Full Time Equivalent
Full Time Equivalent	An estimate of a full time job consisting of an aggregation of the hours worked in a number of part time jobs which equal the time worked in a full time job.

Word or term	Explanation
Green Belt	Green Belts are established through development plans and consist of predominantly open land around urban areas and other settlements with the strategic role of preventing the outward expansion of built-up areas, preventing neighbouring towns merging together, safeguarding the countryside from encroachment, preserving the special character of historic towns and assisting urban regeneration by encouraging the recycling of derelict and other urban land.
HRA	Habitats Regulations Assessment
HS1	High Speed 1
Infrastructure	Roads and other transport facilities; flood defences; schools and other educational facilities; medical facilities; social and community facilities; public services; utility services; sporting and recreational facilities; and open spaces.
Intermediate housing	Homes for sale and rent provided at a cost above social rent but below market levels. These can include shared equity (shared ownership and equity loans), other low cost homes for sale and intermediate rent but not affordable rented housing.
Kent Thameside	This term refers to the areas of Dartford and Gravesham located north of the A2. A number of technical studies have been produced for this area.
LDS	Local Development Scheme
Listed Building	A building or structure of special architectural or historic interest designated by English Heritage under the Planning (Listed Buildings and Conservation Areas) Act 1990
Local Development Scheme	A public statement identifying which local development documents will be produced, in what order and when.
Local Wildlife Site	A site which is important for the conservation of wildlife at the county level. These are non-statutory designations which are generally recognised by local authorities and given weight and protection by inclusion in development plan policies.

Word or term	Explanation
MMO	Marine Management Organisation
National Planning Policy Framework	A document containing the Government's planning policies for England and how they are expected to be applied. It sets out requirements of the planning system and provides a framework within which local people and local councils can produce their own distinctive plans which reflect their needs and priorities.
NCR1	National Cycle Route 1
Net Internal Area	The useable area within a building. It excludes lift wells, stairwells, toilets and circulation areas used in common with other occupiers.
NIA	Net Internal Area
NKEPG	North Kent Environmental Planning Group
NPPF	National Planning Policy Framework
Planning Policy for Traveller Sites	A document containing the Government's planning policies for Traveller sites. This sets out the policy approach to plan making and decision taking in respect of Traveller site provision. The document should be read in conjunction with the National Planning Policy Framework.
Primary and Secondary Frontages	Primary frontages are likely to include a high proportion of retail uses which may include food, drinks clothing and household goods. Secondary frontages provide greater opportunities for a diversity of uses such as restaurants, cinemas and businesses.
Primary Shopping Area	A defined area where retail development is concentrated, generally comprising the primary and those secondary frontages which are adjoining and closely related to the primary shopping frontage.
Ramsar Site	An internationally important wildlife site under the "Convention on Wetlands of International Importance especially as Waterfowl Habitat"
SA	Sustainability Appraisal

Word or term	Explanation
SAC	Special Area of Conservation
Scheduled Monument	A nationally important archaeological site and monument identified by English Heritage and protected under the Ancient Monuments and Archaeological Areas Act 1979
SFRA	Strategic Flood Risk Assessment
SHMA	Strategic Housing Market Assessment
Site of Special Scientific Interest	A nationally important wildlife/geological site designated under the Wildlife and Countryside Act 1981
SLAA	Strategic Land Availability Assessment
Social rented housing	Housing owned by local authorities and private registered providers for which guideline target rents are determined through the national rent regime. It may also be owned by other persons and provided under equivalent rental arrangements to the above, as agreed with the local authority or with the Homes and Communities Agency
SPA	Special Protection Area
SPD	Supplementary Planning Document
Special Area of Conservation	An internationally important wildlife site. These are areas given special protection under the European Union's Habitat Directive, which is transposed into UK law by the Habitats and Conservation of Species Regulations, 2010
Special Protection Area	An internationally important wildlife site. These are areas which have been identified as being of international importance for the breeding, feeding, wintering or the migration of rare and vulnerable species of birds found within the European Union countries. They are European designated sites, classified under the Birds Directive
Sq m	Square metres
SSSI	Site of Special Scientific Interest

Word or term	Explanation
Strategic Environmental Assessment	A procedure set out in the Environmental Assessment of Plans and Programmes Regulations, 2004, which requires the formal environmental assessment of certain plans and programmes which are likely to have significant effects on the environment
Strategic Housing Market Assessment	An assessment of the housing market area, carried out with adjoining authorities, which identifies the scale and mix of housing, the range of tenures, the provision for different groups and the amount of affordable housing that the local population is likely to need over the plan period
Strategic Land Availability Assessment	An assessment to identify sites that are available or could become available within Gravesham up to 2028, which are suitable for housing, employment and retail development. This covers the requirement to produce a Strategic Housing Land Availability Assessment (SHLAA) in the NPPF.
SUDS	Sustainable Drainage Systems
Supplementary Planning Document	Documents which add further detail to the policies of the Local Plan. They can be used to provide further guidance for development on specific sites, or on particular issues, such as design. They are capable of being a material consideration in planning decisions but are not part of the development plan.
Sustainability Appraisal	Assessment of the Environmental, economic and social impact of policies, to ensure that all policies and proposals reflect sustainable development principles.
Sustainable Drainage Systems	Techniques that manage surface water and groundwater sustainably. They seek to mimic natural drainage systems and retain water on or near to the site.
Site of Special Scientific Interest	Sites designated by Natural England under the Wildlife and Countryside Act, 1981
TAA	Traveller Accommodation Assessment
TE2100	Thames Estuary 2100

Word or term	Explanation
Traveller Accommodation Assessment	An assessment of the accommodation needs of Travellers which informs the level of pitch provision over the plan period.
Use Classes	A classification of land uses for development control purposes defined by the Town and Country Planning (Use Classes Order), 1987 and subsequent amendment orders. Changes of use of buildings or other land between uses within a single use class, are excluded from the definition of development in the Town and Country Planning Act, 1990, thus making planning permission unnecessary.
Windfall sites	Sites which have not been specifically identified as available in the Local Plan process. They normally comprise previously-developed sites that have unexpectedly become available.